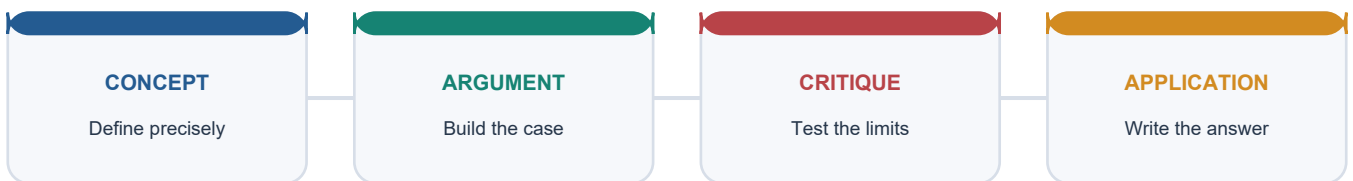


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika - Complete Learning Session

UPSC Philosophy Optional | Paper I, Section B | 15 teaching sessions, 32 diagnostics, 22 solved PYQs, 6 original Mains models and register notes

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika - Complete Learning Session

Syllabus, verbatim: *Nyaya-Vaiesesika : Theory of Categories; Theory of Appearance; Theory of Pramana; Self, Liberation; God; Proofs for the Existence of God; Theory of Causation; Atomistic Theory of Creation.* - UPSC Philosophy Paper I, Section B, item 15. The printed spellings, spacing and the printed misspelling *Vaiesesika* are reproduced exactly; the normalised scholarly forms used below are *Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika*, *padārtha*, *khyāti*, *pramāṇa*, *ātman*, *apavarga*, *Īśvara*, *asatkāryavāda* and *paramāṇuvāda*. **Evidence discipline:** FACT: marks convergent doctrine, ANALYSIS: marks analytical reconstruction or evaluation, and CAUTION: marks a contested textual, historical or interpretive point. Model answers are independent learner practice and are never official UPSC keys. **Terminology rule:** the English concept leads; the accurate Sanskrit term in IAST follows immediately in parentheses. A term is glossed on first use in each session so that no session depends on remembering an earlier gloss.

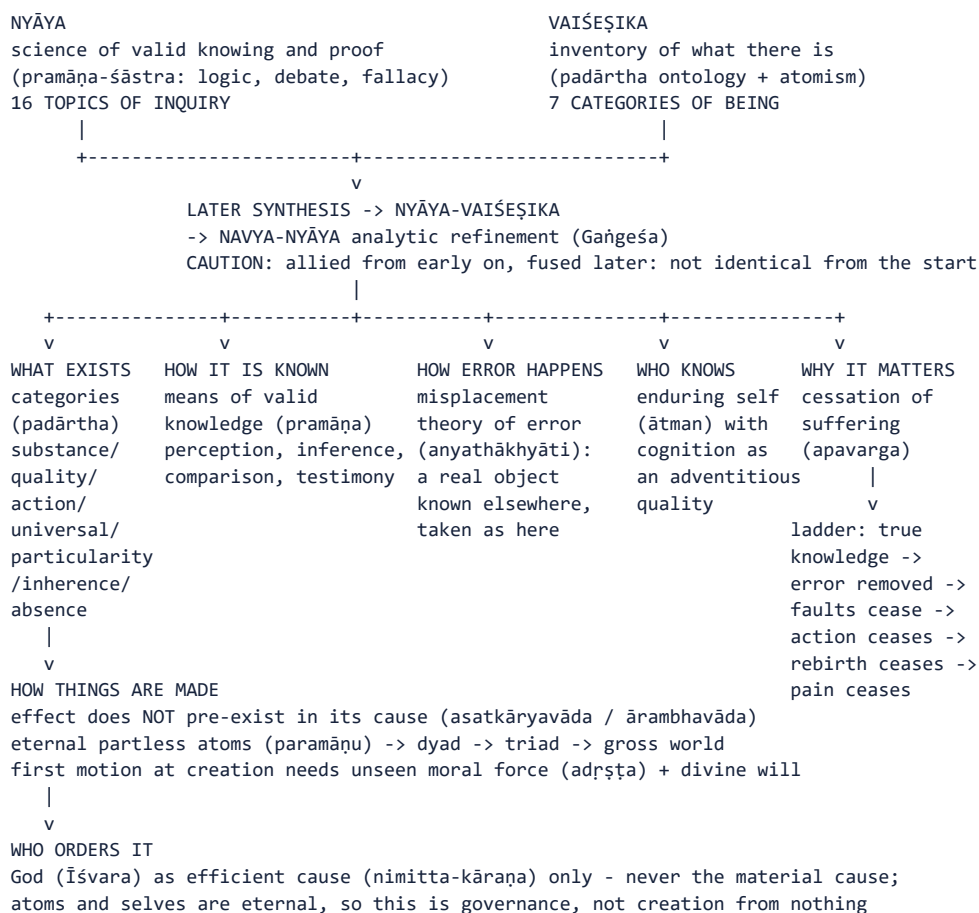
What this package contains

Component	Count
Progressive teaching sessions in the Basic block	15
Original diagnostic MCQs - 24 core plus 8 remedial drills	32
Directly owned verified PYQs solved in full	22
Original solved Mains models - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks	6
Consolidated register parts	12 (A-L)
ASCII master flow panels	14

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

CONCEPT SPINE - ENGLISH FIRST, SANSKRIT IMMEDIATELY AFTER

TWO ALLIED SCHOOLS, ONE MATURE SYSTEM, ONE SOTERIOLOGICAL PURPOSE



Concept spine: read it downward. The two boxes at the top are two different questions - what exists and how we know - and every printed syllabus limb below is generated by joining them. Categories answer "what"; means of valid knowledge answer "how"; the theory of error answers "how knowing fails"; self and liberation answer "for whom"; causation, atomism and God answer "how the world is produced and governed".

Answer-worthiness. FACT: Both category systems, the four means of valid knowledge, perception and inference with their taxonomies, comparison and testimony, the theory of appearance, self and release, later Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika theism with Udayana's proofs, causation and atomism are **marks-essential core** - no routed previous-year question can be answered without them. FACT: The acquisition of invariable concomitance, the fallacies of the reason, the debate categories, the theory of validity, absence-cognition, the six blockers of universalhood, inherence and the named opponent replies are **core supporting depth** wherever they decide a routed question. ANALYSIS: Full Navya-Nyāya formal language, exhaustive subtypes of quibble or ground of defeat, controlled Western comparisons and proof variants beyond the question's demand are **optional enrichment** and are held back to the clearly labelled optional block after the practice sections.

HOW TO READ THIS SESSION

ANALYSIS: **Reconstruction discipline.** Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika has a continuous, textually rich literature - Gautama's *Nyāya-sūtra*, Kaṇāda's *Vaiśeṣika-sūtra*, Praśastapāda, Śrīdhara, Udayana and Gaṅgeśa - so doctrine can be stated positively. Four things still need qualification and are marked CAUTION: wherever they appear: whether Nyāya and Vaiśeṣika are one system or two; whether the seventh category (absence) belongs to Kaṇāda's own list or is a later addition; whether the developed creator-God apparatus can be read back into early Vaiśeṣika; and whether universal-mediated perception is genuine perception or a device built to solve induction.

Complete the Basic block first. Every optional interpretive dispute is deliberately withheld until the labelled optional block that follows the practice sections. Nothing in that block is required for a full-marks core answer.

ANALYSIS: **The single most common structural failure in Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika scripts** is to answer the printed syllabus as eight unrelated headings. It is one system with one purpose. Gautama's opening promise is soteriological: knowledge of the categories of inquiry produces the highest good. Categories give the furniture, means of valid

knowledge give the access, the theory of error explains failure, the self is the one who is bound and released, and causation, atomism and God explain how the furniture is assembled and governed. Every session below is placed so that this single derivation stays visible.

ONE-SCREEN MAP OF THE FIFTEEN SESSIONS

WHAT THIS SYSTEM IS	-> S1	two allied schools, one realism, the liberation promise
THE INQUIRY MAP	-> S2	sixteen Nyāya topics + twelve knowables (prameya)
THE FURNITURE	-> S3	seven categories: substance, quality, motion
THE ONE AND THE MANY	-> S4	universal, its six blockers, ultimate particularity
THE GLUE	-> S5	inherence vs conjunction - brown table vs book on table
NEGATIVE FACTS	-> S6	four absences, counterpositive, how absence is known
SEEING	-> S7	four means of knowing + Gautama's definition of perception
INFERRING	-> S8	five members, three grids, five marks of a valid reason
SECURING THE UNIVERSAL	-> S9	grasping concomitance + the five fallacies
WORDS AND WARRANT	-> S10	comparison, testimony, memory, validity, pramāṇaphala
WHEN KNOWING FAILS	-> S11	misplacement theory of error and its four rivals
WHO IS BOUND	-> S12	self, mind, and release as cessation of suffering
WHO GOVERNS	-> S13	God as efficient cause; Udayana's cumulative proofs
HOW THINGS ARE MADE	-> S14	effect newly produced; three causes; atoms to world
JUDGEMENT	-> S15	named objections, cross-school grid, graded verdict

This is a route map, not a substitute for the fifteen complete Basic subtopics below.

SESSION 1 - TWO ALLIED SCHOOLS, ONE REALISM, ONE LIBERATION PROMISE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika is the Indian school that insists the world is really out there, that it comes in a fixed number of kinds, and that ordinary disciplined knowing - looking, inferring, comparing and listening to reliable speakers - is enough to reach the truth that finally ends suffering.

Technical definition: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika is the mature synthesis of two allied orthodox (*āstika*) realist and pluralist systems: **Nyāya**, the science of the means of valid knowledge, inference, debate and fallacy classically associated with Gautama's *Nyāya-sūtra*; and **Vaiśeṣika**, the ontology of categories (*padārtha*) and atomism classically associated with Kaṇāda's *Vaiśeṣika-sūtra*. The synthesis holds that valid cognition (*pramā*) of the categories of inquiry removes false notions (*mithyā-jñāna*), and that removing false notions removes the faults, activity, rebirth and suffering that constitute bondage.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika is the only Indian system that makes logic itself a path to liberation: it argues that suffering persists because we misdescribe the world, so a discipline that tells us exactly what exists and exactly how it may be known is not a preliminary to soteriology but its instrument.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **realism** - cognition is of a mind-independent object, not a construction of it
- **pluralism** - irreducibly many kinds of real, and many real selves
- **science of valid knowing (pramāṇa-śāstra)** - Nyāya's own self-description
- **category (padārtha)** - literally "the meaning of a word": whatever is nameable and knowable
- **similar systems (samānatānta)** - the textbook label for the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika alliance
- **release (apavarga)** - the declared final purpose of the whole enterprise
- **Navya-Nyāya** - the later analytic refinement associated with Gaṅgeśa

How to use them: never open a Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika answer by listing categories. Open by naming the system's job - realist ontology plus a theory of warranted cognition, aimed at release - and then say which of the two halves the question sits in. A question on categories, particularity, inherence, absence or atoms sits in the Vaiśeṣika half; a question on perception, inference, fallacies, error, validity or God's proofs sits in the Nyāya half; a question on the self, liberation or causation is answered jointly.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

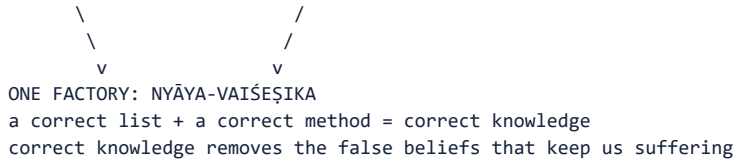
TWO WORKSHOPS THAT EVENTUALLY SHARE ONE FACTORY

WORKSHOP A: "WHAT IS THERE?"

Kaṇāda's Vaiśeṣika
makes a list of kinds of being
substance, quality, motion,
universal, particularity,
inherence, absence

WORKSHOP B: "HOW DO WE FIND OUT?"

Gautama's Nyāya
makes a toolkit for proving things
looking, inferring, comparing,
being told by someone reliable
+ rules for debate and for spotting
a bad reason



In simple words: imagine two neighbours. One spends his life cataloguing everything that exists and refuses to add a new kind unless the catalogue genuinely fails without it. The other spends his life checking how we are entitled to claim anything at all, and refuses to accept a claim unless its route can be named. Eventually they realise they need each other: a catalogue with no method is dogma, and a method with no catalogue has nothing to be about. That merger is Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika. Everything technical in the system - inherence, ultimate particularity, prior absence, universal-mediated perception - exists because one of the two neighbours found a gap the other could not fill.

Remember first	Meaning
Realism	The pot exists whether or not you perceive it; perception reveals, it does not manufacture
Pluralism	Many kinds and many selves; the system never reduces the many to one
<i>Padārtha</i>	"What a word means" - hence a knowable, nameable kind of thing
<i>Pramāṇa</i>	Not "proof" but "the instrument that produces true cognition"
What it denies	Illusionism, momentariness, no-self, a single substance, and knowledge by revelation alone

One-line memory: Nyāya supplies the microscope, Vaiśeṣika supplies the specimen list, and liberation is what the laboratory is for.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE DIVISION OF LABOUR AND WHY IT MATTERS IN THE EXAM

QUESTION ASKS ABOUT ...	ANSWER FROM ...	SIGNATURE VOCABULARY
categories, substance, quality, universal, particularity, inherence, absence, atoms	VAIŚEṢIKA half	padārtha, dravya, guṇa, karma, sāmānya, viśeṣa, samavāya, abhāva, paramāṇu
perception, inference, fallacy, comparison, testimony, error, validity, debate, proofs of God	NYĀYA half	pramāṇa, pratyakṣa, anumāna, vyāpti, hetvābhāsa, anyathākhyāti
self, liberation, causation, God's cosmic role	JOINT - answer from the mature synthesis	ātman, apavarga, asatkāryavāda, Īśvara
HOW MANY MEANS OF KNOWING?		
classical Nyāya	4 : perception, inference, comparison, testimony	
classical Vaiśeṣika	2 : perception and inference; comparison and testimony are commonly reduced to inference	
mature synthesis	follows the fuller Nyāya scheme of four	

ANALYSIS: Caption. This table decides the first two sentences of every answer. A script that writes "Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika accepts four means of valid knowledge" without noticing that the reduction to two is the *Vaiśeṣika* position loses a precision mark that costs nothing to secure.

1. Nyāya: the science of valid knowing, not formal logic

FACT: **Nyāya** is the school of logic, epistemology and critical debate, classically associated with **Gautama's Nyāya-sūtra**.*

FACT: Its concern is **not** logic in an abstract formalist sense alone. It is valid cognition treated as a means to the removal of error and finally to liberation. This is why Nyāya's inference is a schema of *proof to another* with an empirical example built into it, and not a purely formal calculus of validity.

ANALYSIS: **Why this matters for marks.** Scripts that describe Nyāya as "the Indian equivalent of Aristotelian logic" invert its purpose. Aristotle's syllogism tests form; Gautama's five-membered demonstration tests whether an audience is entitled to accept a claim about the world. The presence of the example member (*udāharaṇa*) is the visible proof of that difference.

2. Vaiśeṣika: ontology first, and a name that announces its own thesis

FACT: **Vaiśeṣika**, associated with **Kaṇāda's Vaiśeṣika-sūtra**, is primarily an **ontological school**. It classifies reality into categories (*padārtha**) and develops atomism.

FACT: The school's own name is an argument. It derives from **ultimate particularity (viśeṣa)**, the category invented to explain how two things that share every universal and every ordinary quality can still be two. A system named after its individuator is announcing that plurality is basic and not derived.

3. Their convergence, and the qualification examiners reward

FACT: Over time the two schools converge into a synthetic **Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika** system. Later **Navya-Nyāya**, especially through **Gaṅgeśa**, sharpens the analytic and technical vocabulary of the tradition.

FACT: Standard textbooks call them **similar systems (samānatantṛa)** because they increasingly share a realist ontology, an account of the self, liberation, atomism, causation and later theism.

FACT: Their original division of labour nevertheless remains examinable:

School	Primary classical organisation	Distinctive owner content
Nyāya	Sixteen topics of inquiry and proof	means of valid knowledge, inference, debate, fallacy analysis, theory of error and natural theology
Vaiśeṣika	Seven ontological categories	substances, qualities, motions, universals, particularity, inherence, absence and atomism

ANALYSIS: In an answer it is usually best to treat them together while still noting where a point is distinctly Nyāya (for example the means of valid knowledge, or misplacement error-theory) or distinctly Vaiśeṣika (for example the categories, or atomism).

CAUTION: **The contested question "one system or two?"** should be answered in one qualified sentence rather than avoided: *historically two allied systems with different starting organisations, doctrinally fused in later Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika, with distinguishable emphases that survive the fusion*. Both halves of that sentence carry marks.

4. The theism caution that protects the whole answer

ANALYSIS: **Kaṇāda's foundational text does not unambiguously foreground a creator God**. Praśastapāda, Śrīdhara, Udayana and the later Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika synthesis are explicitly theistic.

ANALYSIS: Therefore attribute the developed efficient-cause and God-proof system to **later** Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika, not mechanically to every stratum of early Vaiśeṣika. A single clause - "in the developed theistic synthesis, though not unambiguously in Kaṇāda" - converts a competent answer into a controlled one.

5. The liberation promise that makes the system one thing

FACT: The system is not a neutral encyclopaedia. Its declared purpose is that knowledge of reality removes false notions, and the removal of false notions dismantles the chain that produces suffering:

- true knowledge of reality (tattva-jñāna)
 - > removal of false notion (mithyā-jñāna)
 - > cessation of faults: attachment, aversion, delusion (rāga, dveṣa, moha)
 - > cessation of action (pravṛtti)
 - > cessation of birth (janma)
 - > cessation of suffering (duḥkha)
 - > RELEASE (apavarga)

ANALYSIS: This ladder is the reason a question about a technical device - inference, prior absence, universal-mediated perception - can always be closed with a soteriological line. The device exists because a mistake about it would leave a false notion in place.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION

Claim. Nyāya and Vaiśeṣika are best treated as two allied systems that solve two halves of one problem rather than as one system from the start. **Named evidence.** Nyāya organises itself around sixteen topics of inquiry and proof beginning with the means of valid knowledge, while Vaiśeṣika organises itself around seven categories of being beginning with substance; classical Nyāya accepts four means of valid knowledge whereas classical Vaiśeṣika accepts two and reduces comparison and testimony to inference. **Analysis.** The two organisations answer different questions - how a claim is warranted, and what kinds of thing there are - and the later synthesis is intelligible precisely because each half needed the other: Vaiśeṣika's atoms and inference are inferred entities that require a defended theory of inference, while Nyāya's realism about universals requires an ontology in which universals are genuine categories. **Qualification.** The fusion is doctrinal rather than original: textbooks call them similar systems (*samānatantra*), and the developed creator-God apparatus in particular belongs to Praśastapāda, Śrīdhara and Udayana rather than unambiguously to Kaṇāda.

UPSC TRAPS - SESSION 1

- ANALYSIS: Writing that Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika "was always one school". It is two allied systems doctrinally fused later.
- ANALYSIS: Attributing Udayana's full creator-God inference to Kaṇāda's own text.
- ANALYSIS: Calling Nyāya "Indian formal logic". Its inference is a schema of proof to another with an obligatory empirical example.
- ANALYSIS: Saying the system accepts four means of valid knowledge without noting that this is the *Nyāya* count and that classical Vaiśeṣika accepts two.
- ANALYSIS: Treating the syllabus limbs as eight separate essays and losing the soteriological frame that ties them together.

RAPID REVISION - SESSION 1

- Nyāya = means of valid knowledge, inference, debate, fallacy, error, natural theology. Vaiśeṣika = categories, particularity, inference, absence, atomism.
- *Samānatantra* = "similar systems": allied, later fused, not identical from the start.
- Vaiśeṣika is named after *viśeṣa*, the ultimate individuator - the name states the thesis.
- Counts: Nyāya 4 means of knowing; classical Vaiśeṣika 2; synthesis follows Nyāya.
- The ladder: true knowledge -> error removed -> faults cease -> action ceases -> birth ceases -> suffering ceases -> release.
- Navya-Nyāya (Gaṅgeśa) refines the vocabulary; it does not replace the doctrine.

SESSION 2 - TWO CATEGORY SYSTEMS: SIXTEEN TOPICS OF INQUIRY AND TWELVE KNOWABLES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Before Nyāya tells you what exists, it tells you what a rational investigation is made of - the sixteen things any disputed inquiry involves, from the instruments of knowing right down to the exact point at which a debater has lost.

Technical definition: The **sixteen topics of inquiry** (*ṣoḍaśa-padārtha*) of Gautama's *Nyāya-sūtra* are the sixteen items whose correct knowledge is declared to produce the highest good. They are topics of rational inquiry, proof and

debate, not kinds of being. The second of them, **objects of valid knowledge (prameya)**, is itself unpacked into **twelve liberation-relevant knowables** running from the self to release.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Nyāya's sixteen categories are the most misread list in Indian philosophy: they are not a rival inventory of being placed alongside Vaiśeṣika's seven, but a map of what a disciplined inquiry contains - which is why doubt, debate, quibble and the ground of defeat sit in the same list as the means of valid knowledge.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **topics of inquiry (śoḍaśa-padārtha)** - sixteen, Nyāya's own organising list
- **objects of valid knowledge (prameya)** - twelve, the soteriological sequence
- **doubt (saṃśaya)** - positive uncertainty between competing alternatives, not blankness
- **hypothetical reasoning (tarka)** - removes doubt by exposing an unacceptable consequence
- **truth-directed debate (vāda)** versus **victory-directed wrangling (jalpa)** versus **destructive cavil (vitaṇḍā)**
- **fallacious reason (hetvābhāsa)** · **quibble (chala)** · **futile rejoinder (jāti)** · **ground of defeat (nigrahasthāna)**

How to use them: if a question asks about "Nyāya categories", decide first whether it means the sixteen topics or the seven kinds of being, and say which you are taking it to mean. That single sentence protects the entire answer.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

THINK OF A COURTROOM, NOT A WAREHOUSE

A WAREHOUSE LIST answers "what is stored here?" -> Vaiśeṣika's seven categories
A COURTROOM LIST answers "what does a trial contain?" -> Nyāya's sixteen topics

In a trial you need:

instruments of proof means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)
the matters to be settled objects of valid knowledge (prameya)
the live uncertainty doubt (saṃśaya)
a reason to bother purpose (prayojana)
an agreed illustration accepted example (dṛṣṭānta)
the position being defended established doctrine (siddhānta)
the steps of demonstration members (avayava)
a way to kill a stubborn doubt .. hypothetical reasoning (tarka)
a verdict ascertainment (nirṇaya)
... plus three ways people argue, and four ways an argument goes wrong.

In simple words: the sixteen are not sixteen things in the world. They are the sixteen moving parts of an argument that is trying to settle something. That is why the list contains both an excellent thing (the means of valid knowledge) and a disreputable thing (quibble) - a complete description of disputation has to include the ways it is abused.

Remember first	Meaning
Sixteen	Topics of <i>inquiry</i> - the anatomy of a rational dispute
Twelve	Knowables inside topic 2 - the anatomy of <i>bondage and release</i>
Seven	Kinds of <i>being</i> - and those belong to Vaiśeṣika, not to this list
Why sixteen matter	Gautama promises the highest good from knowing them
Commonest error	Merging the sixteen and the seven into one list of twenty-three

One-line memory: sixteen is how you argue, twelve is what you must know to be free, seven is what there is.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE SIXTEEN AS FOUR FUNCTIONAL BLOCKS

-- BLOCK I: THE APPARATUS OF KNOWING -----	
1 means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) instruments producing true cognition	
2 objects of valid knowledge (prameya) .. the twelve liberation-relevant realities -> expanded below	
+-----	
-- BLOCK II: WHAT SETS AN INQUIRY GOING AND SETTLES IT -----	
3 doubt (saṃśaya) positive uncertainty between competing options	
4 purpose (prayojana) ... the gain sought or the loss avoided	
5 accepted example (dṛṣṭānta) ... an undisputed case showing a relation	
6 established doctrine (siddhānta) ... the tenet held, by one school, by all, or only for the present argument	
7 members (avayava) the five propositions of proof for another	
8 hypothetical reasoning (tarka) ... doubt-killer: shows the contrary supposition leads somewhere absurd	
9 ascertainment (nirṇaya) ... the settled verdict after both sides are heard	
+-----	
-- BLOCK III: THREE WAYS PEOPLE ACTUALLY ARGUE -----	
10 truth-directed debate (vāda) rule-governed, aimed at truth	
11 victory-directed wrangling (jalpa) aimed at winning, devices allowed	
12 destructive cavil (vitaṇḍā) attacks without defending any thesis	
+-----	
-- BLOCK IV: FOUR WAYS AN ARGUMENT FAILS -----	
13 fallacious reason (hetvābhāsa) an apparent middle term that fails	
14 quibble (chala) distorting the opponent's meaning	
15 futile rejoinder (jāti) specious counter from irrelevant similarity or dissimilarity	
16 ground of defeat (nigrahasthāna) .. the exact point at which a disputant is declared to have lost	
+-----	

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Grouping the sixteen into four functional blocks is worth more than reciting them in order, because the grouping shows *why* the list has that shape: two items supply the epistemic apparatus, seven run an inquiry from doubt to verdict, three classify styles of dispute, and four classify failure.

1. The sixteen topics, with their exam function

#	English-first topic	Exam function
1	means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)	instruments that produce true cognition
2	objects of valid knowledge (prameya)	liberation-relevant realities to be known
3	doubt (saṃśaya)	positive uncertainty between competing alternatives
4	purpose (prayojana)	desired gain or avoided loss that motivates inquiry and action
5	accepted example (dr̥ṣṭānta)	undisputed case illustrating a general relation
6	established doctrine (siddhānta)	conclusion accepted by a system, by all systems, or only for the present argument
7	members of demonstration (avayava)	the five propositions of inference for another
8	hypothetical or reductive reasoning (tarka)	removes doubt by exposing an unacceptable consequence; aids the means of valid knowledge
9	ascertainment (nirṇaya)	settled cognition after considering reasons for and against
10	truth-directed debate (vāda)	rule-governed discussion aimed at truth
11	victory-directed wrangling (jalpa)	debate aimed at winning, including illegitimate devices
12	destructive cavil (vitandā)	attacking the opponent without establishing one's own thesis
13	fallacious reason (hetvābhāsa)	an apparent middle term that fails as proof
14	quibble (chala)	distortion of an opponent's intended meaning
15	futile rejoinder (jāti)	specious counter based on irrelevant similarity or dissimilarity
16	ground of defeat (nigrahasthāna)	the point at which contradiction, evasion or failure to understand defeats a disputant

ANALYSIS: **The homonym trap.** Here **futile rejoinder (jāti)** is a debate fault. It is *not universal (jāti / sāmānya)* in Vaiśeṣika ontology. Two entirely different technical uses of one Sanskrit word appear in one system, and confusing them destroys an otherwise sound answer.

ANALYSIS: Doubt, hypothetical reasoning, truth-directed debate, wrangling, cavil and defeat-grounds need not become separate essays unless asked. Their core function is to show that Nyāya's logic is embedded in disciplined inquiry and debate rather than floating free of it.

2. The twelve objects of valid knowledge as a soteriological sequence

Nyāya's second topic contains twelve liberation-relevant knowables:

1. self (**ātman**)
2. body (**śarīra**)
3. senses (**indriya**)
4. sense-objects (**artha**)
5. cognition (**buddhi / jñāna**)
6. sensory mind (**manas**)
7. activity (**pravṛtti**)
8. defects - attachment, aversion and delusion (**doṣa**)
9. rebirth (**pretyabhāva**)
10. experienced fruit (**phala**)
11. suffering (**duḥkha**)
12. release (**apavarga**)

FACT: This is **not** meant as an exhaustive ontology. It is a **soteriological sequence**: true knowledge of the self and of the causal chain running from defects through activity and rebirth to suffering is what enables release.

FACT: From the Nyāya standpoint the Vaiśeṣika ontological categories fall within the broad field of knowable objects (*prameya*), but they retain their distinct Vaiśeṣika ownership and structure. This is the technically correct way to relate the two lists without flattening them.

3. Why the two lists must never be merged

MEMORY: **Ownership rule.** The sixteen Nyāya categories are topics of rational inquiry, proof and debate; the seven Vaiśeṣika categories are kinds of being. They answer different questions and must not be flattened into one list.

ANALYSIS: A script that writes "Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika has sixteen categories, of which seven are substance, quality, motion..." has produced a category error in the strict sense, and an examiner reading for precision will treat every later distinction in that script as unreliable.

4. Hypothetical reasoning: the one debate-topic that does real doctrinal work

FACT: **Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)** is topic 8, and it is the one item from the debate apparatus that reappears at the heart of the theory of inference.

FACT: Its status is **aid to the means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa-anugrāhaka)**, not an independent means of valid knowledge. It does not by itself prove anything; it removes the rival supposition so that perception and inference can operate.

ANALYSIS: Exam-ready forms of the "unacceptable consequence" it exposes: **self-dependence (ātmāśraya)**, **mutual dependence (anyonyāśraya)**, **circularity (cakraka)**, **infinite regress (anavasthā)**, and contradiction with perception or inference (*pratyakṣa-* or *anumāna-virodha*).

ANALYSIS: Keeping *tarka* out of the list of means of valid knowledge is what saves Nyāya from the charge of circularity when it defends inference in Session 9. Note it here so the reply is already available there.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION

Claim. Nyāya's sixteen topics are a description of rational inquiry, not a competing ontology, and reading them as an inventory of being is the commonest structural error in scripts on this school. **Named evidence.** The list contains the means of valid knowledge and the objects of valid knowledge, but it also contains doubt, purpose, three styles of dispute - truth-directed debate, victory-directed wrangling and destructive cavil - and four modes of failure ending in the ground of defeat; none of the last seven names a kind of thing. **Analysis.** The presence of quibble and futile rejoinder is decisive: a list of what exists would never include ways of arguing badly, whereas a complete anatomy of disputation must, because a theory of proof is incomplete without a theory of how proof is faked. **Qualification.** The two lists are nevertheless relatable rather than unrelated - the Vaiśeṣika categories fall within the field of knowable objects, Nyāya's topic 2 - but they retain distinct ownership, and *jāti* means futile rejoinder here while meaning universal in Vaiśeṣika ontology.

UPSC TRAPS - SESSION 2

- ANALYSIS: Merging the sixteen topics of inquiry with the seven categories of being.
- ANALYSIS: Translating *jāti* as "universal" when it appears as topic 15; there it is futile rejoinder.
- ANALYSIS: Calling hypothetical reasoning (*tarka*) a fifth means of valid knowledge. It is an aid to them.
- ANALYSIS: Presenting the twelve knowables as an ontology. They are a soteriological sequence from self to release.
- ANALYSIS: Confusing truth-directed debate (*vāda*) with victory-directed wrangling (*jalpa*); only the first aims at truth.

RAPID REVISION - SESSION 2

- Sixteen topics = anatomy of inquiry: 2 apparatus + 7 running an inquiry + 3 styles of dispute + 4 modes of failure.
- Topic 2 opens into twelve knowables: self -> body -> senses -> objects -> cognition -> mind -> activity -> defects -> rebirth -> fruit -> suffering -> release.
- *Tarka* is topic 8, is doubt-removing, and is an aid to the means of valid knowledge, never one of them.

- *Jāti* = futile rejoinder in the sixteen; *jāti* = universal in the seven. Different lists, different meaning.
- The four unacceptable consequences to name: self-dependence, mutual dependence, circularity, infinite regress.

SESSION 3 - THE SEVEN CATEGORIES: SUBSTANCE, QUALITY AND MOTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Vaiśeṣika's list of everything there is has exactly seven slots, and the first three are the ordinary furniture of the world: things, the features that belong to them, and the movements they undergo.

Technical definition: A **category (padārtha)** is whatever is nameable and knowable - literally "the meaning of a word". Classical Vaiśeṣika finally recognises **seven**: substance (*dravya*), quality (*guṇa*), motion or action (*karma*), universal (*sāmānya*), ultimate particularity (*viśeṣa*), inherence (*samavāya*) and absence (*abhāva*). The first three are the positive furniture; the next three are what holds the furniture together and apart; the seventh admits negative facts into the inventory.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Vaiśeṣika's category list is an exercise in disciplined economy rather than metaphysical extravagance: each of the seven is admitted only because a describable feature of experience - bearing, depending, moving, recurring, individuating, inseparably relating, or being absent - would otherwise remain unexplained.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **category (padārtha)** - nameable and knowable
- **substance (dravya)** - the locus in which qualities and motions inhere
- **quality (guṇa)** - dependent feature; itself has no further quality or motion in the same way
- **motion or action (karma)** - physical movement, **not** moral karma
- **nine substances · twenty-four qualities · five motions**
- **conjunction (saṃyoga)** and **disjunction (vibhāga)** - produced by motion, and hence the hinge of causation

How to use them: in any question on the categories, give the count *and* the reason for the count. "Nine substances" earns a fact mark; "nine, because ether, time and direction are themselves substances and not mere conditions" earns the analysis mark.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

THE THREE OBVIOUS SLOTS

A THING (substance)	ITS FEATURES (quality)	WHAT IT DOES (motion)
a pot	brown, one, big	it rises, it falls
qualities and motions cannot float free -		
they must be *in* something		
+-----> the pot <-----+		

Test that separates them:

- Can it exist on its own and hold things? -> substance
- Does it depend on a substance and have no further quality of its own? -> quality
- Does it cause things to come into contact or come apart? -> motion

In simple words: hold a pot. The pot is a thing. Brown, heavy and single are not extra things sitting beside the pot - they are features that could not exist unless the pot did. Lifting it is neither the pot nor a feature but an event in it, and the interesting thing about that event is that it makes the pot touch or stop touching something else. That last point is why motion earns its own slot: contact and separation are what causation is made of.

Remember first	Meaning
Substance	Bears qualities and motions; can be a material base
Quality	Cannot exist independently of a substance

Remember first	Meaning
Motion	Physical movement in a substance; produces contact and separation
Nine substances	earth, water, fire, air, ether, time, direction, self, mind
Trap	<i>Karma</i> here means motion, not moral desert; moral merit and demerit are qualities

One-line memory: a substance has, a quality belongs, a motion happens - and only motion makes things touch.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE NINE SUBSTANCES SORTED BY THE TESTS EXAMINERS USE

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┌- ATOMIC AND ETERNAL AS ATOMS, NON-ETERNAL AS COMPOUNDS -----┐
| 1 earth (pṛthivī)  2 water (ap)  3 fire (tejas)  4 air (vāyu)  |
| ▶ these four have ultimate atoms (paramāṇu) and build the gross world |
└-----┘
┌- ALL-PERVADING, ETERNAL, ONE, NON-ATOMIC -----┐
| 5 ether (ākāśa) - substrate of sound                |
| 6 time (kāla)   - ground of before/after             |
| 7 direction (dik) - ground of here/there, near/far   |
| ▶ TRAP: these are SUBSTANCES, not abstract conditions or frameworks |
└-----┘
┌- THE KNOWER AND ITS INSTRUMENT -----┐
| 8 self (ātman) - eternal, all-pervading, many; bears cognition, |
|                  pleasure, pain, desire, aversion, effort, merit |
| 9 mind (manas) - eternal, ATOMIC, one per self; the internal organ |
| ▶ mind is atomic => only one cognition at a time (attention is serial) |
└-----┘

```

COUNT CHECK: 4 elemental + 3 all-pervading non-conscious + self + mind = 9

ANALYSIS: Caption. Sorting the nine by their properties, rather than reciting them, converts a recall question into an analysis answer, and it also pre-loads two high-frequency points: that ether, time and direction are substances, and that the atomicity of mind is what makes attention serial.

1. Category (padārtha): what the word claims

FACT: Padārtha means what is **nameable and knowable**. The term is literally "the meaning of a word", and that etymology carries the school's realist semantics: if a word has a settled meaning, there is something in the world answering to it.

FACT: Classical Vaiśeṣika finally recognises **seven** categories.

CAUTION: Historically, Kaṇāda's older list is often taken as **six**, with **absence (abhāva)** added later. An answer should note this whenever the count is at issue, because the examiner may be testing exactly that awareness.

2. The seven at a glance

Category	Basic sense	Why it is admitted
substance (dravya)	substance	locus of qualities and actions
quality (guṇa)	quality	cannot exist independently of substance
motion (karma)	motion/action	produces conjunction and disjunction
universal (sāmānya)	universal	common feature grounding classification
particularity (viśeṣa)	ultimate particularity	differentiates eternal reals
inherence (samavāya)	inherence	inseparable relation
absence (abhāva)	absence/non-existence	explains negation and non-being judgements

3. Substance (dravya): definition, list, distinction, example

FACT: Statement. Substance is that in which qualities and actions inhere and which can serve as a material or ontological base.

FACT: There are **nine** substances: earth (*pṛthivī*), water (*ap*), fire (*tejas*), air (*vāyu*), ether (*ākāśa*), time (*kāla*), space or direction (*dik*), self (*ātman*) and mind (*manas*).

ANALYSIS: **Distinction.** A common trap is to forget that **ether, time and direction** are themselves substances, not merely abstract conditions or frameworks within which things happen.

FACT: **Example.** A pot is a substance because colour, number, conjunction and motion can inhere in it.

4. Quality (guṇa): the twenty-four, and the point they make

FACT: **Statement. Quality** is a dependent ontological feature that inheres in a substance but does not itself possess further qualities or actions in the same way.

FACT: The traditional list gives **twenty-four qualities**: colour (*rūpa*), taste (*rasa*), smell (*gandha*), touch (*sparsa*), number (*saṃkhyā*), magnitude (*parimāṇa*), distinctness (*pṛthaktva*), conjunction (*saṃyoga*), disjunction (*vibhāga*), priority or remoteness (*paratva*), posteriority or nearness (*aparatva*), cognition (*buddhi*), pleasure (*sukha*), pain (*duḥkha*), desire (*icchā*), aversion (*dveṣa*), effort (*prayatna*), heaviness (*gurutva*), fluidity (*dravatva*), viscosity (*sneha*), dispositional tendency or momentum (*saṃskāra*), merit (*dharma*), demerit (*adharma*) and sound (*śabda*).

ANALYSIS: **Philosophical significance.** The list is notable because mental items such as **cognition, desire and pleasure are treated as qualities**, not as the essence of the self. That single classification decision is the seed of the school's whole account of the self in Session 12 and of its contrast with Advaita, where consciousness *is* the self's nature.

ANALYSIS: **Two high-value observations hidden in the list.** First, **conjunction and disjunction are qualities**, which is why motion - which produces them - is causally central. Second, **merit and demerit (dharma and adharma) are qualities of the self**, which is how the school locates moral desert inside its ontology without inventing a new category for it.

5. Motion or action (karma): five kinds and why it matters

FACT: **Karma** here means **physical motion or action**, not moral karma.

FACT: Vaiśeṣika recognises **five kinds**: upward movement, downward movement, contraction, expansion, and locomotion or general movement.

FACT: Motion is important because it **generates conjunction and disjunction**, which are central to causation. A weaver's motion brings threads into the conjunction that produces cloth; a blow produces the disjunction that destroys a pot.

ANALYSIS: **Why this earns marks in a causation question.** In Session 14 the second kind of cause - the non-inherent cause - is typically a *conjunction* in the material cause. That conjunction is a quality, and it exists because a motion produced it. The three categories therefore chain directly into the theory of causation rather than sitting inertly in a list.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION

Claim. The first three Vaiśeṣika categories are not an arbitrary partition of the visible world but a functional triad in which each member does work the other two cannot. **Named evidence.** Substance is defined as the locus in which qualities and motions inhere and is enumerated as nine, from earth to mind; quality is defined as what inheres without itself bearing further qualities in the same way and is enumerated as twenty-four, including cognition, pleasure, merit and demerit; motion is enumerated as five and is defined as what produces conjunction and disjunction. **Analysis.** The triad is closed under the school's own explanatory demand: qualities need a bearer, so substance is required; substances need distinguishing features, so quality is required; and change of relation requires an event that is neither a thing nor a feature, so motion is required - and because conjunction and disjunction are themselves qualities produced by motion, the triad already contains the machinery of causation. **Qualification.** The economy is real but not costless: classifying cognition and pleasure as qualities of the self commits the school to a self that can exist without manifest consciousness, and CAUTION: the count of the list itself is disputed, since Kaṇāda's older enumeration is commonly taken as six with absence added later.

UPSC TRAPS - SESSION 3

- ANALYSIS: Listing only seven substances. There are **nine**.

- ANALYSIS: Treating ether, time and direction as abstract frameworks rather than as substances.
- ANALYSIS: Reading *karma* in the category list as moral karma. It is physical motion; merit and demerit are qualities.
- ANALYSIS: Saying consciousness is the essence of the self in this school. It is an **adventitious quality**.
- ANALYSIS: Projecting the seven-category list back onto Kaṇāda without noting CAUTION: that his older enumeration is commonly taken as six.
- ANALYSIS: Forgetting that conjunction and disjunction are qualities, which is the bridge from motion to causation.

RAPID REVISION - SESSION 3

- Seven categories: substance, quality, motion, universal, particularity, inherence, absence.
- Nine substances: earth, water, fire, air, ether, time, direction, self, mind. Four have atoms; three are all-pervading; mind is atomic.
- Twenty-four qualities include cognition, pleasure, pain, desire, aversion, effort, merit, demerit and sound.
- Five motions: up, down, contraction, expansion, locomotion.
- Motion -> conjunction and disjunction -> causation. Mind is atomic -> one cognition at a time.
- CAUTION: Six or seven? Absence is commonly treated as the later seventh.

SESSION 4 - THE ONE IN THE MANY: UNIVERSAL, ITS SIX BLOCKERS, AND ULTIMATE PARTICULARITY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Two problems sit at opposite ends of the same question. Why do completely different cows all count as cows? And why do two atoms that are alike in absolutely every respect still count as two? Vaiśeṣika answers the first with a real universal and the second with a real ultimate particular.

Technical definition: A **universal (sāmānya, also jāti)** is a real, eternal, one-in-many entity present in multiple particulars by inherence and grounding objective classification. **Ultimate particularity (viśeṣa)** is the ultimate individuator residing only in eternal substances - the atoms of earth, water, fire and air, and the eternal instances of ether, time, direction, self and mind. Between them stand the **six blockers of universalhood (jāti-bādhaka)**, the school's internal rules for refusing to admit a proposed universal.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Vaiśeṣika is charged with populating the world with entities, yet it is the only Indian realism that publishes an explicit list of six conditions under which a proposed universal must be *refused* - which is why its realism about universals should be read as a regulated ontology rather than as indiscriminate multiplication.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **universal (sāmānya / jāti)** - real, eternal, one-in-many
- **higher and lower (para and apara)** - the ordering of universals by extension
- **exclusion theory (apoha)** - the Buddhist rival: "cow" means "not non-cow"
- **six blockers of universalhood (jāti-bādhaka)** - the six refusals
- **imposed property or limiting adjunct (upādhi)** - what a blocked universal is downgraded to
- **ultimate particularity (viśeṣa)** - the individuator of eternal reals
- **self-differentiating (svato-vyāvartaka)** - how the regress of individuators is stopped

How to use them: whenever a question presses the charge of ontological excess, name at least two blockers by function. The examiner is testing whether you know the school polices itself, not whether you can transliterate six Sanskrit words.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

TWO OPPOSITE PUZZLES, ONE ONTOLOGY

PUZZLE 1: SAMENESS

A black cow, a white cow, a calf.
Utterly unlike in colour and size.
Yet all are "cow".

|
v

Something real must be shared.

-> UNIVERSAL (sāmānya)

|

+-----> and in between: <-----+

SIX RULES FOR SAYING "NO"

Not every general word names a real universal. If admitting one would give a single instance, or duplicate an existing universal, or cross-cut another, or start an endless series, or destroy the thing's own function, or lack a relation to attach by - then it is refused and downgraded to a mere imposed property (upādhi).

PUZZLE 2: DIFFERENCE

Two atoms of earth. Same kind,
same size, same everything.
Yet they are two, not one.

|
v

Something real must separate them.

-> ULTIMATE PARTICULARITY (viśeṣa)

|

In simple words: you can say "cook", "Indian" or "thing that I saw yesterday". Vaiśeṣika will not give you a universal for any of those. It gives you a real universal only when the classification is objective, plural, non-overlapping, non-regressive, harmless to its bearer and actually attachable. Everything else is a label. The Buddhists say *all* of it is a label; the six blockers are Vaiśeṣika's evidence that it is not simply saying yes to everything.

Remember first	Meaning
Universal	One eternal entity present in many, by inherence, not by being cut into pieces
Higher / lower	<i>Para</i> has the widest extension; <i>apara</i> is narrower
Blocker	A rule that refuses universalhood to a proposed class
Imposed property	What a refused candidate becomes: a limiting adjunct, not a new category
Particularity	The individuator; it differentiates <i>itself</i> as well as its bearer

One-line memory: universals explain why many things are one kind; particularities explain why one kind can still be many things.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE SIX BLOCKERS AS SIX REFUSAL TESTS

CANDIDATE UNIVERSAL ARRIVES -> RUN SIX TESTS -> ACCEPT (jāti) or REFUSE (upādhi)

TEST 1	Does it have more than one instance?	NO -> BLOCKED
	▸ vyakter abhedah - no single-instance universal	
	▸ ether-ness (ākāśatva) blocked if there is only one ether	

TEST 2	Is there already a co-extensive universal?	YES -> BLOCKED
	▸ tulyatvam - do not admit two universals over exactly the same class	
	▸ pot-ness (ghaṭatva) and jar-ness (kalaśatva) over one class	

TEST 3	Does it partially overlap another universal?	YES -> BLOCKED
	▸ saṅkaraḥ - universals must be nested or disjoint, never cross-cutting	
	▸ the standard case: elemental-ness (bhūtatva) and corporeal-ness (mūrtatva)	

TEST 4	Would admitting it start an endless series?	YES -> BLOCKED
	▸ anavasthā - no universal over universals	
	▸ universal-ness (jātitva) would need a universal of universal-ness...	

TEST 5	Would it destroy its bearer's own function?	YES -> BLOCKED
	▸ rūpahāniḥ - form-loss	
	▸ a universal inside particularities would defeat their whole job of ultimate individuation	

TEST 6	Is there a relation available to attach it?	NO -> BLOCKED
	▸ asambandhaḥ - universals attach by inheritance, but inheritance itself has no further inheritance, so inheritance-ness (samavāyatva) is refused	

RESULT:	real universals are admitted; the rest survive only as imposed properties - and the Buddhist charge of "bloated realism" is answered from inside the system, not by assertion.	

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The six tests are the answer to the most frequent evaluative demand on this topic. Stated as tests rather than as a list, they demonstrate the school's economy in the same breath as they demonstrate its realism.

1. Universal (sāmānya): statement, argument, presupposition, example

FACT: **Statement.** Sāmānya is the real universal: one-in-many, eternal, and present in multiple particulars. Universals may be ordered as **higher (para)** and **lower (apara)** by extension - being-ness is the widest, cow-ness narrower.

FACT: **Argument.**

1. We genuinely classify many individuals under one concept: "cow", "pot", "substance".
2. Mere resemblance is insufficient unless some objective commonness grounds the classification.
3. Therefore a universal must be real.

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition.** The argument presupposes **realist semantics**: common predication reflects objective common structure in the world. State this presupposition explicitly - evaluative questions on the ontological status of the universal are really questions about whether this presupposition can be granted.

FACT: **Distinction.** Vaiśeṣika realism here opposes the Buddhist **exclusion theory (apoha)**, which explains universals through exclusion of the other rather than through real common entities: "cow" means "not non-cow".

FACT: **Example.** "Cow-ness" is one universal present in many cows.

CAUTION: **Objection.** If the universal is one, how can it be wholly present in many places?

FACT: **Reply.** The universal is not spatially divided like a physical thing. It is a single eternal entity **instantiated in many particulars through inheritance (samavāya)**. The objection assumes that presence must be spatial containment; inheritance is precisely the relation that is not spatial containment.

2. The six blockers of universalhood, stated as rules

FACT: **Statement.** Not every general term names a real universal. Where a proposed universal is blocked, Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika treats it as an **imposed property or limiting adjunct (upādhi)**, not as a new category.

ANALYSIS: **Philosophical function.** The six blockers are the school's internal discipline against a bloated ontology of universals.

Blocker	Rule	Exam example and payoff
FACT: no single instance (vyakter abhedah)	A universal cannot have only one instance, because universalhood requires a plurality of loci.	Ether-ness (ākāśatva) is blocked if there is only one ether.
FACT: co-extensiveness (tulyatvam)	Two exactly co-extensive putative universals should not both be admitted.	If pot-ness (ghaṭatva) and jar-ness (kalaśatva) both cover the same class, there is no ground for two universals.
FACT: cross-cutting (saṅkaraḥ)	Two universals cannot partially overlap without one being included in the other; they must be nested or disjoint.	The standard case is elemental-ness (bhūtatva) and corporeal-ness (mūrtatva) , where cross-connection would confuse the hierarchy of kinds.
FACT: infinite regress (anavasthā)	Universalhood itself cannot be a further universal in universals, because that would demand another universal of universalhood without end.	Universal-ness (jātitva) as a universal over universals is blocked by regress.
FACT: form-loss (rūpahāniḥ)	A universal is blocked where admitting it destroys the very form or function of the entity concerned.	A universal residing in particularities (viśeṣa) would defeat particularity's function of ultimate individuation.
FACT: no available relation (asambandhaḥ)	A universal must inhere in its instances by inherence, but inherence itself has no further inherence to connect it with a universal.	Inherence-ness (samavāyatva) cannot be admitted as a real universal without relation-regress.

FACT: **Buddhist objection.** Dignāga- and Dharmakīrti-style **exclusion theory** argues that universals are unperceived, causally inert, and cannot be wholly present in many places at once.

FACT: **Nyāya reply.** Universals **are** perceived, in determinate perception (*savikalpaka-pratyakṣa*) such as "this is a cow"; their presence is by inherence, not by spatial containment; and exclusion is circular, because excluding non-cows presupposes a stable cow-class or at least stable exclusion-domains.

ANALYSIS: **Exam payoff.** The blockers let Nyāya answer the Buddhist charge of ontological excess: realism about universals is **not** indiscriminate multiplication.

3. Ultimate particularity (viśeṣa): statement, function, and the school's own name

FACT: **Statement.** **Viśeṣa** is the ultimate individuator residing only in **eternal** substances: the atoms of earth, water, fire and air, and the eternal instances of ether, time, direction, self and mind.

FACT: **Function.** Two atoms of earth may be alike in all universals and all ordinary qualities. Without particularity they would be indistinguishable and, by the identity of indiscernibles, would collapse into one.

FACT: **School-name significance.** Particularity gives the *Vaiśeṣika* school its name, because the system explains plurality through irreducible particularity.

ANALYSIS: **Scope caution.** Particularity resides in eternal substances only. Non-eternal composites - a pot, a cloth, a body - are individuated by their parts, their qualities, their place and their causal history, so they need no *viśeṣa*. Getting this scope right is a fast way to show technical control.

4. Two objections to particularity, and their exact residual force

FACT: **Objection: the regress of differentiators.** If particularity differentiates one atom from another, what differentiates one particularity from another? A further particularity would be needed, and so on without end.

FACT: **Reply.** Particularities are **self-differentiating (svato-vyāvartaka)**: they distinguish both their loci and themselves by their own nature.

ANALYSIS: **Residual force.** Critics argue that "self-differentiating" names the stopping point rather than proving it; particularity is a **stipulated terminus** of individuation.

FACT: **Objection: the imperceptible ontological IOU.** Particularity is imperceptible and appears to be posited solely to do the explanatory job of individuating exactly similar eternal.

FACT: **Reply.** Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika frames the posit **inferentially**: the plurality of exactly similar eternal substances is otherwise inexplicable. Note the consistency point - Nyāya reduces postulation (*arthāpatti*) to inference rather than making it a separate means of valid knowledge, so this is an inference, not a smuggled fifth instrument.

ANALYSIS: **Comparative note.** Jaina, Buddhist and Advaita critiques often target particularity and inherence as the **weakest joints** of the system. Śrīharṣa's *Khaṇḍanakhaṇḍakhādyā* attacks Nyāya definitions systematically.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION

Claim. The universal and ultimate particularity are the two halves of a single answer to the problem of the one and the many, and neither can be evaluated without the other. **Named evidence.** The universal is admitted because common predication over dissimilar individuals - a black cow and a white calf are both cows - requires an objective ground, and it inheres rather than being spatially divided; particularity is admitted because two atoms of earth alike in every universal and quality would otherwise collapse into one by the identity of indiscernibles, and it is said to be self-differentiating. **Analysis.** The pair is symmetrical in structure and in vulnerability: each is an unperceived posit justified by an inference from an otherwise inexplicable feature of experience, and each terminates a threatened regress by declaring itself the stopping point - the universal by inhering without being contained, particularity by differentiating itself. **Qualification.** The six blockers show that the realism is regulated rather than promiscuous, but CAUTION: the charge that self-differentiation names the terminus instead of proving it is not answered, which is why Buddhist exclusion theory and Śrīharṣa's dialectic remain live rather than defeated.

UPSC TRAPS - SESSION 4

- ANALYSIS: Saying universals are not perceived in Nyāya. They **are**, in determinate perception and through universal-mediated extraordinary perception.
- ANALYSIS: Explaining the presence of one universal in many by spatial division. It is by **inherence**.
- ANALYSIS: Assigning particularity to ordinary composite objects. It resides only in **eternal** substances.
- ANALYSIS: Presenting the six blockers as six types of universal. They are six grounds of **refusal**.
- ANALYSIS: Treating the regress objection as answered rather than stopped. Say "stipulated terminus", and the answer becomes evaluative.
- ANALYSIS: Confusing *jāti* as universal here with *jāti* as futile rejoinder in the sixteen topics.

RAPID REVISION - SESSION 4

- Universal = one-in-many, eternal, present by inherence; ordered as higher and lower.
- Argument: real classification needs an objective ground; resemblance alone is not enough.
- Six blockers: single instance · co-extensiveness · cross-cutting · regress · form-loss · no relation.
- Blocked candidates become imposed properties (*upādhi*), not new categories.
- Particularity individuates **eternal** substances only; it is self-differentiating; it names the school.
- Both universal and particularity are stipulated termini - that is the evaluative line to write.

SESSION 5 - THE GLUE: INHERENCE VERSUS CONJUNCTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A book lies on a table and the table is brown. Both look like "something related to something". Vaiśeṣika insists they are two utterly different relations - one you could undo by lifting the book, the other you could not undo at all without destroying the table.

Technical definition: **Inherence (samavāya)** is the eternal, single, imperceptible-yet-inferred **inseparable relation (ayutasiddha-sambandha)** that holds where the relata cannot be established as separable in the relevant ontological mode. **Conjunction (saṃyoga)** is by contrast a **quality (guṇa)**, produced and destructible, holding between relata that can exist separately.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The difference between a book resting on a table and the brownness belonging to it is not a difference of degree of attachment but of ontological kind: one relation is a producible, destructible quality, the other is the eternal tie without which a quality could not be *of* anything at all.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **inherence (samavāya)** - eternal, one, inseparable, inferred
- **conjunction (saṃyoga)** - a quality; produced, destructible, separable relata
- **inseparability (ayutasiddhatva)** - the defining condition, necessary but contested as sufficient
- **self-linking relation (svarūpa-sambandha)** - how the relation-regress is stopped
- **five inherence pairs** - part-whole, substance-quality, substance-motion, universal-particular, eternal substance-its particularity
- **infinite regress (anavasthā)** - the standing threat to any relational realism

How to use them: the 2018 and 2021 questions both hinge on one sentence - *inseparability is the criterion, not closeness*. Write that sentence early and everything after it reads as demonstration.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

THE TABLE TEST

(i) THE BROWN COLOUR OF THE TABLE
Can you take the brown away and still have the table there?
NO - a colourless table of that kind is not available

↓
relata are INSEPARABLE (ayutasiddha)

↓
INHERENCE (samavāya)
• eternal as a relation
• a category of its own
• imperceptible, inferred

(ii) THE BOOK ON THE TABLE
Can you take the book away and still have the table there?
YES - trivially

↓
relata are SEPARABLE (yutasiddha)

↓
CONJUNCTION (saṃyoga)
• produced and destroyed
• merely a QUALITY (guṇa)
• ordinarily perceptible in effect

WRONG CRITERION: "the book is only touching, the colour is really stuck on".

RIGHT CRITERION: ontological inseparability and the category-relation of the relata.

In simple words: the temptation is to grade relations by how hard they are to pull apart - glue is stronger than resting. Vaiśeṣika refuses that. Its question is not "how firmly?" but "could these two have been established separately at all?" Threads can exist without the cloth; the cloth cannot be established apart from the threads, so the whole inheres in its parts. Nothing about physical force enters the criterion.

Remember first	Meaning
Inherence	A category; eternal; one; not perceived but inferred
Conjunction	A quality; produced; destructible; separable relata
The five pairs	whole-parts · quality-substance · motion-substance · universal-particular · particularity-eternal substance
Criterion	Inseparability of the relata, not spatial closeness or physical grip
Standing threat	If a relation needs a relation, regress follows

One-line memory: conjunction is something that *happens to* two things; inherence is what makes one of them *be a feature of* the other.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE FIVE INHERENCE PAIRS AND THE ONE IMPOSTOR

WHERE INHERENCE OPERATES (five standard pairs)

whole <- parts	cloth inheres in its threads
quality <- substance	brownness inheres in the table
motion <- substance	the rising inheres in the hand that rises
universal <- particular	cow-ness inheres in each cow
particularity <- eternal substance	this atom's viśeṣa inheres in it

WHERE IT DOES NOT (the impostor)

substance - substance	book and table: CONJUNCTION, a quality
	two pots touching: CONJUNCTION

THE COMPARISON EXAMINERS ASK FOR

	INHERENCE (samavāya)	CONJUNCTION (saṃyoga)
ontological rank	a category (padārtha)	a quality (guṇa)
relata	inseparable	separable
production	eternal as a relation	produced and destructible
number	ONE, not locally multiplied	many, one per contact
epistemic access	inferred	effects ordinarily evident
example	colour in cloth; whole in parts	book on table; two pots in contact

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The five-pair box and the six-row comparison together answer the 2018 question and half of the 2021 question. The row that most often decides the mark is "ontological rank": conjunction is *inside* the category of quality, whereas inherence is a category in its own right.

1. Inherence: statement and scope

FACT: **Statement.** **Samavāya** is the eternal, single, imperceptible-yet-inferred inseparable relation (*ayutasiddha-sambandha*) that holds where relata cannot be established as separable in the relevant ontological mode.

FACT: **Scope.** It holds between five standard pairs: part-whole, substance-quality, substance-motion, universal-particular, and eternal substance-its ultimate particularity.

ANALYSIS: **The "all-pervading" sense.** Later exposition calls inherence one and not locally multiplied. "All-pervading" should be read as **one relation operating wherever the required relata obtain**, not as a tenth spatial substance. This is a genuine trap: a script that treats inherence as a kind of universal ether has misunderstood the category.

2. Inherence versus conjunction, tabulated

Relation	Status	Relata	Production and destruction	Example
FACT: inherence (samavāya)	FACT: Inseparable relation; a category	FACT: Inseparable (<i>ayutasiddha</i>) relata	FACT: Eternal as a relation	FACT: Colour in cloth; whole in parts
FACT: conjunction (saṃyoga)	FACT: A quality (<i>guṇa</i>)	FACT: Separable relata	FACT: Produced and destructible	FACT: Book on table; two pots in contact

3. The inseparability question the 2021 paper actually asks

FACT: **Statement of the issue.** Inseparability (*ayutasiddhatva*) is **necessary** for inherence.

ANALYSIS: **But it is not by itself sufficient** unless the specific ontological dependence relation is shown. Mere closeness is not inherence, and even mere inseparability in some loose sense does not by itself deliver the categorial tie.

ANALYSIS: **How to argue it.** The defining characteristic (*lakṣaṇa*) of a category must be free of three faults: it must not be too narrow (*avyāpti*), too wide (*ativyāpti*) or impossible (*asambhava*). Inseparability alone risks being **too wide**, because it can be satisfied by cases that are not the categorial relation of dependent to locus. The safe verdict is therefore: **necessary, and sufficient only when conjoined with the specific ontological dependence of the**

relata.

ANALYSIS: **Why an examiner sets this.** The question is testing whether a candidate can distinguish a *necessary condition* from a *definition*. A script that simply asserts "inseparability defines inherence" has answered the easier question that was not asked.

4. The relation-regress and the school's stopping move

FACT: **Objection.** If inherence relates A and B, a further relation seems to be needed to relate inherence itself to A and to B, generating **infinite regress (anavasthā)**.

FACT: **Reply.** Inherence is a **self-linking relation (svarūpa-sambandha)**: it relates by its own nature and needs no further relator.

ANALYSIS: **Residual force.** This is a **stipulated terminus**. Every relational ontology must stop somewhere; but critics - Buddhists and Śrīharṣa in particular - press the charge that Nyāya stops the regress here while using regress as a weapon against opponents elsewhere (as in the fourth blocker of universalhood). The charge is of inconsistency in the use of a method, not merely of stopping.

ANALYSIS: **Controlled comparison flag.** The issue resembles **Bradley's regress** in Western metaphysics, but that comparison belongs only *after* the Indian argument is complete, and at most in one line.

5. One inherence or many? - parsimony and its cost

FACT: **Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika position.** Inherence is **one** and eternal. Parsimony is the Vaiśeṣika reason for not multiplying inherence-relations.

ANALYSIS: **Internal difficulty.** If inherence is one, it is hard to explain why it relates *this* quality to *this* substance rather than to all substances indiscriminately.

ANALYSIS: **Reply.** The **relata themselves determine the relation's operation**: inherence is not free-floating glue but the inseparable tie manifest only where the relevant terms exist.

ANALYSIS: **Evaluative line worth writing.** Vaiśeṣika buys economy at the top of the ontology and pays for it at the level of explanation - one relation is cheaper than many, but a single relation must then borrow its specificity entirely from its relata.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION

Claim. Vaiśeṣika distinguishes inherence from conjunction by ontological status rather than by degree of attachment, and the distinction carries the weight of the whole category scheme. **Named evidence.** The brown colour of the table inheres in it through inherence, an inseparable relation of quality to substance; the book stands on the table through conjunction, which is not a category at all but one of the twenty-four qualities, produced by motion and destroyed by motion. **Analysis.** Because conjunction is itself a quality, it must inhere in its substances - so conjunction presupposes inherence and cannot replace it, which is precisely why the school treats inherence as a separate category rather than reducing all relation to contact. **Qualification.** Inseparability is necessary but ANALYSIS: not obviously sufficient as a defining characteristic, and the reply to the relation-regress - that inherence is self-linking - is a stipulated terminus that Buddhist and Advaitin critics regard as a stopping point rather than a proof.

UPSC TRAPS - SESSION 5

- ANALYSIS: Using spatial closeness or physical grip as the criterion. The criterion is ontological inseparability.
- ANALYSIS: Calling conjunction a category. It is a **quality**, one of the twenty-four.
- ANALYSIS: Saying inseparability is the full definition of inherence. It is necessary; sufficiency requires the specific dependence relation.
- ANALYSIS: Treating "all-pervading inherence" as a tenth substance filling space.
- ANALYSIS: Claiming the regress is refuted. It is stopped by declaring inherence self-linking - say so and evaluate it.
- ANALYSIS: Introducing Bradley before the Indian argument is complete.

RAPID REVISION - SESSION 5

- Inherence: category, eternal, one, inseparable relata, inferred. Conjunction: quality, produced, destructible, separable relata.
- Five pairs: whole-parts, quality-substance, motion-substance, universal-particular, particularity-eternal substance.
- 2018 answer in one line: brown colour = inherence; book on table = conjunction; criterion is inseparability, not closeness.
- 2021 answer in one line: inseparability is necessary, not by itself sufficient - otherwise the defining characteristic is too wide.
- Regress stopped by self-linking relation (*svarūpa-sambandha*); critics call this a stipulated terminus.
- Conjunction presupposes inherence, since a quality must inhere - that is the strongest pro-inherence argument.

SESSION 6 - NEGATIVE FACTS: THE FOUR ABSENCES AND HOW ABSENCE IS KNOWN

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: "There is no jar on the table" is true. Vaiśeṣika takes that seriously enough to say the world contains not only jars and tables but also jar-absences - and then has to explain how you could possibly perceive one.

Technical definition: **Absence (abhāva)** is the seventh category, the category of non-existence. It is admitted in four kinds: **prior non-existence (prāgabhāva)**, **posterior non-existence or destruction (pradhvaṃsābhāva)**, **absolute non-existence (atyantābhāva)** and **mutual non-existence or difference (anyonyābhāva)**. Every absence is structurally the absence of something, its **counterpositive (pratiyogin)**, in a **locus (anuyogin)**.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Vaiśeṣika's seventh category is the point at which its realism becomes uncomfortable and interesting at once: rather than treat negation as a merely linguistic operation, it treats absence as a structured feature of the world with a locus and a counterpositive - which is why absolute negation, negation of nothing in particular, is declared impossible.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **absence (abhāva)** - the seventh category
- **counterpositive (pratiyogin)** - the positive term whose absence is cognised
- **locus (anuyogin)** - the place qualified by the absence
- **prior (prāgabhāva) · posterior (pradhvaṃsābhāva) · absolute (atyantābhāva) · mutual (anyonyābhāva)**
- **qualifier-qualified relation (viśeṣaṇa-viśeṣya-bhāva)** - the sixth sense-object contact, by which absence is perceived
- **non-cognition (anupalabdhi)** - the Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā rival that Nyāya refuses to admit as independent

How to use them: the 2023 stem quotes "Negation always has a counterpositive and absolute negation is an impossibility." Decode it before answering: the first clause asserts structure, the second denies contentless negation. That decoding *is* the introduction.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

FOUR WAYS SOMETHING CAN BE MISSING

BEFORE it is made

```
[
| prior absence
| (prāgabhāva)
| no beginning
| ENDS when the
| thing is made
|
+-----]
```

AFTER it is destroyed

```
[
| posterior
| absence
| (pradhvaṃsā-)
| BEGINS at
| destruction,
| never ends
|
+-----]
```

NEVER there at all

```
[
| absolute
| absence
| (atyantābhāva)
| no beginning,
| no end
| hare's horn
|
+-----]
```

... and a fourth, which is not about time at all:

```
[-----]
| mutual absence (anyonyābhāva) = DIFFERENCE
| "a pot is not a cloth" - neither has ever been the other
|
+-----]
```

NOTE THE ASYMMETRY THAT EXAMINERS LOVE:

prior absence : no beginning, HAS an end
 posterior : HAS a beginning, no end
 absolute : neither beginning nor end

In simple words: three of the four absences are about *time* - before, after, and never. The fourth is about *identity* - this is not that. Once you see that split, the 2024 question answers itself, because "air does not have heat" is a temporal-locus claim about a missing quality while "air is not fire" is an identity claim about two different substances.

Remember first	Meaning
Counterpositive	The thing that is missing - the jar, the heat, the fire
Locus	Where it is missing from - the table, the air
Prior	Absent before production; ends with production
Posterior	Absent after destruction; begins with destruction
Absolute	Absent in that locus for all time - hare's horn
Mutual	Difference; "a pot is not a cloth"

One-line memory: three absences answer "when?", one answers "which?" - and every one of them answers "of what?"

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE 2024 DISCRIMINATION, DRAWN

SENTENCE 1: "AIR DOES NOT HAVE HEAT"

LOCUS (anuyogin)	air, a substance
COUNTERPOSITIVE (pratiyogin)	heat, a QUALITY
CLAIM SHAPE	a quality does not reside in this locus, and never will
VERDICT	ABSOLUTE ABSENCE (atyantābhāva) of heat with respect to air

NOT THE SAME AS

SENTENCE 2: "AIR IS NOT FIRE"

LOCUS	air, a substance
COUNTERPOSITIVE	fire, another SUBSTANCE
CLAIM SHAPE	two entities are not identical
VERDICT	MUTUAL ABSENCE (anyonyābhāva) = difference, not qualification

THE DECIDING TEST

Is the missing item a QUALITY that could have qualified the locus? -> absolute

Is the missing item ANOTHER ENTITY that the locus could be mistaken for being identical with? -> mutual

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The 2024 question is decided by one structural observation: absolute absence denies a *qualification*, mutual absence denies an *identity*. Draw the two boxes in the answer booklet and the discrimination is visible before a word of prose is written.

1. Absence: statement and the four kinds

FACT: **Statement. Abhāva** is the category of absence or non-existence. Four kinds are recognised: prior non-existence, posterior non-existence, absolute non-existence and mutual non-existence.

FACT: **(a) Prior non-existence (prāgabhāva).** The non-existence of an effect **before** its production. It has **no beginning**, but **ends** when the effect is produced.

FACT: **(b) Posterior non-existence (pradhvaṃsābhāva).** The non-existence of a thing **after** its destruction. It **begins** with destruction and has **no end**.

FACT: **(c) Absolute non-existence (atyantābhāva).** A thing is absent in a locus **for all times**. Standard example: a hare's horn.

FACT: **(d) Mutual non-existence (anyonyābhāva).** Reciprocal difference. "A pot is not a cloth" means pot and cloth are different entities.

2. The 2024 discrimination, argued

FACT: "Air does not have heat" is best treated as **absolute absence** with respect to heat in air.

FACT: "Air is not fire" is **mutual absence**, because it expresses **difference** between two entities.

ANALYSIS: Therefore they are **not** the same kind of absence, and the correct answer to the 2024 question is a reasoned "no" rather than a hedge.

ANALYSIS: **The refinement that lifts the mark.** In the Vaiśeṣika scheme heat (*uṣṇa-sparśa*, hot touch) is the characteristic touch of fire, so its absence in air is not a contingent shortage that could be remedied - it is a permanent categorial absence of a quality in a locus. That is exactly why it is absolute absence and not merely a temporary one.

3. The 2023 counterpositive issue and why absolute negation is impossible

FACT: Every absence is the absence **of** something; that absent positive term is the **counterpositive (pratiyogin)**.

ANALYSIS: This shows absence is **not sheer blankness**: it has structured, intentional content.

ANALYSIS: **How to decode the printed statement.** "Negation always has a counterpositive" asserts that every negative cognition is directed at a determinate positive term. "Absolute negation is an impossibility" then follows as a corollary: a negation of *nothing in particular*, with no counterpositive and no locus, would have no content and could not be a cognition at all. Note carefully that this does **not** deny **absolute absence (atyantābhāva)**, which is a perfectly admitted kind with a determinate counterpositive. The two must not be conflated: the impossible thing is contentless negation, not permanent absence.

4. How absence is known - and why Nyāya refuses a fifth instrument

FACT: In the cognition "there is no jar on the table", the **table is the locus (anuyogin)** and the **jar is the counterpositive (pratiyogin)** whose absence qualifies that locus.

FACT: Nyāya does **not** require an independent means of valid knowledge called non-cognition. Under suitable conditions, the same perceptual situation that presents the empty locus presents jar-absence through the **qualifier-qualified relation (viśeṣaṇa-viśeṣya-bhāva)** - the sixth of the six sense-object contacts listed in Session 7.

FACT: **The four conditions that must hold.** Adequate absence-cognition presupposes that (i) the object would have been perceptible if present, (ii) the locus is available, (iii) the senses are competent, and (iv) no obstruction prevents observation. Where these fail, the cognition fails - which is why one cannot perceive the absence of a ghost.

FACT: If the missing item is itself inferential rather than perceptible, its absence may also be **inferentially** established.

FACT: **The Buddhist half of the 2018 question.** The Buddhist denies the need for a separately existing negative entity and explains the judgement through perception of the positive locus plus non-apprehension, conceptual exclusion or inference. The disagreement is therefore **ontological before it is epistemological**: the Buddhist objects to admitting absence as a real category at all, and only then to the machinery for perceiving it.

ANALYSIS: **Cross-owner boundary. Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā owns non-cognition (anupalabdhi) as an independent means of valid knowledge**; Nyāya reduces the work to perception or inference. Naming this boundary is what makes the 2018 answer look controlled rather than partisan.

5. Why absence earns its place as a category (the 2019 demand)

ANALYSIS: The justification runs in four steps, and each step is a mark:

1. **Cognitive datum.** Negative judgements - "no jar here", "the pot is not a cloth" - are experienced as true or false, so they have determinate content.
2. **Realist semantics.** In this school a determinate cognition is of something real; a merely linguistic account would break the correspondence that the whole system relies on.
3. **Explanatory necessity.** Prior absence is needed by the theory of causation (Session 14), where it is the weapon against the pre-existence of the effect; posterior absence is needed by destruction; difference is needed by every discrimination.
4. **Economy check.** Absence is admitted as **one** category with four kinds rather than as many positive entities, and it is known by existing instruments rather than by a new one - so admitting it does not breach the school's parsimony.

ANALYSIS: **The honest cost.** CAUTION: Kaṇāda's own enumeration is commonly taken as six categories, with absence added later. An answer that states the four-step justification *and* concedes this historical point is doing exactly what "justify the status of *abhāva* as a category" asks for.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION

Claim. Absence earns categorial status in Vaiśeṣika because negative cognition has determinate structure, not because the school is careless about multiplying entities. **Named evidence.** Every absence has a counterpositive and a locus, so "no jar on the table" is the table qualified by jar-absence; the four kinds are distinguished by exact temporal signatures - prior absence has no beginning but an end, posterior absence has a beginning but no end, absolute absence has neither - while mutual absence is difference rather than a temporal notion at all. **Analysis.** The structure is doing explanatory work elsewhere in the system: prior absence is the instrument by which the school refutes the pre-existence of the effect, and the qualifier-qualified contact allows the absence to be perceived by an existing instrument rather than by a new one, so the category is admitted without a corresponding inflation of the means of valid knowledge. **Qualification.** CAUTION: The historical enumeration is contested, since Kaṇāda's older list is commonly taken as six with absence added later, and Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā's independent instrument of non-cognition remains a live rival account of the same cognitive datum.

UPSC TRAPS - SESSION 6

- ANALYSIS: Confusing **absolute absence** (an admitted kind) with **absolute negation** (declared impossible because contentless).

- ANALYSIS: Saying "air does not have heat" and "air is not fire" are the same absence. They are absolute and mutual respectively.
- ANALYSIS: Reversing the temporal signatures: prior absence *ends*, posterior absence *begins*.
- ANALYSIS: Attributing non-cognition (*anupalabdhi*) to Nyāya as an independent means of valid knowledge. That is Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā.
- ANALYSIS: Forgetting the four conditions of absence-perception, which is where the "why can't I perceive the absence of a ghost?" objection is answered.
- ANALYSIS: Treating absence as sheer blankness rather than as structured content with a counterpositive.

RAPID REVISION - SESSION 6

- Four absences: prior (ends), posterior (begins), absolute (neither), mutual (difference).
- Structure: locus (*anuyogin*) + counterpositive (*pratiyogin*). No counterpositive => no negation.
- 2024: heat-in-air = absolute; air/fire = mutual. Quality-denial versus identity-denial.
- 2023: "absolute negation impossible" = contentless negation impossible, **not** absolute absence denied.
- 2018: Nyāya perceives absence by the qualifier-qualified contact; Buddhists explain it away; Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā uses non-cognition.
- 2019 justification: determinate negative cognition + realist semantics + explanatory work + parsimony, with CAUTION: the six/seven history conceded.

SESSION 7 - THE FOUR MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE AND GAUTAMA'S DEFINITION OF PERCEPTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Nyāya says there are exactly four legitimate routes to knowing - seeing it, working it out from a sign, learning a word by resemblance, and being told by someone trustworthy. Everything else is either one of these in disguise, or not knowledge at all.

Technical definition: A **means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)** is the instrument or operative causal complex that produces **valid cognition (pramā)**. Nyāya recognises four: **perception (pratyakṣa)**, **inference (anumāna)**, **comparison (upamāna)** and **testimony (śabda)**. Perception is defined by Gautama as cognition **produced from sense-object contact (indriyārtha-sannikarṣa)**, **non-verbal (avyapadeśya)**, **non-errant (avyabhicāri)** and **determinate (vyavasāyātmaka)**.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Gautama's definition of perception is not a description but a set of four exclusions, each of which throws out a specific rival candidate - and the mark in a question on it is earned by naming what each clause is designed to exclude rather than by translating the clause.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)** · **valid cognition (pramā)**
- **sense-object contact (indriyārtha-sannikarṣa)** - the generative condition
- **non-verbal (avyapadeśya)** · **non-errant (avyabhicāri)** · **determinate (vyavasāyātmaka)**
- **indeterminate (nirvikalpaka)** and **determinate (savikalpaka)** perception
- **six sense-object contacts (sannikarṣa)**
- **extraordinary perception (alaukika)** - universal-mediated, cognition-mediated, yogic

How to use them: for the 2025 twenty-marker, the structure is fixed for you by the definition itself. One paragraph per clause, one sentence per exclusion, then the indeterminate/determinate tension, then the six contacts, then extraordinary perception. Nothing else is needed and nothing may be dropped.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

FOUR DOORS INTO KNOWLEDGE - AND WHAT EACH ONE IS FOR

[PERCEPTION (pratyakṣa) -----] "I see the pot." sense touches object -> cognition ▶ the only instrument that gives the object itself, directly +-----+
[INFERENCE (anumāna) -----] "Smoke there, so fire there." sign + known invariable link ▶ reaches what is currently out of sensory range +-----+
[COMPARISON (upamāna) -----] "So THAT is what 'gavaya' means." description + resemblance ▶ fixes the word-object link; a semantic instrument +-----+
[TESTIMONY (śabda) -----] "A reliable person says so." trustworthy utterance, understood ▶ reaches what no individual could verify personally +-----+

COUNT CAUTION: four is the NYĀYA count.

Classical Vaiśeṣika keeps two - perception and inference - and folds comparison and testimony into inference. The mature synthesis follows Nyāya.

In simple words: each door exists because the previous one has a limit. Perception cannot reach the far side of a hill, so inference is needed. Inference cannot tell you which animal a new word names, so comparison is needed. Neither can tell you what happened before you were born or what a ritual accomplishes, so testimony is needed. The four are a division of labour, not four synonyms for "evidence".

Remember first	Meaning
<i>Pramāṇa</i>	The instrument, not the result
<i>Pramā</i>	The result: valid cognition
Four	Nyāya's count; classical Vaiśeṣika keeps two
Not a <i>pramāṇa</i>	Memory - it reproduces, it does not generate
Not a <i>pramāṇa</i>	Hypothetical reasoning (<i>tarka</i>) - it assists, it does not prove

One-line memory: perception gives you the thing, inference gives you the hidden, comparison gives you the word, testimony gives you what only another could know.

VISUAL: VISUAL - GAUTAMA'S DEFINITION AS FOUR EXCLUSION GATES

A CANDIDATE COGNITION ARRIVES. FOUR GATES DECIDE WHETHER IT IS PERCEPTION.

GATE 1	PRODUCED FROM SENSE-OBJECT CONTACT (indriyārtha-sannikarṣa-utpanna) EXCLUDES: inference, memory, testimony - none is generated by a present sense-object relation ▼
GATE 2	NON-VERBAL (avyapadeśya) EXCLUDES: knowledge constituted by words as words, i.e. testimony ANALYSIS: it does NOT exclude determinate perception that happens to be expressible in words ▼
GATE 3	NON-ERRANT (avyabhicāri) EXCLUDES: illusion - shell seen as silver is not valid perception ANALYSIS: error still needs its own theory: see Session 11 ▼
GATE 4	DETERMINATE (vyavasāyātmaka) EXCLUDES: doubt - "is that a post or a man?" is not perception CAUTION: raises the internal question of how the admitted INDETERMINATE (nirvikalpaka) stage can also be perception ▼
	VALID PERCEPTION (pratyakṣa-pramā)

ANALYSIS: Caption. Each gate is an exclusion, and each exclusion names a rival. Gate 1 excludes the other three instruments, gate 2 excludes testimony specifically, gate 3 excludes illusion, and gate 4 excludes doubt - while opening the one internal tension the tradition itself had to resolve.

1. The four means of valid knowledge, and the count caution

FACT: Nyāya recognises four: perception (*pratyakṣa*), inference (*anumāna*), comparison (*upamāna*) and testimony (*śabda*).

FACT: **Classical Vaiśeṣika recognises perception and inference** and reduces comparison and testimony to inferential knowledge; the later combined system normally follows Nyāya's fourfold scheme.

ANALYSIS: **Comparative bearing.** Sāṃkhya and Yoga usually accept three; Mīmāṃsā sub-schools accept more, classically adding **postulation (arthāpatti)** and, for Bhāṭṭa, **non-cognition (anupalabdhi)**; Advaita's standard later account gives six; Cārvāka accepts perception alone; Buddhist epistemologists accept two. **Nyāya reduces postulation to inference and non-cognition to perception or inference** - that reduction is the school's characteristic move and should be named whenever a comparative question is asked.

2. Gautama's definition and its clause-by-clause analysis

FACT: The classical Nyāya definition states in substance: "**indriyārtha-sannikarṣa-utpannam jñānam avyapadeśyam avyabhicāri vyavasāyātmakam pratyakṣam**".

ANALYSIS: The 2025 twenty-marker expects clause-by-clause unpacking. Take them in order.

1. Sense-object contact (indriyārtha-sannikarṣa).

- FACT: Perception begins with a relation between sense organ and object.
- ANALYSIS: This marks perception as **causally immediate** relative to the relevant sense relation. It is the clause that makes perception the foundational instrument: the other three all presuppose that something was, at some point, perceived.

2. Produced (utpannam).

- FACT: The cognition must be **produced from** that contact.
- ANALYSIS: This excludes merely remembered or verbally derived knowledge. Contact must be the generating condition, not an accidental accompaniment.

3. Non-verbal (avyapadeśyam).

- FACT: Perception is **not constituted by words as words**.
- ANALYSIS: This distinguishes it from testimony. It does **not** mean perception must be inexpressible - determinate perception is expressible, and Nyāya insists that it is genuine perception.

4. Non-errant (avyabhicāri).

- FACT: Genuine perception is **unerring**.
- ANALYSIS: Illusion is excluded from valid perception in the final sense. Note that this clause creates the *need* for a separate theory of error, which is why Session 11 exists at all.

5. Determinate (vyavasāyātmakam).

- FACT: It is **definite, not doubtful**.
- ANALYSIS: This clause creates discussion, because later Naiyāyikas also admit a prior **indeterminate** phase.

3. Indeterminate and determinate perception, and the tension in clause five

FACT: **Indeterminate (nirvikalpaka)** perception is pre-predicative awareness: the object is present but not yet cognised as qualified by a universal or a name.

FACT: **Determinate (savikalpaka)** perception is qualified, nameable awareness such as "this is a blue pot".

ANALYSIS: The tradition uses the indeterminate stage to explain how raw awareness can **ground** determinate judgement without that judgement being a mere verbal construction.

CAUTION: **The internal tension, stated fairly.** If perception must be determinate by definition, how can the indeterminate stage be perception at all? The standard resolution is that the definition's "determinate" clause excludes **doubt**, not the pre-predicative stage; the indeterminate stage is perceptual because it is generated by sense-object contact, and it is not doubtful, merely not yet articulated. ANALYSIS: Critics reply that this makes "determinate" do two jobs at once. Report the tension; do not pretend it is absent.

ANALYSIS: **Why the two stages matter beyond definition.** The indeterminate-determinate pair is what allows Nyāya to say universals are *perceived*: the universal is what the determinate stage adds as qualifier. Cut the pair and Session 4's realism about universals loses its epistemology.

4. The six sense-object contacts

FACT: Nyāya elaborates six sense-object relations, and each exists because a different kind of object has to be reachable:

#	Contact	What it makes perceptible
1	conjunction (saṃyoga)	a substance - the pot itself
2	inherence in what is conjoined (saṃyukta-samavāya)	a quality or motion in that substance - its colour
3	inherence in what inheres in what is conjoined (saṃyukta-samaveta-samavāya)	the universal in that quality - colour-ness
4	inherence (samavāya)	sound, taken as inhering in ether, grasped by the ear
5	inherence in what inheres (samaveta-samavāya)	the universal in sound - sound-ness
6	qualifier-qualified relation (viśeṣaṇa-viśeṣya-bhāva)	absence - jar-absence qualifying the table

ANALYSIS: These are technical tools for explaining how the senses can apprehend not just substances, but also qualities, universals and absences. The sixth is the one that carries Session 6's account of absence-perception, and the third and fifth are the ones that carry Session 4's claim that universals are perceived.

5. Extraordinary perception (alaukika): three kinds, three jobs

1. FACT: **Universal-mediated perception (sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa).** By apprehending a universal one can perceptually relate to all its instances in a distinctive way.
- ANALYSIS: This supports Nyāya realism about universals: universals are perceived, not merely inferred. It is also the key to the theory of induction in Session 9.
2. FACT: **Cognition-mediated perception (jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa).** A prior cognition mediates present perception; one may in a derivative sense "see" sandalwood as fragrant, the fragrance being supplied by a past cognition rather than by the eye.
- ANALYSIS: This becomes crucial in Nyāya's theory of error in Session 11.
3. FACT: **Yogic perception (yogaja-pratyakṣa).** Perception of subtle, distant, past or future objects by the perfected practitioner.

ANALYSIS: **The 2023 evaluative demand - "are they justified in accepting that universals are perceived?"**

Answer in three moves. **For:** determinate perception already presents the object as qualified by a universal, so the universal is given in the cognition rather than added to it; without this, classification and the grasping of invariable concomitance lose their base. **Against:** CAUTION: critics hold that universal-mediated perception is an ad hoc device built to solve induction, and Buddhist exclusion theory explains classification without a perceived one-in-many. **Verdict:** justified *within* Nyāya's realist ontology, where universals are genuine categories; not justified for an opponent who has already refused that ontology - which shows the dispute is metaphysical before it is perceptual.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION

Claim. Gautama defines perception by exclusion, so the definition is best read as a filter that identifies what perception is *not*. **Named evidence.** The definition requires cognition produced from sense-object contact, non-verbal, non-errant and determinate; the first requirement excludes inference, memory and testimony, the second excludes verbally constituted knowledge, the third excludes illusion such as shell-silver, and the fourth excludes doubt such as "post or man?". **Analysis.** Read as a filter, the definition explains the school's later architecture: because illusion is excluded rather than explained, a separate theory of error becomes obligatory; because absence and universals are not reachable by simple contact, six graded contacts are required; and because ordinary contact cannot reach all instances of a kind, extraordinary perception is introduced. **Qualification.** CAUTION: The determinacy clause remains internally contested, since later Naiyāyikas also admit an indeterminate pre-predicative stage, and the standard resolution - that the clause excludes doubt rather than the pre-predicative phase - is a reading that critics regard as making one word do two jobs.

UPSC TRAPS - SESSION 7

- ANALYSIS: Translating the clauses instead of naming what each excludes. The exclusions are where the marks are.
- ANALYSIS: Reading "non-verbal" as "inexpressible". Determinate perception is expressible and is still perception.
- ANALYSIS: Saying Nyāya accepts non-cognition or postulation as separate instruments. It reduces both.
- ANALYSIS: Presenting the six contacts as a list without saying which object each one reaches.
- ANALYSIS: Claiming the indeterminate/determinate tension is settled. Report the resolution and the criticism.
- ANALYSIS: Giving "four means of valid knowledge" as the Vaiśeṣika count. Classical Vaiśeṣika keeps two.

RAPID REVISION - SESSION 7

- Four instruments: perception, inference, comparison, testimony. Vaiśeṣika: two.
- Definition: produced from sense-object contact · non-verbal · non-errant · determinate.
- Exclusions in order: the other instruments · testimony · illusion · doubt.
- Indeterminate -> determinate; the determinate stage is where the universal appears as qualifier.
- Six contacts: conjunction · inherence-in-conjoined · inherence-in-inherent-in-conjoined · inherence · inherence-in-inherent · qualifier-qualified (for absence).
- Extraordinary: universal-mediated (induction), cognition-mediated (error), yogic.

SESSION 8 - INFERENCE: FIVE MEMBERS, THREE CLASSIFICATION GRIDS, FIVE MARKS OF A VALID REASON

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: You see smoke and conclude there is fire. Nyāya's question is not whether that feels reasonable but what exactly entitles you - and its answer is that a sign only works if it is tied to what it signifies by a relation that never fails.

Technical definition: Inference (**anumāna**) is knowledge arising through a **sign or reason (liṅga / hetu, the probans)** known to stand in **invariable concomitance (vyāpti)** with the **property to be proved (sādhya, the probandum)** in a given **subject (pakṣa)**. Its communicable form is the **five-membered demonstration (pañcāvayava)**, and its immediate cause is the **subsumptive reflection (parāmarśa)**: "this hill possesses smoke, which is pervaded by fire".

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Nyāya's five-membered demonstration is often dismissed as a redundant syllogism, but the redundancy is deliberate: unlike a formal calculus it must display both the universal rule and an actually observed instance, because Nyāya is proving something about the world to another person rather than testing the form of a sentence.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **subject (pakṣa)** · **property to be proved (sādhya)** · **reason or sign (hetu / liṅga)**
- **invariable concomitance (vyāpti)** - the relation that licenses the move
- **five members (pañcāvayava)**: thesis, reason, example, application, conclusion
- **inference for oneself (svārthānumāna)** / **inference for another (parārthānumāna)**
- **subsumptive reflection (parāmarśa)** - the immediate cause of inferential cognition
- **presence in the subject (pakṣadharmatā)** - the first of the five marks

How to use them: in any inference answer, name the three terms of the example before you run it. "Hill is the subject, fire is the property to be proved, smoke is the reason" costs one line and makes every subsequent sentence legible.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

ONE INFERENCE, LAID OUT

WHAT I WANT TO SHOW	-> the hill has FIRE	(sādhya)
WHERE I WANT TO SHOW IT	-> this hill	(pakṣa)
WHAT LETS ME SHOW IT	-> smoke	(hetu)
WHY THAT WORKS	-> wherever smoke, there fire	(vyāpti)

TWO SETTINGS FOR THE SAME MACHINE

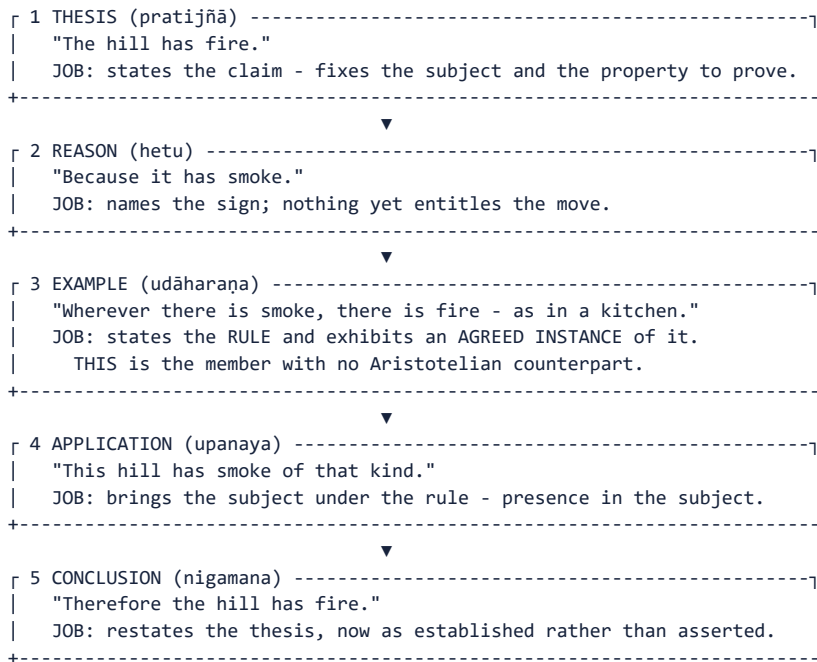
FOR MYSELF (svārthānumāna) I already know the rule. I see smoke. I conclude fire. No speech required. The whole thing happens in one reflection.	FOR ANOTHER (parārthānumāna) I must SHOW my listener the rule and its instance. Hence five spoken members. The extra members are not padding; they are the public exhibition of what was private in the first case.
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In simple words: the same act of reasoning has two forms depending on whether you are convincing yourself or someone else. When convincing yourself, the rule and the instance are already in your possession. When convincing someone else, you must lay both on the table, plus an example they will grant. That is why Nyāya's demonstration has an example member and Aristotle's syllogism does not.

Remember first	Meaning
<i>Pakṣa</i>	The subject under discussion - this hill
<i>Sādhya</i>	What is to be established there - fire
<i>Hetu</i>	The sign that establishes it - smoke
<i>Sapakṣa</i>	A similar instance where the property is known to hold - a kitchen
<i>Vipakṣa</i>	A dissimilar instance where it is known not to hold - a lake
<i>Vyāpti</i>	The rule tying reason to property, invariably and unconditionally

One-line memory: the subject is where, the property is what, the reason is how, and concomitance is why.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE FIVE MEMBERS AND THE WORK EACH ONE DOES



Members 3 and 4 together are the public form of the SUBSUMPTIVE REFLECTION (parāmarśa): "this hill possesses smoke which is pervaded by fire".
That single cognition is the immediate cause (karaṇa) of the conclusion.

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The diagram makes the standard objection answerable. Members 1 and 5 look like repetition - but member 1 is an *asserted* claim while member 5 is an *established* one, and the transformation between them is exactly what members 3 and 4 accomplish.

1. Inference stated

FACT: **Anumāna** is knowledge arising through a **sign (liṅga / hetu, probans)** known to be invariably related to the **probandum (sādhya)**.

ANALYSIS: Note the epistemic order: the invariable relation must be **already known** for the inference to run. This is why Session 9 - how that relation is secured - is not an appendix but the load-bearing wall of the whole theory.

2. The five members, using the standard example

1. FACT: **Thesis (pratijñā)** - The hill has fire.
2. FACT: **Reason (hetu)** - because it has smoke.
3. FACT: **Example (udāharaṇa)** - wherever there is smoke, there is fire, as in a kitchen.
4. FACT: **Application (upanaya)** - this hill has smoke of that kind.
5. FACT: **Conclusion (nigamana)** - therefore the hill has fire.

FACT: **Purpose.** The five-membered form is the form of **proof for another (parārthānumāna)**. It makes explicit both the invariable concomitance and its application to the subject.

ANALYSIS: **The redundancy objection and its reply.** Later Indian logicians themselves noted that three members can suffice for a trained hearer. Nyāya's reply is that the demonstration is a **public epistemic act**, not a minimal formal derivation: the example member supplies an instance the audience already accepts, which is what converts assertion into shared warrant. State the objection and the reply together; a script that only recites five members misses the philosophical content.

3. Three classification grids - and the instruction to name which one you are using

Basis of division	Types	Exact distinction
Purpose	inference for oneself (svārthānumāna); inference for another (parārthānumāna)	The first produces one's own conclusion; the second communicates proof through five members.
Direction or basis of uniformity	from perceived cause to unperceived effect (pūrvavat); from perceived effect to unperceived cause (śeṣavat); from non-causal uniformity (sāmānyatodṛṣṭa)	Dark clouds to future rain; a swollen muddy river to past rain; changed celestial position to unperceived motion are the standard examples.
Form of concomitance	positive-only (kevalānvayi); negative-only (kevalavyatireki); positive-and-negative (anvayavyatireki)	Established through agreement in presence, agreement in absence, or both.

ANALYSIS: Textbooks also use residual inference (**pariśeṣa**) as another interpretation of **śeṣavat**. **State which classification you are using** rather than mixing the senses - an answer that silently switches between "śeṣavat = effect-to-cause" and "śeṣavat = elimination of alternatives" reads as confused even when both readings are individually defensible.

ANALYSIS: The third grid explained, since it is the least well written. A **positive-only** reason has no dissimilar instance available, because the property to be proved covers everything - "the pot is nameable, because it is knowable" leaves nothing outside the class. A **negative-only** reason has no similar instance available, because the subject is the only case - the classic example proves that living bodies possess a soul, since the reason occurs nowhere else. A **positive-and-negative** reason has both, and smoke-and-fire is its standard illustration. Naming which of the three a given inference is makes the fallacy analysis in Session 9 immediately applicable.

4. The five marks of a valid reason

1. FACT: **Presence in the subject (pakṣadharmatā)** - the reason is present in the subject under consideration.
2. FACT: **Presence in similar instances (sapakṣa-sattva)** - the reason is present in positive instances where the property is known to hold.
3. FACT: **Absence from dissimilar instances (vipakṣa-asattva)** - the reason is absent from negative instances where the property is known not to hold.
4. FACT: **Not contradicted (abādhita)** - the property to be proved is not contradicted by stronger knowledge.
5. FACT: **Not counterbalanced (asatpratipakṣa)** - the reason is not opposed by an equally strong counter-reason.

ANALYSIS: **Exam link.** These five marks are the **positive side** of exactly the same test that appears **negatively** as the fallacies of the reason (*hetvābhāsa*) in Session 9. The 2023 twenty-marker asks for the fallacies *in relation to* the five marks, so the mapping between them is the answer's spine, not an afterthought.

5. Subsumptive reflection: what actually causes the inferential cognition

FACT: **Presence in the subject.** The reason must be **known** to exist in the subject: this hill has smoke.

FACT: **Subsumptive reflection (parāmarśa).** The **immediate cause (karaṇa)** of inferential cognition is the subsumptive reflection: "this hill possesses smoke which is pervaded by fire".

FACT: **Connection to the five members.** The five-membered demonstration makes subsumptive reflection **communicable**: the thesis states the claim, the reason states the sign, the example states the concomitance with an instance, the application applies it to the subject, and the conclusion states the result.

ANALYSIS: **Why naming the immediate cause earns a mark.** It shows that for Nyāya inference is a *causal-cognitive episode* with an identifiable proximate cause, not merely a valid pattern. That is also why Nyāya can be realist about inference: the reflection is a real cognition with a real object, and its validity is settled extrinsically, as Session 10 explains.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION

Claim. The five-membered demonstration is not a clumsy syllogism but a schema for producing warranted assent in another person. **Named evidence.** Its third member, the example, states the invariable concomitance *and* exhibits an agreed instance such as the kitchen, while its fourth member applies that rule to the subject by asserting presence in the subject; together these two reproduce publicly the subsumptive reflection that is the immediate cause of the inferential cognition. **Analysis.** This explains the two features that look like defects from a formalist standpoint: the apparent repetition between thesis and conclusion marks the difference between an asserted and an established claim, and the obligatory empirical example marks Nyāya's refusal to detach validity from the world it is reasoning about. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: Later Indian logicians themselves accepted that fewer members suffice for a trained hearer, so the five-membered form should be defended as pedagogically and dialectically complete rather than as logically indispensable.

UPSC TRAPS - SESSION 8

- ANALYSIS: Calling the five-membered demonstration a version of the Aristotelian syllogism. The example member has no counterpart there.
- ANALYSIS: Mixing the two readings of *śeṣavat* - effect-to-cause and residual elimination - without saying which is used.
- ANALYSIS: Listing the five marks without mapping them to the five fallacies. The 2023 question demands the mapping.
- ANALYSIS: Omitting the subsumptive reflection, which is the immediate cause of the inferential cognition.
- ANALYSIS: Treating inference for oneself and for another as two different logics. They are one machine in two settings.
- ANALYSIS: Forgetting that invariable concomitance must be *already known* before the inference runs.

RAPID REVISION - SESSION 8

- Terms: subject (*pakṣa*), property to prove (*sādhya*), reason (*hetu*), similar instance (*sapakṣa*), dissimilar instance (*vipakṣa*).
- Five members: thesis · reason · example · application · conclusion. The example is the distinctive one.
- Grid 1 purpose: for oneself / for another. Grid 2 direction: cause->effect, effect->cause, non-causal uniformity. Grid 3 concomitance: positive-only, negative-only, both.
- Five marks: in the subject · in similar cases · absent from dissimilar cases · uncontradicted · uncounterbalanced.
- Immediate cause of the conclusion = subsumptive reflection (*parāmarśa*).
- Say which classification you are using; ANALYSIS: *śeṣavat* has two textbook readings.

SESSION 9 - SECURING THE UNIVERSAL: GRASPING CONCOMITANCE AND THE FIVE FALLACIES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Everything in Nyāya's theory of inference rests on one claim - that we can know a rule holds *always*, not just in the cases we happened to check. This session is the school's defence of that claim, and its list of the exact ways a reason can fail.

Technical definition: Grasping invariable concomitance (vyāpti-grahaṇa) is the chain by which Nyāya claims to know the universal relation required for inference. **Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)** is fixed (*niyata*) and unconditioned (*anaupādhika*) co-presence - **invariable non-deviation (avinābhāva-niyama)** - between the reason and the property to be proved. The **fallacies of the reason (hetvābhāsa)** are the five ways an apparent reason fails, each corresponding to the violation of one of the five marks.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Nyāya's reply to the sceptic is not that induction can be made certain but that it can be made *disciplined*: repeated observation, deliberate search for a counter-instance, elimination of the conditioning adjunct, and doubt-removing hypothetical reasoning together convert a sample into a warrant, and the school's honesty lies in admitting that this is warrant rather than enumeration.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **invariable concomitance (vyāpti)** · **fixed (niyata)** · **unconditioned (anaupādhika)**
- **equal extension (samavyāpti)** and **unequal extension (viśamavyāpti / asamavyāpti)**
- **repeated observation (bhūyodarśana)** · **non-observation of deviation (vyabhicāra-adarśana)**
- **conditioning adjunct (upādhi)** and its **elimination (upādhi-nirāsa)**
- **hypothetical reasoning (tarka)** - aid to the instruments, not an instrument
- **universal-mediated perception (sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa)** - the specifically Nyāya move on induction
- **self-contradiction in one's own speech (svavacana-virodha)** - the counter-attack on the sceptic

How to use them: for the 2022 fifteen-marker the winning structure is: state the Cārvāka objection at full strength -> give the four-step acquisition chain -> add universal-mediated perception -> close with the self-refutation charge -> concede the residual dependence on realism about universals.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

THE PROBLEM IN ONE SENTENCE

You have seen smoke with fire a hundred times. How do you know about the hundred-and-first - or about all of them?

NYĀYA'S FOUR-STEP DISCIPLINE (each step fixes the previous step's gap)

STEP 1 LOOK A LOT (bhūyodarśana)

co-presence in many cases + co-absence where fire is absent

▸ GAP: a finite sample is still finite

STEP 2 HUNT FOR A COUNTER-CASE (vyabhicāra-adarśana)

actively search for smoke without fire; find none

▸ GAP: a hidden condition might still be doing the work

STEP 3 REMOVE THE HIDDEN CONDITION (upādhi-nirāsa)

test whether some adjunct, not the reason itself, explains the link

▸ GAP: a residual "but what if?" doubt survives

STEP 4 KILL THE RESIDUAL DOUBT (tarka)

suppose the contrary - smoke without fire - and show the consequence is unacceptable

▸ RESULT: warranted universal cognition (not enumeration)

PLUS ONE ONTOLOGICAL MOVE

STEP 5 BECAUSE UNIVERSALS ARE REAL, perceiving one instance of smokeness

relates you perceptually to SMOKE AS SUCH

(sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa) - no infinite survey needed

In simple words: the sceptic's challenge is that no number of observations adds up to "always". Nyāya agrees that counting will not do it, and then argues that counting was never the method. The method is elimination - you rule out the ways the link could fail - plus an ontology in which what you grasp is a kind, not a heap of cases.

Remember first	Meaning
<i>Vyāpti</i>	Pervasion: wherever the reason, there the property, without exception or condition
Equal extension	The two pervade each other and are convertible
Unequal extension	All smoke is pervaded by fire; not all fire is pervaded by smoke
<i>Upādhi</i>	A conditioning adjunct: pervades the property but not the reason
<i>Tarka</i>	Doubt-remover; assists, never proves

One-line memory: Nyāya does not count instances into a universal; it eliminates the ways the universal could be false.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE CONDITIONING ADJUNCT, WORKED THROUGH

A GOOD INFERENCE

"The hill has fire, because smoke."
smoke fire

A BAD INFERENCE

"The hill has smoke, because fire."
fire smoke

WHY THE SECOND FAILS - FIND THE ADJUNCT

DEFINITION OF AN ADJUNCT (upādhi):

sādhya-vyāpakatve sati sādhana-avyāpakah

= it PERVADES the property to be proved, but does NOT pervade the reason

CANDIDATE ADJUNCT: WET FUEL (ārdra-indhana)

- wherever there is SMOKE, there is wet fuel → pervades the sādhya
- NOT wherever there is FIRE is there wet fuel → fails to pervade the hetu

=> wet fuel is a genuine upādhi

CONSEQUENCE: fire does not UNCONDITIONALLY pervade smoke.

The fire->smoke link is conditional, so the inference collapses.

THE CĀRVĀKA'S USE OF THE SAME TOOL

"You can never be sure some adjunct is not lurking in smoke->fire either."

NYĀYA'S REPLY: systematic elimination of the adjunct plus removal of the suspicion of an adjunct (upādhi-śaṅkā-nivṛtti), supported by hypothetical reasoning, converts observation into warranted universal cognition.

ANALYSIS: Caption. The adjunct test is the single most transferable device in this session. It is simultaneously Nyāya's method of quality control, the Cārvāka's weapon, and the diagnosis of one named fallacy - the unproved reason by failure of pervasion.

1. Invariable concomitance defined and divided

FACT: Definition. Vyāpti is invariable, unconditional concomitance - **invariable non-deviation**

(avinābhāva-niyama) - between the reason (for example smoke) and the property to be proved (for example fire).

FACT: Distinction. Equal extension (samavyāpti) is convertibility: the two terms pervade each other.

FACT: Distinction. Unequal extension (viśamavyāpti / asamavyāpti) is one-way: all smoke is pervaded by fire, but not all fire is pervaded by smoke.

FACT: Condition. Nyāya requires **fixed (niyata)** and **unconditioned (anaupādhika)** concomitance, **not mere frequency**. This is the sentence that separates Nyāya's account from a statistical one and should be written verbatim in any induction question.

2. Repeated observation, and its honest limit

FACT: Argument. The knower observes **co-presence (anvaya)** in many positive instances: smoke with fire in kitchens, hearths and similar cases.

FACT: Argument. The knower also observes **co-absence (vyatireka)** in negative instances: where fire is absent, smoke is absent.

ANALYSIS: Limit. Repeated observation alone is **not sufficient**, because repeated observation remains a finite sample and cannot by itself yield an unrestricted universal. Nyāya states this limit itself; conceding it early is what makes the later steps look like a solution rather than a dodge.

3. Non-observation of deviation

FACT: Argument. The investigator searches for **deviation (vyabhicāra)** and does not find a case where the reason occurs without the property.

ANALYSIS: Limit. This strengthens the universal but still needs the removal of hidden conditions. Note the shift in method: step 1 collects, step 2 tries to refute. Nyāya's induction is falsification-shaped before it is enumeration-shaped.

4. Elimination of the conditioning adjunct

FACT: **Definition.** An **adjunct (upādhi)** is a conditioning factor defined as "**sādhya-vyāpakatve sati sādhana-avyāpakah**" - that which pervades the property to be proved but does not pervade the reason.

FACT: **Example.** In the bad inference "the hill has smoke because it has fire", **wet fuel (ārdra-indhana)** is the adjunct: wherever there is smoke there is wet fuel, but not wherever there is fire is there wet fuel.

FACT: **Argument.** Therefore fire does not unconditionally pervade smoke; the fire-to-smoke inference is conditional and fails.

FACT: **Nyāya's reply to Cārvāka.** The Cārvāka says a hidden condition may **always** lurk. Nyāya replies that systematic **elimination of the adjunct (upādhi-nirāsa)** together with **removal of the suspicion of an adjunct (upādhi-śaṅkā-nivṛtti)**, supported by hypothetical reasoning, converts observation into warranted universal cognition.

5. Hypothetical reasoning as doubt-remover, not as proof

FACT: **Statement.** **Tarka** is hypothetical or counterfactual reasoning that removes residual doubt by showing the unacceptable consequence of the contrary supposition.

FACT: **Example.** If smoke were not pervaded by fire, smoke could occur without fire; this contradicts uniform experience and would make the causal order unintelligible.

FACT: **Status.** Tarka is **an aid to the means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa-anugrahaka)**, not an independent instrument. It supports perception and inference by eliminating the rival supposition.

ANALYSIS: **Forms of the unacceptable consequence:** self-dependence (*ātmāśraya*), mutual dependence (*anyonyāśraya*), circularity (*cakraka*), infinite regress (*anavasthā*), and contradiction of perception or inference (*pratyakṣa-* or *anumāna-virodha*).

ANALYSIS: **Why the status matters.** Because tarka does not itself prove the universal, Nyāya escapes the charge of circularity: it is not inferring the licence for inference. State this explicitly whenever the circularity objection is raised.

6. Universal-mediated perception: the specifically Nyāya solution

FACT: **Cross-reference.** As Session 7 established, **universal-mediated perception (sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa)** is extraordinary perception through the universal.

FACT: **Role in concomitance.** On perceiving an instance of **smokeness**, the cognizer is perceptually related to smoke **as a universal**, so all smoke as such can be presented without an infinite survey of every smoke-instance.

ANALYSIS: **Induction payoff.** This is the specifically Nyāya move against the problem of induction: because the universal (*jāti*) is **real**, it can be cognitively grasped rather than merely guessed from samples.

CAUTION: **Contested.** It remains contested whether universal-mediated perception is genuine perception or an *ad hoc* device built to solve induction. Report the dispute; do not suppress it.

7. The five fallacies of the reason, mapped to the five marks

Fallacy	What fails	Subtypes and examples
FACT: irregular (<i>savyabhicāra</i> / <i>anaikāntika</i>)	FACT: The reason is not invariably tied to the property.	FACT: too common (<i>sādhāraṇa</i>) occurs in both similar and dissimilar instances; too restricted (<i>asādhāraṇa</i>) is confined to the subject; inconclusive by over-width (<i>anupasaṃhārin</i>) is too wide to allow contrast.
FACT: contradictory (<i>viruddha</i>)	FACT: The reason proves the opposite of the intended property.	FACT: A reason meant to prove permanence instead proves impermanence.
FACT: counterbalanced (<i>satpratipakṣa</i> / <i>prakaraṇasama</i>)	FACT: An equally strong counter-reason proves the contrary.	FACT: The debate remains balanced because each side has a reason of comparable force.
FACT: unproved (<i>asiddha</i> / <i>sādhyaśama</i>)	FACT: The reason itself is not established.	FACT: locus-unproved (<i>āśrayāsiddha</i>): the subject-locus is unreal; form-unproved (<i>svarūpāsiddha</i>): the reason is absent in the subject; pervasion-unproved (<i>vyāpyatvāsiddha</i>): pervasion is unproved, often because of an adjunct.
FACT: stultified (<i>bādhita</i> / <i>kālātīta</i>)	FACT: The conclusion is contradicted by a stronger instrument.	FACT: Fire cannot be inferred as cold, because perception defeats the property to be proved.

ANALYSIS: **Linking rule - the spine of the 2023 twenty-marker.** Irregular violates **absence from dissimilar instances**; unproved violates **presence in the subject**; stultified violates **not contradicted**; counterbalanced violates **not counterbalanced**; and contradictory **reverses the direction of concomitance itself**.

ANALYSIS: **How to present the mapping.** Write the five marks as a numbered column and the five fallacies as a facing column, then state the four one-to-one correspondences and the one exception. The exception is worth saying aloud: contradictory is not the mere negation of a single mark but the inversion of the relation that all five marks presuppose.

8. The Cārvāka objection at full strength, and Nyāya's four replies

FACT: **Objection.** No finite observation licenses a universal; adjunct-elimination can never be completed; hypothetical reasoning presupposes inference and is therefore circular; and universal-mediated perception looks like an *ad hoc* posit.

ANALYSIS: **The Humean parallel.** Observed regularity alone does not logically entail future or universal necessity.

ANALYSIS: Use this comparison in at most one line, and only after the Indian argument is complete.

FACT: **Reply 1.** The demand for **mathematical certainty** from empirical universals is misplaced. Nyāya claims **warranted cognition**, not omniscient enumeration by ordinary knowers.

FACT: **Reply 2.** Hypothetical reasoning is **not an independent proof** of concomitance, so it does not circularly infer what it must prove; it removes the contrary supposition so that perception and inference can function.

FACT: **Reply 3.** Universal-mediated perception is **not ad hoc within Nyāya ontology**, because universals are real categories and can be presented in cognition.

FACT: **Reply 4.** The sceptic's denial of **all** inference is itself a universal claim about inference, and so invites **self-contradiction in one's own speech** (*svavacana-virodha*). Moreover, the Cārvāka's own critique of inference - that a hidden adjunct may always lurk - is itself an inference from observed cases to an unrestricted claim.

ANALYSIS: **Residual force.** The Nyāya answer is strongest **if one accepts realism about universals**. If the universal is denied, the induction solution becomes contested. This concession is not a weakness in the answer; it is the analysis the directive "critically discuss" is asking for.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION

Claim. Nyāya answers inductive scepticism by replacing enumeration with elimination, and then by grounding elimination in a realist ontology of kinds. **Named evidence.** The chain runs from repeated observation of co-presence and co-absence, through the search for deviation, to the elimination of the conditioning adjunct - where wet fuel is shown to pervade smoke but not fire, defeating the fire-to-smoke inference - and finally to hypothetical reasoning, which is expressly classed as an aid to the instruments rather than as one of them. **Analysis.** Each step is calibrated to a specific gap in the previous one, so the chain is a sequence of defeaters rather than an accumulation of evidence; and because hypothetical reasoning does not itself establish the universal, the account escapes the circularity charge that would otherwise be fatal to a defence of inference by inference. **Qualification.** CAUTION: The final step, universal-mediated perception, is contested as possibly *ad hoc*, and the whole reply holds only for an opponent who grants that universals are real - which is precisely what the Buddhist exclusion theorist and the Cārvāka refuse.

UPSC TRAPS - SESSION 9

- ANALYSIS: Defining concomitance as frequent co-occurrence. It is fixed **and unconditioned**.
- ANALYSIS: Getting the adjunct definition backwards. It pervades the **property to be proved**, not the reason.
- ANALYSIS: Calling hypothetical reasoning a means of valid knowledge; that concession would make the reply circular.
- ANALYSIS: Listing the fallacies without mapping them onto the five marks.
- ANALYSIS: Presenting universal-mediated perception as uncontroversial.
- ANALYSIS: Leading with Hume. The Indian argument comes first; the parallel is one line at most.

RAPID REVISION - SESSION 9

- Concomitance = fixed (*niyata*) + unconditioned (*anaupādhika*); equal versus unequal extension.
- Chain: repeated observation -> search for deviation -> eliminate the adjunct -> hypothetical reasoning -> universal-mediated perception.
- Adjunct formula: pervades the property, does not pervade the reason. Example: wet fuel in the fire->smoke inference.
- Five fallacies: irregular · contradictory · counterbalanced · unproved · stultified.
- Mapping: irregular<->dissimilar-instance absence · unproved<->presence in subject · stultified<->uncontradicted · counterbalanced<->uncounterbalanced · contradictory<->reverses concomitance.
- Sceptic's self-refutation: a universal denial of inference is itself a universal claim.

SESSION 10 - WORDS AND WARRANT: COMPARISON, TESTIMONY, MEMORY, VALIDITY AND THE FRUIT OF KNOWING

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Two of Nyāya's four instruments are about language and other people - one tells you what a new word picks out, the other lets you know things you could never have checked yourself. This session also settles three questions that decide many marks: why memory is not knowledge, how we know a cognition is true, and whether the instrument and its result are the same thing.

Technical definition: **Comparison (upamāna)** yields knowledge of the relation between a word and its referent through resemblance. **Testimony (śabda)** is valid verbal knowledge from the instruction of a reliable person (*āptopadeśa* / *āptavākya*). **Memory (smṛti)** is excluded from the instruments because it reproduces rather than generates. Nyāya holds **extrinsic validity (parataḥ-prāmāṇya)** for both truth and falsity, and distinguishes the **instrument (pramāṇa)** from its **fruit (pramāṇaphala / pramīti)**.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Nyāya's treatment of testimony is the point at which its realism becomes a social epistemology: it accepts that most of what any person knows was learned from someone else, and then insists that this dependence is legitimate only where speaker-reliability, sentence-intelligibility and the resulting cognition can each be independently specified.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **comparison (upamāna)** - word-referent link through resemblance
- **reliable person (āpta)** - knows correctly, intends truthfully, is competent to express
- **four sentence conditions:** mutual expectancy (*ākāṅkṣā*), semantic fitness (*yogyatā*), proximity (*sannidhi / āsatti*), intended meaning (*tātparya*)
- **memory (smṛti)** - reproductive, hence not an instrument
- **extrinsic validity (parataḥ-prāmāṇya)** - for **both** validity and invalidity
- **instrument and fruit (pramāṇa and pramāṇaphala)** - analytically distinct in a realist episode

How to use them: the single highest-yield sentence in this session is that Nyāya is extrinsic for **both** validity and invalidity. Examiners set this precisely because most scripts write "extrinsic for invalidity only".

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

HOW COMPARISON ACTUALLY WORKS - IN FOUR BEATS

- BEAT 1 A forester tells you: "a gavaya is like a cow."
▸ this is testimony, and it gives you a DESCRIPTION
- BEAT 2 You go to the forest and see an animal resembling a cow.
▸ this is perception, and it gives you an OBJECT
- BEAT 3 You recall the description while seeing the object.
▸ memory supplies the earlier sentence
- BEAT 4 You know: "THIS is what the word 'gavaya' denotes."
▸ THIS fourth cognition is the fruit of COMPARISON
- and none of the earlier three instruments produced it

WHY IT IS A SEPARATE INSTRUMENT (Nyāya's claim)
testimony gave a description, not a referent
perception gave an animal, not a name
memory reproduced, it did not establish
=> the word-object link is a NEW cognition needing its own instrument

In simple words: comparison is not "reasoning by analogy". It is the specific act by which a word gets attached to a thing you are meeting for the first time. That is why the classical example is always about learning what an unfamiliar word denotes and never about arguing from one case to another.

Remember first	Meaning
Comparison	Semantic acquisition through resemblance plus prior description
Āpta	Reliable: correct knowledge + truthful intention + competent expression
Four conditions	Expectancy, fitness, proximity, intended meaning
Memory	Reproduces a past cognition; produces nothing novel
Extrinsic validity	Truth and falsity are known through external conditions or later checks

One-line memory: comparison names, testimony informs, memory only repeats - and none of the three certifies itself.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE VALIDITY QUESTION ACROSS SCHOOLS

"IS A COGNITION KNOWN TO BE TRUE BY ITSELF, OR BY SOMETHING ELSE?"

SCHOOL	VALIDITY (truth)	INVALIDITY (falsity)
NYĀYA	EXTRINSIC (parataḥ) known by successful activity, coherence, corroboration	EXTRINSIC (parataḥ) known by contradiction or defect in the causal conditions
MĪMĀṢĀ	INTRINSIC (svataḥ) arises with the cognition	EXTRINSIC discovered later
THE TRAP	Writing "Nyāya is extrinsic for invalidity" is only HALF the position and is marked as an error.	

WHY NYĀYA TAKES THE HARDER ROUTE

If validity were self-certifying, error could never be recognised as error from the inside - yet Nyāya's whole theory of error (Session 11) requires that a cognition can be false while feeling exactly like a true one.

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The grid does two jobs at once: it fixes the high-frequency factual point, and it supplies the *reason* Nyāya adopts the extrinsic position - the theory of error would collapse under intrinsic validity.

1. Comparison (upamāna)

FACT: **Upamāna** gives knowledge of the relation between a **word and its referent** through resemblance.

FACT: If one is told that a **gavaya** resembles a cow, later encountering such an animal yields knowledge that **this** is what the word denotes.

ANALYSIS: The point is **semantic acquisition via similarity**, not analogical argument.

ANALYSIS: **Why classical Vaiśeṣika folds it into inference.** The Vaiśeṣika reduction treats the fourth cognition as inferential: this animal has the described features, whatever has those features is called *gavaya*, therefore this is a *gavaya*. Nyāya resists on the ground that what is established is a **word-object relation**, not a property of the animal - and instruments are individuated by the kind of cognition they produce. Naming this internal disagreement is a mark that costs one sentence.

2. Testimony (śabda): statement, argument, and the reliability condition

FACT: **Statement.** Testimony is valid verbal knowledge from **reliable instruction** (āptopadeśa / āptavākya).

FACT: A **reliable person** (āpta) (i) knows the matter correctly, (ii) intends to communicate it truthfully, and (iii) is competent to express it. **Mere status or confidence does not create epistemic authority.**

FACT: **Argument.**

1. Many things cannot be directly perceived by each knower.
2. Human life depends on reliable communication.
3. Therefore testimony must be recognised as an independent instrument when it comes from a trustworthy source.

ANALYSIS: **The 2021 demand.** The question requires more than "a trustworthy person". Connect three things: speaker reliability, sentence comprehension, and the resulting cognition of the word-object relation. A script that stops at the first of the three has answered a third of the question.

3. Vedic testimony and the theistic bridge

FACT: Nyāya accepts the Veda as valid testimony.

FACT: In later Nyāya, its authority is often connected with **God as omniscient author** - which is why testimony reappears in Session 13 as the scriptural proof of God's existence.

ANALYSIS: **Note the circularity risk and its management.** If the Veda is authoritative *because* God authored it, and God is inferred *from* the Veda's authority, the reasoning is circular. Nyāya's escape is that the primary God-proofs are from effect, arrangement and sustenance - not from scripture - so the scriptural argument functions as a converging strand rather than as the load-bearing one. Say this in a God question and the cumulative structure of Session 13 becomes intelligible.

4. Classifications and the four sentence conditions

FACT: Testimony may concern **perceptible matters (dr̥ṣṭārtha)** or **imperceptible matters (adr̥ṣṭārtha)**, and may be **secular (laukika)** or **Vedic (vaidika)**.

FACT: An intelligible sentence requires:

1. **mutual expectancy (ākāṅkṣā)** among its words - "cow horse man elephant" has none;
2. **semantic fitness (yogyatā)** without contradiction - "sprinkle with fire" fails;
3. **proximity (sannidhi / āsatti)** in utterance - words spoken hours apart do not compose;
4. **intended meaning (tātparya)** where ambiguity exists - "bring the *saindhava*" means salt at dinner and a horse before a journey.

ANALYSIS: The four conditions are also the answer to "why is testimony an instrument rather than mere hearsay?": hearsay fails at least one of them, and a reliable speaker satisfying all four produces a cognition that no other instrument could deliver.

5. Why memory is not an instrument (the 2024 comparative)

FACT: **Memory (smṛti)** reproduces a **past** cognition; it does not generate **novel** knowledge.

FACT: An instrument must produce **fresh, true cognition** of what is not already known in that mode.

ANALYSIS: Therefore memory may be psychologically indispensable but is **not epistemically an instrument** in the technical sense.

ANALYSIS: **The comparative refinement.** The Prābhākara Mīmāṃsakas exclude memory on a related but distinct ground - that it is not *presentative*, being dependent on a prior impression rather than on a present object. Nyāya's ground is the novelty condition; Prābhākara's is the dependence on a residual impression. The two agree on the verdict and differ on the reason, which is exactly what a comparative question is testing.

6. Extrinsic validity for both truth and falsity (the 2025 comparative)

FACT: Nyāya defends **extrinsic validity (parataḥ-prāmāṇya)** and **extrinsic invalidity (parataḥ-aprāmāṇya)**.

FACT: That means **both** the validity and the invalidity of a cognition are known through external conditions or later confirmation and disconfirmation.

ANALYSIS: This is a standard trap: Nyāya is **not merely extrinsic for invalidity; it is extrinsic for both**.

FACT: **Contrast.** Mīmāṃsā generally takes validity to be **self-manifest (svataḥ)** while invalidity is known later.

ANALYSIS: **The argument, not just the label.** Nyāya's reason is causal: a cognition's truth depends on whether its generating conditions were free of defect, and a knower has no direct access to the state of those conditions from inside the cognition. Confirmation therefore comes from successful activity (*pravṛtti-sāmarthya*), coherence with other cognitions, or corroboration. ANALYSIS: The cost is a regress worry - if each confirmation itself needs confirmation, where does it stop? Nyāya's answer is practical rather than foundational: confirmation stops where doubt actually ceases, not where certainty is demonstrated.

7. Instrument and fruit: the 2025 debate with the Buddhists

FACT: **Nyāya's four factors.** The **knower (pramātr)**, the **means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)**, the **object (prameya)** and the **resulting true cognition (pramā / pramiti / pramāṇaphala)** are **analytically distinct** factors in a realist cognitive episode.

FACT: The means and the result are therefore **different**: the operative instrument or causal complex is the instrument, while true cognition is its **fruit**.

FACT: **The Buddhist position.** Buddhist epistemologists such as **Dignāga** are commonly read as tightening the relation so that cognition itself is **both** revelatory act and result, within a self-luminous framework.

ANALYSIS: The contrast turns on broader metaphysics: **Nyāya is instrumentally realist; Buddhist epistemology is more cognition-centred.**

ANALYSIS: **How to argue it rather than report it.** Nyāya's separation follows from its realism: if the object is independent, the instrument that reaches it must be distinct from the reaching, exactly as an axe is distinct from the splitting. The Buddhist collapse follows from its ontology: with only momentary cognition-events available, an

instrument distinct from its result would be a second entity nobody perceives. ANALYSIS: The dispute is therefore not a quarrel about vocabulary but a direct consequence of the two schools' opposed metaphysics - that sentence is the closing verdict a 10-marker on this topic wants.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION

Claim. Nyāya's account of testimony makes epistemic dependence on others respectable by specifying exactly what makes it work. **Named evidence.** A reliable person is defined by three conditions - correct knowledge, truthful intention and competence of expression - and the sentence heard must satisfy mutual expectancy, semantic fitness, proximity and intended meaning, as when "*saindhava*" means salt at dinner and a horse before a journey. **Analysis.** The two sets of conditions divide the labour precisely: the first set locates the risk in the speaker and the second locates it in the utterance, so that a failure of testimony can always be diagnosed as either an unreliable source or an unintelligible sentence rather than as an unanalysable failure of trust. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: The account becomes contested at the Vedic case, where authority is linked in later Nyāya to God's omniscient authorship, so the scriptural strand must be presented as one converging consideration in the theistic case rather than as its foundation, on pain of circularity.

UPSC TRAPS - SESSION 10

- ANALYSIS: Saying Nyāya holds extrinsic **invalidity** only. It holds extrinsic validity **and** invalidity.
- ANALYSIS: Treating comparison as analogical argument. It is word-referent acquisition by resemblance.
- ANALYSIS: Defining a reliable person by social status. The three conditions are knowledge, truthfulness, competence.
- ANALYSIS: Omitting the four sentence conditions from a testimony answer.
- ANALYSIS: Saying memory is excluded because it is unreliable. It is excluded because it is **reproductive**.
- ANALYSIS: Reporting the instrument/fruit debate as a terminological difference rather than as a consequence of opposed metaphysics.

RAPID REVISION - SESSION 10

- Comparison: description + resemblance -> word-object relation. Classical Vaiśeṣika folds it into inference.
- Reliable person: correct knowledge · truthful intention · competent expression. Not status.
- Sentence conditions: expectancy · fitness · proximity · intended meaning.
- Memory excluded for lack of novelty; Prābhākara excludes it for lack of presentative character.
- Nyāya: extrinsic for **both** validity and invalidity. Mīmāṃsā: intrinsic validity, extrinsic invalidity.
- Instrument ≠ fruit for Nyāya, because realism separates the reaching from what reaches; Dignāga tightens them.

SESSION 11 - WHEN KNOWING FAILS: THE MISPLACEMENT THEORY OF ERROR

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: You see a piece of shell on the beach and take it for silver. Nyāya refuses to say you saw nothing, and refuses to say you saw something that is neither real nor unreal. It says you saw two real things and joined them wrongly.

Technical definition: Misplacement theory of error (anyathākhyāti) is Nyāya's account of illusion: in the standard shell-silver case both the presented "this" and the silver are **real**, and the error consists in apprehending silver - which exists elsewhere - **as here**. Error is therefore **wrong synthesis or misplacement (anyathā, "otherwise")**, not the apprehension of a non-entity.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Nyāya's theory of error is the strongest test of its realism, because a realist must explain how a cognition can be false without conceding that the mind ever encounters anything unreal - and its solution is to relocate the falsity from the objects to the relation asserted between them.

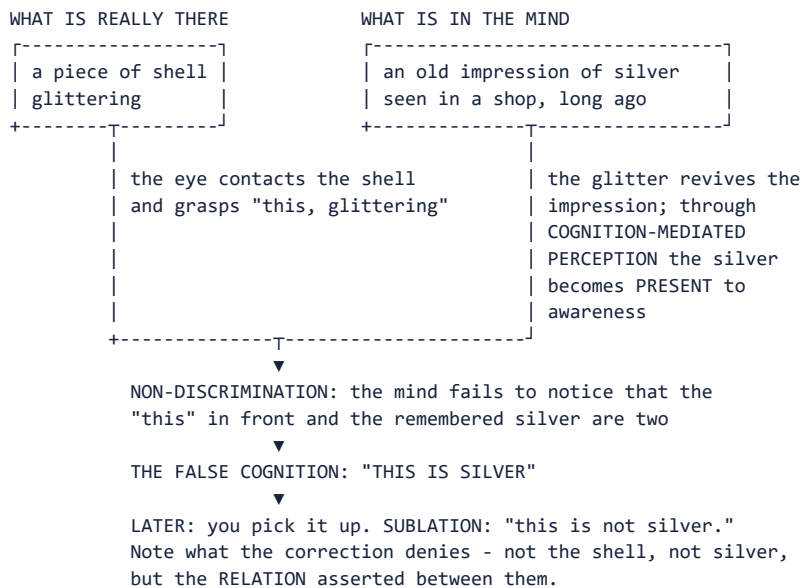
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **misplacement theory of error (anyathākhyāti)** - a real object taken as being where it is not
- **cognition-mediated perception (jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa)** - the mechanism of presentation
- **non-discrimination (bheda-agraha)** - the failure that permits the wrong synthesis
- **the four rivals:** self-apprehension (*ātmakhyāti*), apprehension of the non-existent (*asatkhyāti*), non-apprehension of difference (*akhyāti*), the indefinable (*anirvacanīya-khyāti*)
- **sublation (bādha)** - the later corrective cognition "this is not silver"

How to use them: for the 2019 fifteen-marker, the answer is a mechanism, not a definition. Show how the silver becomes *present to consciousness* without being physically present, and the question is answered.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

THE SHELL-SILVER CASE, STEP BY STEP



FACT: NOTHING UNREAL WAS EVER PERCEIVED. Realism survives.

In simple words: two real ingredients and one bad join. The shell is real, silver is real, and the mistake lies entirely in the "is here" that the mind supplied. This is why the correcting cognition takes the form "this is *not* silver" rather than "silver does not exist".

Remember first	Meaning
Both terms real	Neither the locus nor the misapplied object is unreal
The error	Lies in the relation, not in either relatum
Mechanism	Cognition-mediated perception makes the absent object present to awareness
Enabling failure	Non-discrimination between the presented and the remembered
Correction	Sublation denies the relation, which is why realism is untouched

One-line memory: in Nyāya, you never see nothing and you never see something impossible - you see something real, in the wrong place.

VISUAL: VISUAL - FIVE THEORIES OF ERROR ON ONE GRID

ONE ILLUSION. FIVE ACCOUNTS OF WHAT WENT WRONG.

THEORY	SCHOOL	ERROR IS ...
misplacement (anyathākhyāti)	NYĀYA	a real object known elsewhere, apprehended as being HERE
self-apprehension (ātmakhyāti)	YOGĀCĀRA	an internal cognition projected outward as if external
apprehension of the non-existent (asatkhyāti)	MĀDHYAMIKA, in standard doxography	apprehension of the utterly non-existent
non-apprehension of difference (akhyāti)	PRĀBHĀKARA MĪMĀṂSĀ	FAILURE TO DISCRIMINATE two cognitions, each of them valid - there is no false cognition
the indefinable (anirvacaniya-khyāti)	ADVĀITA VEDĀNTA	an object that is NEITHER real NOR unreal, projected by beginningless nescience

READ THE GRID AS A SPECTRUM OF ONTOLOGICAL COST

Prābhākara pays least (no false cognition at all)

Nyāya pays little (two reals, one bad relation)

Yogācāra pays more (externality itself is a construction)

Advaita pays a new ontological status

Asatkhyāti pays most (a cognition of the utterly non-existent)

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Presenting the five theories as a spectrum of ontological cost converts a memorised table into an argument, and it supplies the evaluative sentence a "critically discuss" directive requires.

1. The theory stated precisely

FACT: Nyāya explains illusion through **misplacement (anyathākhyāti)**.

FACT: In the classic shell-silver case, **both** the presented "this" and the silver are **real**. The error lies in taking silver, which exists elsewhere, as **here**.

ANALYSIS: Error is therefore **misplacement or wrong synthesis**, not apprehension of a non-entity.

2. The mechanism in five steps

1. FACT: A present perceptual base exists - the shell.
2. FACT: A past impression of silver is activated by the resemblance (glitter, whiteness).
3. FACT: Through **cognition-mediated perception (jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa)**, the silver becomes **present to consciousness** in a derivative, extraordinary perceptual way.
4. FACT: Due to **non-discrimination**, the mind synthesises the present locus and the remembered object wrongly.
5. FACT: The erroneous cognition "this is silver" results.

ANALYSIS: **Why step 3 is the load-bearing one.** Without it, the theory would have to say that the silver is merely *remembered*, and a memory does not have the presentational character of an illusion - illusions feel like seeing. Cognition-mediated perception is the device that gives the absent object presentational force without giving it physical presence, and it was already introduced in Session 7 as one of the three kinds of extraordinary perception. This continuity is exactly what the 2019 question is testing.

3. Presupposition, and why the theory is required by the rest of the system

ANALYSIS: Nyāya preserves realism even in illusion: cognition goes wrong, but the world is **not** ontologically downgraded into dream-stuff.

ANALYSIS: **The systemic requirement.** Session 7 excluded illusion from valid perception by the non-errancy clause but did not explain it. Session 10 held that validity is extrinsic, which requires that a false cognition can feel exactly like a true one. Misplacement theory is what discharges both debts at once: it explains how a cognition can be phenomenally indistinguishable from a veridical one while being false, and it does so without admitting any unreal object.

4. Distinction from the rival theories of error

Theory	School	Error explained as
misplacement (anyathākhyāti)	Nyāya	real object known elsewhere, mislocated here
self-apprehension (ātmakhyāti)	Yogācāra	internal cognition projected outward
apprehension of the non-existent (asatkhyāti)	Mādhymika reading in standard doxography	apprehension of the non-existent
non-apprehension of difference (akhyāti)	Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā	failure to discriminate two valid cognitions
the indefinable (anirvacanīya-khyāti)	Advaita Vedānta	error-object neither real nor unreal

ANALYSIS: **The sharpest contrast to write.** Prābhākara's account says there is **no false cognition at all** - only a perception and a memory that were not discriminated, so that the "error" lies in the resulting activity rather than in any cognition. Nyāya replies that this cannot account for the corrective cognition's form: "this is **not** silver" denies something that was asserted, and on Prābhākara's account nothing was ever asserted to deny.

5. Cognition-mediated perception and the 2019 question

FACT: Nyāya uses **cognition-mediated perception** to explain how the silver can be **experientially present** without being **physically present** in that location.

ANALYSIS: It bridges memory and presentative awareness while preserving realism.

ANALYSIS: **The three-part answer structure for 2019.** (i) State what misplacement theory must explain - presentational force without physical presence. (ii) Introduce cognition-mediated perception as the extraordinary perception in which a prior cognition serves as the connecting relation. (iii) Show the pay-off: because the silver is *perceptually* present rather than merely remembered, the illusion has the immediacy of seeing, and because it is present only through a prior cognition, no unreal object is admitted.

6. The reply to the Advaita account (the 2021 routed comparison)

FACT: Nyāya objects that the Advaitin's "**neither real nor unreal**" status is **obscure** and violates the classical logical alternatives - an entity is either existent or non-existent, and a third status is unintelligible without independent argument.

FACT: For Nyāya, the error-object must be explainable using **real entities and cognitive misrelation**; no third ontological status is needed, and the principle of economy tells against inventing one.

ANALYSIS: **The Advaita counter, stated fairly.** The Advaitin replies that the silver cannot be simply real, since it is sublated; and cannot be simply unreal, since it was actually presented and even caused activity - one reaches for it. The indefinable status is a description of that double failure, not an arbitrary third value. ANALYSIS: Nyāya's rejoinder is that misplacement already explains both facts without the new status: the silver is real (hence presentable and motivating) and it is not here (hence sublated). **Verdict line:** Nyāya wins on economy; Advaita presses that economy purchased by relocating the whole difficulty into the relation is not obviously cheaper than relocating it into the object.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION

Claim. Misplacement theory is the account of error that a consistent realist is forced to adopt, and it should be defended on that structural ground rather than merely described. **Named evidence.** In the shell-silver illusion both terms are real, the silver is made present through cognition-mediated perception rather than through physical contact, non-discrimination permits the wrong synthesis, and the corrective cognition takes the form "this is not silver" - denying a relation, not an entity. **Analysis.** The form of the corrective cognition is decisive evidence for the theory, because a correction that denies location rather than existence shows that what was false was the placing; and this simultaneously discharges two earlier commitments, the exclusion of illusion by the non-errancy clause and the extrinsic account of validity that requires false cognitions to be phenomenally indistinguishable from true ones. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: The economy is real but contested: Prābhākara denies that there is any false cognition to explain, and Advaita argues that the presented silver's double failure - sublated yet motivating - is what its indefinable status records, so Nyāya's advantage is one of parsimony rather than of demonstration.

UPSC TRAPS - SESSION 11

- ANALYSIS: Confusing misplacement (*anyathākhyāti*) with the indefinable (*anirvacanīya-khyāti*). This is among the most penalised confusions in the paper.
- ANALYSIS: Saying the silver is unreal. Both terms are real; only the relation is false.
- ANALYSIS: Omitting cognition-mediated perception, which is the mechanism the 2019 question names.
- ANALYSIS: Attributing *akhyāti* to Bhāṭṭa. It is the **Prābhākara** position.
- ANALYSIS: Presenting the corrective cognition as "silver does not exist". It is "this is **not** silver".
- ANALYSIS: Dismissing the Advaita position without stating its argument from sublation and motivation.

RAPID REVISION - SESSION 11

- Misplacement: real object known elsewhere, apprehended here; error is in the relation.
- Mechanism: present base -> revived impression -> cognition-mediated perception -> non-discrimination -> false cognition -> sublation.
- Five rivals: Nyāya misplacement · Yogācāra self-apprehension · Mādhyamika non-existent · Prābhākara non-apprehension of difference · Advaita indefinable.
- 2019: the question is about the **mechanism** - presentational force without physical presence.
- 2021: Nyāya rejects a third ontological status on grounds of logic and economy; Advaita answers from sublation plus motivation.
- Systemic role: discharges the non-errancy exclusion of Session 7 and supports extrinsic validity from Session 10.

SESSION 12 - WHO IS BOUND: SELF, MIND AND RELEASE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Nyāya says there really is a "you" - an enduring thing that desires, tries, suffers and knows. But it also says that knowing is something that *happens to* you rather than something you *are*, and that being finally free means the happening stops.

Technical definition: The **self (ātman)** is a real, eternal, all-pervading substance, distinct from body, senses and mind, in which cognition, pleasure, pain, desire, aversion, effort, merit and demerit inhere as **adventitious qualities**. The **sensory mind (manas)** is an eternal **atomic** internal organ mediating between self and the external senses.

Release (apavarga) is the **absolute cessation of pain (duḥkha-atyanta-nivṛtti)**, not a positive state of bliss.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Nyāya's self is the most counter-intuitive item in its realism: it is affirmed on the ground that desiring, striving and suffering require someone to whom they belong, and yet it is defined so that in its liberated condition it neither desires, strives, suffers nor knows - which is precisely the tension every evaluative question on this topic is built around.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **self (ātman)** - eternal substance, all-pervading, plural
- **adventitious quality** - consciousness belongs to the self, is not its nature
- **six marks (liṅga)** - desire, aversion, effort, pleasure, pain, cognition
- **sensory mind (manas)** - atomic, one per self, hence serial attention
- **release (apavarga)** - absolute cessation of pain
- **defects (doṣa)** - attachment, aversion, delusion (*rāga, dveṣa, moha*)
- **stone-like liberation** - the standing objection

How to use them: the 2024 question asks for **six** reasons. Give Gautama's canonical six and label the supplementary arguments separately. Substituting memory and recognition for one of the six is a direct loss of marks.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

WHY NYĀYA THINKS THERE MUST BE A SELF

You say: "I wanted that." -> wanting needs a WANTER
You say: "I avoided that." -> avoiding needs an AVOIDER
You say: "I tried." -> trying needs a TRIER
You say: "I enjoyed it." -> enjoying needs an ENJOYER
You say: "It hurt me." -> hurting needs a SUFFERER
You say: "I know this." -> knowing is a QUALITY, and a quality must inhere in a SUBSTANCE

Six episodic qualities, all appropriated by one "I".
The qualities come and go. The "I" does not.

=> AN ENDURING SELF-SUBSTANCE (ātman)

BUT NOTE THE PRICE
If cognition is only a QUALITY of the self, then the self can exist
WITHOUT it - in deep sleep, and in liberation.

In simple words: the argument is grammatical before it is metaphysical. Every mental episode is reported as belonging to someone. Nyāya takes that ownership seriously and asks what kind of thing an owner has to be. Its answer is: a substance, because only substances can have qualities. The cost of that answer is that the owner outlives what it owns - which is why Nyāya's liberated self is conscious of nothing.

Remember first	Meaning
Self	Substance; eternal; all-pervading; many , one per person
Consciousness	A quality of the self, not its essence - the key Advaita contrast
Mind	Atomic, eternal, one per self; hence one cognition at a time
Release	Cessation of pain, not attainment of bliss
Ladder	knowledge -> error removed -> defects cease -> action ceases -> birth ceases -> pain ceases

One-line memory: for Nyāya you are the one who has experiences, not the experiencing - and freedom is the end of having them.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE SIX MARKS, AND WHAT MUST NOT BE SUBSTITUTED

GAUTAMA'S CANONICAL FORMULA
icchā-dveṣa-prayatna-sukha-duḥkha-jñānāny ātmano liṅgam
"desire, aversion, effort, pleasure, pain and cognition are the marks of the self"

1	desire (icchā)	requires a subject who desires
2	aversion (dveṣa)	requires a subject who rejects or avoids
3	effort (prayatna)	requires an agent of striving
4	pleasure (sukha)	requires an experiencer
5	pain (duḥkha)	requires an experiencer
6	cognition (jñāna)	is a QUALITY -> needs a substance to inhere

► THE ARGUMENT IS CUMULATIVE: these qualities vary, but their appropriation as "I desire", "I suffer", "I know" points to ONE enduring self-substance.

ANALYSIS: SUPPLEMENTARY - VALUABLE, BUT NOT PART OF THE CANONICAL SIX

• memory and recognition -> support PERSISTENCE across time
• the coordinated body-sense-mind complex -> supports an INSTRUMENT-USER inference

► Use these to enrich a 15- or 20-marker. NEVER swap one of them in for one of the six when the question says "six reasons".

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The separation between the canonical six and the supplementary two is the entire content of the 2024 question. A script that gives eight arguments in one undifferentiated list has failed the instruction even if every argument in it is sound.

1. The self: statement

FACT: The **self (ātman)** is a real enduring substance distinct from body, senses and mind.

FACT: Consciousness is **not its essence** but an **adventitious quality** arising under proper conditions - specifically, under the conjunction of self with mind, mind with sense, and sense with object.

ANALYSIS: **Two further properties worth naming.** The self is **all-pervading (vibhu)**, which is why it does not travel at rebirth - what changes is the body-mind complex conjoined with it; and selves are **many**, one per person, which is what distinguishes Nyāya from Advaita's single self and aligns it with Sāṃkhya's plurality of conscious witnesses without adopting Sāṃkhya's account of their nature.

2. The six arguments, in Gautama's sequence

FACT: Gautama's six canonical marks are expressed in the sequence: **desire, aversion, effort, pleasure, pain and cognition are signs of the self (icchā-dveṣa-prayatna-sukha-duḥkha-jñānāny ātmano liṅgam).**

1. **desire (icchā)** requires a subject who desires;
2. **aversion (dveṣa)** requires a subject who rejects or avoids;
3. **effort or volition (prayatna)** requires an agent of striving;
4. **pleasure (sukha)** requires an experiencer;
5. **pain (duḥkha)** requires an experiencer;
6. **cognition (jñāna / buddhi)** is a quality and therefore requires a substance in which it inheres.

FACT: The argument is **cumulative**: these episodic qualities vary, but their appropriation as "I desire", "I suffer" and "I know" points to **one enduring self-substance**.

ANALYSIS: **Supplementary, not part of the canonical six.** Memory and recognition support persistence across time, while the coordinated body-sense-mind complex supports an instrument-user inference. **Do not substitute these supplementary arguments for Gautama's six** when the question asks for the six reasons.

ANALYSIS: **The inferential form, if the examiner wants it.** Desire for what one earlier experienced requires that the earlier experiencer and the present desirer be one; the body changes and the senses are many, so neither can be that one; therefore a distinct enduring substance is inferred. Notice that this is a **negative-only (kevalavyatireki)** inference in the Session 8 classification - there is no independent similar instance of a self - which is why the school's fallacy theory and its theory of the self are technically connected.

3. The sensory mind: atomic, and why that matters

FACT: **Manas** is an **atomic** internal organ.

FACT: It mediates between the self and the external senses.

FACT: Because the mind is atomic, the self attends to **one sense-cognition at a time**.

ANALYSIS: **The explanatory payoff.** This is not an idle piece of psychology. It explains why simultaneous cognitions do not occur, and it is also the reason cognition can lapse entirely: in deep sleep the mind withdraws from conjunction with the senses, so no cognition arises although the self persists. That single mechanism prepares the account of liberation in point 5 below.

4. The distinction from Advaita

FACT: **Nyāya**: consciousness is a **quality of** the self. FACT: **Advaita**: consciousness is the very **nature of** the self.

ANALYSIS: This is one of the most examinable contrasts in Indian philosophy, and it should be stated with its consequence attached: for Nyāya an unconscious self is intelligible, and indeed is what liberation delivers; for Advaita an unconscious self is a contradiction in terms.

ANALYSIS: **Do not over-extend the contrast.** Both schools agree that the self is eternal and that liberation is the goal. The disagreement is about the relation of consciousness to the self, and about plurality - many selves for Nyāya, one for Advaita.

5. The objection about the empty self, and the reply

CAUTION: **Objection.** If the self without cognition can still exist, does it become an empty abstraction - a substance with no describable character?

FACT: **Reply.** Nyāya accepts that the self can exist **without manifest cognition**, as in deep sleep or in liberation, because cognition depends on conjunction with mind, senses and objects. The self is not thereby characterless: it remains the substance that is capable of bearing those qualities when the conditions obtain, and its capacity is not annulled by the absence of the occasion.

ANALYSIS: **Where the objection retains force.** A capacity that is never again exercised is difficult to distinguish, in practice, from its absence. This is the exact point at which the objection to the self becomes the objection to liberation, treated next.

6. Release: statement and the ladder

FACT: **Apavarga** is **absolute cessation of pain: duḥkha-atyanta-nivṛtti***.

FACT: It is **not** primarily a positive bliss-state in Nyāya's standard formulation.

FACT: **The ladder to liberation.** The classic Nyāya chain runs:

- true knowledge of reality (tattva-jñāna)
- > removal of false notion (mithyā-jñāna)
- > cessation of defects: attachment, aversion, delusion (rāga, dveṣa, moha)
- > cessation of activity (pravṛtti)
- > cessation of birth (janma)
- > cessation of suffering (duḥkha)
- > RELEASE (apavarga)

ANALYSIS: Knowledge matters **not** because it reveals identity with Brahman, but because it removes the error that sustains bondage-producing activity. This distinction - instrumental knowledge versus identity-revealing knowledge - is the cleanest way to separate Nyāya soteriology from Advaita in one sentence.

ANALYSIS: **Read the ladder backwards for the exam.** Each rung is a *cessation* produced by removing the condition of the next. That is what makes the chain an argument rather than a list: if the first removal is possible, every subsequent removal follows.

7. The nature of the liberated self, and the stone-like objection

FACT: In release the self remains as a **pure substance without pleasure, pain, desire, aversion or even ordinary cognition**.

FACT: Consciousness ceases because the required conjunction of self, mind, senses and objects ceases.

FACT: **The objection.** Critics object that such liberation is "**stone-like**": why seek a state devoid of consciousness or bliss? A liberated self so described appears indistinguishable from an inert substance.

FACT: **Nyāya's reply.** The aim is **freedom from suffering, not acquisition of bliss**.

ANALYSIS: Bliss may itself be **relational** and capable of engendering attachment; release is secure precisely because it is sheer freedom from all suffering-conditions, and a state that could generate attachment would not be secure.

ANALYSIS: **The honest evaluation.** The reply is internally coherent - a negative goal cannot be undermined by the absence of positive content - but it carries a motivational cost that no argument removes: a goal that no one can desire as a state is difficult to make attractive as an end of practice. ANALYSIS: Note also that the objection is pressed hardest by **Advaita**, for whom liberation is the self's own blissful nature, and that Nyāya can partly deflect it by pointing out that its own account at least explains why liberation is permanent - nothing remains that could be lost.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION

Claim. Nyāya's self and its account of release are a single package, and the strangeness of the second follows rigorously from the classification decision made in the first. **Named evidence.** Gautama's six marks - desire, aversion, effort, pleasure, pain and cognition - establish the self as the substance in which those qualities inhere; and since cognition arises only under the conjunction of self, mind, senses and objects, release is defined as absolute cessation of pain with no cognition remaining. **Analysis.** The chain is tight: once consciousness is classed as an adventitious quality rather than as the self's nature, an unconscious self becomes intelligible, and once the goal is stated as removal rather than acquisition, the ladder from true knowledge through the cessation of defects, activity and birth follows without further premisses. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: The cost is the stone-like liberation objection, which Nyāya answers by denying that bliss is the goal and by noting that bliss is relational and attachment-generating - a coherent reply that nevertheless leaves the motivational difficulty untouched.

UPSC TRAPS - SESSION 12

- ANALYSIS: Writing that consciousness is the essence of the self in Nyāya. It is an **adventitious quality**.
- ANALYSIS: Giving eight arguments when the question asks for the canonical **six**.
- ANALYSIS: Saying the self travels at rebirth. It is all-pervading; the associated complex changes.
- ANALYSIS: Treating release as bliss. It is absolute cessation of pain.
- ANALYSIS: Forgetting that the mind is **atomic**, which is what explains serial attention and deep sleep.
- ANALYSIS: Presenting the stone-like objection as answered rather than as answered-with-a-cost.

RAPID REVISION - SESSION 12

- Self: substance, eternal, all-pervading, many; consciousness inheres as an adventitious quality.
- Six marks: desire, aversion, effort, pleasure, pain, cognition. Supplementary: memory/recognition and the instrument-user argument.
- Mind: atomic, eternal, one per self -> one cognition at a time; deep sleep = withdrawal of conjunction.
- Nyāya vs Advaita: quality *of* the self versus nature *of* the self; many selves versus one.
- Release = absolute cessation of pain; the ladder runs knowledge -> error -> defects -> activity -> birth -> pain.
- Stone-like objection: answered by "freedom from suffering, not acquisition of bliss"; motivational cost remains.

SESSION 13 - WHO GOVERNS: GOD AS EFFICIENT CAUSE AND UDAYANA'S CUMULATIVE PROOFS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Nyāya's God does not make the world out of nothing. Atoms and selves were always there. What God does is start the machine, keep it running, hand out the moral consequences and author the scripture.

Technical definition: In developed Nyāya and the later Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika synthesis, **God (Īśvara)** is an eternal, omniscient, bodiless and supremely powerful special self who is the **efficient cause (nimitta-kāraṇa)** of the world but **never its material cause** - the material cause remains the eternal atoms. **Udayana**, especially in the **Nyāyakusumāñjali***, develops the systematic arguments, best read as a **cumulative case** rather than as one demonstrative proof.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Udayana's achievement is not a single knock-down argument for God but the construction of a converging case: each strand - from effect, from first combination, from sustenance, from moral allocation and from scripture - can be resisted in isolation, and the claim is that together they leave one explanatory hypothesis standing.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **efficient cause (nimitta-kāraṇa)** - never material cause
- **from effect (kāryāt)** · **from combination (āyojanāt)** · **from support (dhr̥tyādeḥ)** · **from scripture (śruteḥ)**

- **unseen moral force (adṛṣṭa)** - what God's volition operates with
- **reliable authority (āpta)** - God as the source of the Veda in later Nyāya
- **special conscious witness (puruṣa-viśeṣa)** - the Yoga contrast
- **disanalogy (vaiṣamya)** - the Buddhist charge against the pot-potter model

How to use them: the 2018 question is a two-part comparison; the 2019 question names the four proofs. Do not answer one with the other's structure. For 2019, give the four proofs *as inferences*; for 2018, give the proofs briefly and spend the marks on the Nyāya-Yoga difference.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

WHAT NYĀYA'S GOD IS - AND IS NOT

IS -----	IS NOT -----
an eternal, omniscient special self	the material out of which the
the EFFICIENT cause of the world	world is made
the arranger of atoms at creation	a creator from nothing
the dispenser of karmic fruit	an arbitrary ruler above karma
the source of Vedic authority	Advaita's non-dual Brahman
bodiless, yet an agent	Sāṃkhya's rejected superfluity

THE THREE JOBS, IN ORDER OF THE ARGUMENTS

-----	-----
COSMIC	conjoins atoms at the start of a cycle, working WITH the
	unseen moral force (adṛṣṭa) of souls
MORAL	allots the fruits of action, because an unconscious
	moral force cannot allot anything intelligently
SCRIPTURAL	is the reliable author/source of the Veda in later Nyāya

In simple words: think of a cosmic engineer working with materials he did not create and to a specification he did not write. The atoms are given; the moral ledger of past lives is given. God's role is to start the assembly at the right moment and to see that the ledger is honoured. That is why the problem of evil takes a peculiar form here: God is not accused of designing suffering, only of administering a system in which it is earned.

Remember first	Meaning
Efficient only	Atoms are the material cause; this is governance, not creation from nothing
Cumulative	Four or more converging strands, not one demonstration
<i>Adṛṣṭa</i>	Unseen moral force; unconscious, hence requiring an intelligent administrator
Historical caution	Kaṇāda's own text does not unambiguously foreground a creator
Yoga contrast	A special conscious witness and object of devotion, not a proved cosmic maker

One-line memory: Nyāya's God is inferred as the intelligence the world's order requires, not revealed as the being from whom the world proceeds.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE FOUR PROOFS AS FOUR INFERENCES

EACH PROOF IS A FORMAL INFERENCE. GIVE THE FOUR COLUMNS AND THE MARK IS SAFE.

PROOF	SUBJECT (pakṣa)	REASON (hetu)	TO BE PROVED (sādhya)	EXAMPLE (dṛṣṭānta)
FROM EFFECT (kāryāt)	the world	it is an effect, composite and ordered	it has an intelligent maker	pot and potter
FROM COMBINATION (āyojanāt)	primordial atomic conjunction	unconscious atoms and unconscious adṛṣṭa cannot initiate ordered FIRST motion	it requires an intelligent impeller	ordered arrangement by an agent
FROM SUPPORT (dhr̥tyādeḥ)	the ordered cosmos	it is sustained, regulated and dissolved	it requires governing intelligence	a regulated artefact
FROM WORDS AND SCRIPTURE (padāt/śruteḥ/vākyāt)	Vedic and meaningful sentences	sentences require competent authorship, and Vedic scope exceeds ordinary knowledge	the Veda has an omniscient source	ordinary competent speaker
ANALYSIS: MORAL ADMINISTRATION	karmic distribution	unconscious adṛṣṭa cannot allot fruits with moral precision	an intelligent administrator is required	a just allocation system

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Casting each proof in the Session 8 format converts a list into an application of the school's own logic, and it makes the objections legible too - the Buddhist attack on the pot-potter example is an attack on the *example column*, not on the reason.

1. God: statement, nature, and the historical control

FACT: Developed Nyāya and the later Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika synthesis affirm **God (Īśvara)** as an eternal, omniscient and supremely powerful being.

FACT: God is the **efficient cause (nimitta-kāraṇa)**, **not** the material cause of the world. The material cause remains **atoms**.

ANALYSIS: **Historical control matters.** Kaṇāda does **not** unambiguously make God central in the foundational Vaiśeṣika text; later Vaiśeṣika commentators and Naiyāyikas explicitly develop the theistic synthesis.

FACT: **Nature.** God is often characterised as a **special self never bound by karma**. He orders atoms at creation, dispenses karmic fruits, and in later Nyāya authors the Veda.

ANALYSIS: **Distinction.** Nyāya's God is **not** Advaita's non-dual Brahman and **not** Sāṃkhya's rejected superfluity. He is a real personal-intelligent governor **within a pluralist realist metaphysics** - which is why he can be omnipotent in his own domain while working with materials and a moral ledger he did not originate.

2. Udayana's project, and why it is cumulative

FACT: **Udayana**, especially in the **Nyāyakusumāñjali***, develops systematic arguments for God.

FACT: **Structure.** The work is best read as a reply to **successive objections**, not as one solitary proof mechanically added to Nyāya metaphysics. It removes obstacles to theism step by step: that there is no unseen cause; that an unseen cause needs no intelligent controller; that Vedic authority can stand without an author; and that karma or atoms can function without governance.

ANALYSIS: **Twenty-mark payoff.** A strong answer presents the proofs as a **converging or cumulative-case argument**: each strand alone can be challenged, but together they are said to converge on one explanatory hypothesis.

CAUTION: **Count caution.** The exact naming and count vary somewhat across secondary presentations. Where the exact traditional label is uncertain, write "commonly enumerated as" rather than inventing a fixed count.

3. The four major arguments (the 2019 demand)

(a) From effect (kāryāt).

- FACT: The world is an effect because it is composite and made of parts.
- FACT: Effects require an intelligent efficient cause.
- FACT: Therefore the world requires God.
- ANALYSIS: This is Nyāya's strongest cosmological-teleological bridge.

(b) From combination or arrangement (āyojanāt).

- FACT: At the beginning of creation, atoms must first combine.
- FACT: Unintelligent atoms cannot purposively initiate ordered combination.
- FACT: Therefore an intelligent arranger is required: God.
- ANALYSIS: Note that this argument is doing work the first cannot: it is not about the world's being an effect but specifically about the **initiation of the first motion**, which links directly to Session 14's atomism.

(c) From support and sustenance (dhr̥tyādeḥ).

- FACT: The order, maintenance and dissolution of the cosmos suggest sustaining intelligence.
- ANALYSIS: This moves from bare origination to **continuing governance**.

(d) From scripture (śruteḥ).

- FACT: The Veda is authoritative knowledge.
- FACT: Such authoritative revelation implies an omniscient source.
- FACT: Therefore God.

FACT: **Additional arguments often cited:** from words and linguistic convention (*padāt*); from the structure of cognition and authoritative knowledge (*pratyayataḥ*); from meaningful sentences, especially Vedic sentences (*vākyāt*); and from determinate numerical modes of atomic combination (*saṅkhyāviśeṣāt*).

ANALYSIS: **Presuppositions.** These proofs presuppose that **order, meaningfulness and purposiveness require intelligence** rather than being emergent or brute. Name this presupposition in an evaluative answer: every serious objection below is an attack on it.

4. The explanatory hypothesis, stated as a hypothesis

FACT: **Thesis.** God is an omniscient, eternal, **bodiless agent** who is the efficient but not material cause of the world.

FACT: **Cosmic role.** God conjoins atoms at the beginning of a creative cycle through volition operating **with the unseen moral force (adr̥ṣṭa) of souls**.

FACT: **Moral role.** God dispenses karmic fruits, because unconscious *adr̥ṣṭa* cannot intelligently allot results by itself.

FACT: **Scriptural role.** God is the **reliable authority (āpta)** who is the author or source of the Veda in later Nyāya theism.

5. Objections and replies, with residual force stated

Opponent	Objection	Nyāya reply	Residual force
FACT: Mīmāṃsā / Kumārila	FACT: The Veda is authorless, and ritual potency (<i>apūrva</i>) can link action to fruit without God.	FACT: Meaningful authoritative sentences and moral dispensation are better explained by an omniscient reliable authority; unconscious <i>apūrva</i> cannot administer fruits.	ANALYSIS: If Vedic authorlessness is accepted, the scriptural proof loses force.
FACT: Sāṃkhya	FACT: Primordial nature's own teleology explains the world, and a perfect God has no motive to create.	FACT: Unconscious primordial nature cannot purposively allocate karma or initiate ordered atomic motion; God's action follows souls' <i>adr̥ṣṭa</i> , not desire-based lack.	ANALYSIS: The motive problem remains if divine action is modelled too anthropomorphically.
FACT: Buddhist (Dharmakīrti and Śāntarakṣita-style)	FACT: The world is not observed as an effect in the relevant sense, and the pot-potter analogy fails by disanalogy (vaiṣamya) , since a potter has a body, hands and external material.	FACT: Nyāya treats composite, ordered, dependent wholes as inferable effects, and allows a bodiless omniscient agent because embodiment is not essential to agency.	ANALYSIS: The analogy is strained, because worldly makers are always embodied.
FACT: Cārvāka	FACT: God is never perceived, and inference itself is unreliable.	FACT: Nyāya first defends invariable concomitance and inference; once inference is secured, imperceptibility alone does not disprove a cause.	ANALYSIS: The proof works only for someone who grants Nyāya's theory of the means of valid knowledge.
FACT: Advaita	FACT: God is real only at the empirical (vyāvahārika) level, not at ultimate non-dual reality.	FACT: Nyāya rejects the two-level downgrade and insists on a plural realist ontology.	ANALYSIS: The disagreement is rooted in incompatible metaphysical starting-points.
FACT: Problem of evil	FACT: If God is good and omnipotent, why is there suffering?	FACT: God dispenses fruits according to beginningless karma ; evil is traceable to souls' karma, not to divine arbitrariness.	ANALYSIS: This saves goodness at the cost of independence, because God appears constrained by a karmic order he did not create.

ANALYSIS: How to close an evaluative God answer. The strongest verdict line concedes the cumulative structure's genuine strength - it is not defeated by refuting any single strand - while noting that a cumulative case is only as strong as the shared presupposition beneath all its strands, and here that presupposition is precisely what every named opponent denies.

6. Nyāya and Yoga do not prove God in the same way (the 2018 demand)

Issue	Nyāya	Classical Yoga
Primary characterisation	Omniscient efficient cause, arranger of atoms, karmic governor and source of authoritative testimony	Special conscious witness (puruṣa-viśeṣa) untouched by afflictions, actions, fruits and latent deposits
Main argumentative role	Inferred through world-effect, atomic arrangement, sustenance, moral administration and scripture	Admitted within the soteriology of Pātañjala Yoga as beginningless teacher and support of meditative discipline
Relation to the world	Efficient, not material, cause in the later Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika cosmos	The <i>Yoga-sūtra</i> does not build Udayana's full atomic creator inference
Practice	Knowledge of God supports metaphysical explanation and liberation	Devotion to God (Īśvara-praṇidhāna) aids concentration and meditative absorption

FACT: Both systems accept God, but **sameness of name does not prove sameness of demonstration or function.**

ANALYSIS: Later Yoga commentators may strengthen theistic cosmology. The safe verdict is that classical Yoga's special conscious witness and meditative support are **not** established through the same cumulative natural theology

as Nyāya.

ANALYSIS: The structure the 2018 question wants. It asks "if yes, how? and if no, why?" - so the answer must be explicitly disjunctive. Give the Nyāya proofs compactly, then answer "no", then give the reason: Yoga's God is *admitted* as a soteriological posit within a system that already has a complete account of bondage and release, whereas Nyāya's God is *inferred* as the explanation of cosmic and moral order. The difference is in the **argumentative role**, not merely in the description.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION

Claim. Udayana's theism should be assessed as a cumulative explanatory case, because that is the form in which he actually presents it. **Named evidence.** The *Nyāyakusumāñjali* proceeds by removing successive obstacles - that there is no unseen cause, that an unseen cause needs no controller, that Vedic authority needs no author, that karma and atoms need no governance - and the proofs from effect, from first combination, from sustenance and from scripture converge on one hypothesis: an omniscient bodiless efficient cause operating with the unseen moral force of souls. **Analysis.** Read cumulatively, the proofs are mutually supporting rather than redundant, since each addresses a different explanandum - the world's compositeness, the initiation of first motion, continuing regulation, and the authority of scripture - and the refutation of any one leaves the others standing. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: Every strand nonetheless rests on the single presupposition that order and meaningfulness require intelligence, and this is exactly what Mīmāṃsā, Sāṃkhya, Buddhist and Cārvāka opponents deny, so the cumulative case is strong internally and question-begging externally.

UPSC TRAPS - SESSION 13

- ANALYSIS: Making God the material cause. He is **efficient only**; atoms are the material cause.
- ANALYSIS: Attributing the full creator-God apparatus to Kaṇāda's own text.
- ANALYSIS: Saying Nyāya and Yoga prove God in the same way. The 2018 answer is a reasoned "no".
- ANALYSIS: Presenting the four proofs as a list rather than as inferences with subject, reason, property and example.
- ANALYSIS: Ignoring the Buddhist disanalogy charge against the pot-potter example.
- ANALYSIS: Claiming the problem of evil is solved. It is *answered* by karma, at the cost of divine independence.

RAPID REVISION - SESSION 13

- God: eternal, omniscient, bodiless, **efficient cause only**; a special self never bound by karma.
- Four proofs: from effect · from combination · from support · from scripture. Also words, cognition, sentences, numerical modes.
- Cumulative reading: successive obstacle-removal in the *Nyāyakusumāñjali*, converging on one hypothesis.
- Objections: Mīmāṃsā authorless Veda · Sāṃkhya no motive · Buddhist disanalogy · Cārvāka anti-inference · Advaita two levels · evil.
- 2018: Yoga's God is a special conscious witness and object of devotion, not the conclusion of a creator inference.
- Shared presupposition: order and meaning require intelligence - that is where every objection lands.

SESSION 14 - HOW THINGS ARE MADE: NEW PRODUCTION, THREE CAUSES AND ATOMISM

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Does a pot already exist, hidden, in the lump of clay? Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika says no. Making something means bringing into being a genuinely new whole that was not there before - and the world itself is made the same way, out of eternal atoms.

Technical definition: Non-pre-existence of the effect (asatkāryavāda), also called **the doctrine of new beginning (ārambhavāda)**, holds that the effect does **not** pre-exist in its cause but is a genuinely new production. A **cause** is an **unconditional and invariable antecedent** - prior (*pūrvavṛtti*), invariably prior (*niyata-pūrvavṛtti*) and not otherwise established (*ananyathāsiddha*). **Atomism (paramāṇuvāda)** holds that the ultimate material constituents are

eternal, partless, imperceptible **atoms (paramāṇu)** combining into dyads and triads under the direction of unseen moral force and divine will.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika's theory of causation is not merely the denial of Sāṃkhya's pre-existent effect; it is a positive account in which production is real emergence, and its most powerful weapon is a category the rival ontology cannot use - the prior non-existence that the effect must have had if production was ever to mean anything.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **non-pre-existence of the effect (asatkāryavāda) / new beginning (ārambhavāda)**
- **unconditional invariable antecedent** - the definition of a cause
- **not otherwise established (ananyathāsiddha)** and **otherwise established (anyathāsiddha)**
- **causal complex (kāraṇa-sāmagrī)** and **absence of a blocker (pratibandhakābhāva)**
- **inherent (samavāyi), non-inherent (asamavāyi)** and **efficient (nimitta) causes**
- **atom (paramāṇu) · dyad (dvyaṇuka) · triad (tryaṇuka / trasareṇu)**
- **creation (sṛṣṭi)** and **dissolution (pralaya)**

How to use them: the 2020 question is entirely about *anyathāsiddha* and *ananyathāsiddha*; the 2023 question is entirely about prior non-existence against Sāṃkhya; the 2021 and 2025 questions are the general theory. Identify which of the four you are facing before writing a line.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

THE SEED AND THE TREE - TWO ANSWERS

SĀMĀKHYA (satkāryavāda)

The tree is **ALREADY** in the seed, latent, and production is only **MANIFESTATION**.

- nothing new ever appears
- oil from sesame, not sand

NYĀYA-VAIŚEṢIKA (asatkāryavāda)

The tree is **NOT** in the seed. Production makes a **NEW WHOLE** that did not exist before.

- genuine novelty appears
- but only under the right causes

THE SHARED PROBLEM: why do only **SOME** things come from only **SOME** causes?

Sāṃkhya answers: because the effect was there all along.

Nyāya answers: because a cause is an **UNCONDITIONAL, INVARIABLE** antecedent - regularity is built into the definition of cause, not into the effect.

NYĀYA'S DECISIVE MOVE

Before the pot is made, there is a **REAL PRIOR NON-EXISTENCE** of the pot (prāgabhāva) in the clay. A real absence cannot coexist with a latent presence. So the effect was genuinely absent.

In simple words: both schools agree that you cannot get oil from sand. They disagree about why. Sāṃkhya says because the oil was already in the sesame. Nyāya says because "cause" *means* the antecedent that invariably and unconditionally produces this effect - the regularity is in the causal relation, not smuggled into the effect. Nyāya then presses its advantage with the seventh category from Session 6: prior absence is a real feature of the world, and a real absence rules out a latent presence.

Remember first	Meaning
Effect	Genuinely new; not a redescription of the parts
Cause	Unconditional, invariable antecedent, not otherwise established
Three causes	Inherent (threads) · non-inherent (their conjunction) · efficient (the weaver)
Atom	Eternal, partless, indivisible, imperceptible, minute
Combination	2 atoms -> dyad; 3 dyads -> triad = minimum perceptible magnitude

One-line memory: Sāṃkhya makes causation a reveal; Nyāya makes it a build.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE EXCLUSION OF ACCIDENTAL ANTECEDENTS

A POT IS PRODUCED. WHICH OF THESE PRECEDING ITEMS IS A CAUSE?

CANDIDATE ANTECEDENT	VERDICT AND REASON
the clay	CAUSE - inherent (samavāyi) material cause
the potter	CAUSE - efficient (nimitta) cause
the wheel and staff	CAUSE - instrumental, within the causal complex (kāraṇa-sāmagrī)
colour of the potter's staff	OTHERWISE ESTABLISHED - a quality of a causal instrument, irrelevant to the pot
the potter's father	remote cause of the POTTER, not the direct necessary cause of the pot
the sound made by the staff	a CO-EFFECT of the operation, not a producer of the pot
all-pervading space	an ever-present background, not the distinctive unconditional antecedent
the potter's donkey	an accidental companion, not causally indispensable

THE PRINCIPLE

ananyathāsiddha = "not established otherwise" => indispensable causal relevance => genuinely a cause
 anyathāsiddha = "established otherwise" => remote, accidental, co-effect or redundant => EXCLUDED

ANALYSIS: Caption. The five excluded antecedents are a classification of five *different kinds* of irrelevance - quality of an instrument, remoteness, co-effect, omnipresence and accidental accompaniment. Naming which kind each one is turns a memorised list into the analysis the 2020 question asks for.

1. Non-pre-existence of the effect: statement and argument

FACT: Statement. Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika defends **asatkāryavāda**, also called **ārambhavāda**. The effect does **not** pre-exist in its cause; it is a genuinely new beginning.

FACT: Argument.

1. Before production, the effect is absent.
2. If it already existed fully in the cause, production would be meaningless.
3. Production therefore brings forth a new entity.
4. Cloth is not simply threads under another description; it is a **new whole** produced from them.

ANALYSIS: Presupposition. The argument assumes that causal production should explain **novelty**, not merely manifestation. State this: the Sāṃkhya opponent rejects exactly this assumption, so the dispute is about what causation is *for*.

FACT: Distinction. Contrast **Sāṃkhya's satkāryavāda**, where the effect pre-exists in the cause in latent form.

ANALYSIS: The whole-over-parts commitment. Nyāya's position requires that the cloth be a real whole (*avayavin*) distinct from its threads, with new properties of its own. Buddhists deny this, arguing that the whole is either identical with the parts or a further unintelligible entity. Nyāya replies that practical cognition treats the cloth as one thing and that wholes possess properties their parts lack - you can wear a cloth but not a thread. **ANALYSIS:** The reply leans heavily on inference from Session 5, which is why criticisms of inference are simultaneously criticisms of this theory of causation.

2. The definition of a cause, and the exclusion of accidental antecedents (the 2020 demand)

FACT: Nyāya defines a cause as an **unconditional and invariable antecedent**: it precedes the effect (*pūrvavṛtti*), does so invariably (*niyata-pūrvavṛtti*), and is not established as dispensable or otherwise accounted for (*ananyathāsiddha*).

FACT: A **complete cause** is the relevant **causal complex (kāraṇa-sāmagrī)**, including the **absence of a blocking condition (pratibandhakābhāva)**.

FACT: An **accidental or otherwise-established antecedent (anyathāsiddha)** is excluded even if it happens to precede the effect.

Excluded antecedent	Why it is not the cause of the pot
colour of the potter's staff	a quality of a causal instrument but irrelevant to pot-production
the potter's father	remote cause of the potter, not the direct necessary cause of the pot
sound made by the staff	co-effect of the operation, not producer of the pot
all-pervading space	ever-present background, not the distinctive unconditional antecedent
the potter's donkey	accidental companion, not causally indispensable

ANALYSIS: **This is the 2020 answer key.** *Ananyathāsiddha* marks **indispensable causal relevance**; *anyathāsiddha* **blocks over-inclusion** of remote, accidental, co-effect or redundant antecedents.

ANALYSIS: **Why the distinction is required by the theory.** Since Nyāya refuses to locate the effect in the cause, it must locate causal necessity in the *antecedent relation*. But a bare antecedent relation over-generates - everything that ever preceded a pot would count. The pair of terms is therefore not a decorative refinement; it is what makes an antecedent-based definition of cause survivable at all.

3. The three kinds of cause

1. FACT: **Inherent or material cause (samavāyi-kāraṇa)** - the substance in which the effect inheres: threads for cloth, clay for the pot.
2. FACT: **Non-inherent cause (asamavāyi-kāraṇa)** - qualities or conjunctions in the material cause that help produce the effect: the conjunction of the threads.
3. FACT: **Efficient cause (nimitta-kāraṇa)** - the agent and instruments: the weaver, the loom.

ANALYSIS: **Where the second one comes from.** The non-inherent cause is typically a *conjunction*, which Session 3 identified as a quality produced by motion. The three-fold classification is therefore a direct consequence of the category scheme: material causes are substances, non-inherent causes are qualities, and efficient causes are agents with instruments. That linkage is worth one sentence in any causation answer.

4. The seed and the tree (the 2021 demand)

FACT: Asked whether the seed contains the tree, Nyāya says **no** in the *satkāryavāda* sense.

FACT: The tree is a **new effect produced from the seed** under appropriate conditions.

ANALYSIS: So the seed is **causal ground, not a concealed miniature tree** in metaphysical latency.

ANALYSIS: **The refinement that answers the obvious rejoinder.** "But only a mango seed yields a mango tree" - Nyāya agrees and explains it by the definition of cause: the mango seed is the *invariable, unconditional* antecedent of the mango tree and of nothing else. Specificity is thus secured by the causal relation rather than by pre-existence, and this is exactly the point Sāṃkhya's argument from restriction is designed to deny.

5. Prior non-existence against Sāṃkhya (the 2023 demand)

FACT: Before the effect arises, it has **prior non-existence (prāgabhāva)**.

FACT: This prior absence shows the effect is **genuinely absent** before production.

ANALYSIS: Therefore prior non-existence becomes a **sharp weapon** against the pre-existence of the effect.

ANALYSIS: **The argument in full, since the question says "critically discuss".**

1. Prior non-existence is a real absence with the effect as its counterpositive, admitted as a kind of the seventh category (Session 6).
2. It has **no beginning but ends** exactly when the effect is produced - its termination *is* the production.
3. If the effect pre-existed latently in the cause, there would be nothing for prior non-existence to be the absence of, and the category would be empty.

4. But the category is required elsewhere in the ontology and is independently attested by negative cognition.
5. Therefore the effect does not pre-exist.

ANALYSIS: **Sāṃkhya's counter, stated fairly.** The Sāṃkhya replies that prior non-existence is a Vaiśeṣika posit, so the argument assumes what it must prove; and that the real question is why effects are restricted to specific causes, which pre-existence explains directly. ANALYSIS: **Verdict line.** Nyāya's argument is decisive *inside* an ontology that already admits absence as a real category, and question-begging outside it - so the causation dispute reduces to the prior dispute about whether absences are real.

6. Atomism: why atoms must be partless and eternal

FACT: **The atom (paramāṇu)** is the basic physical unit. It is **eternal, partless, indivisible, imperceptible**, and often described as minute or spherical (*parimāṇḍalya*).

FACT: **Argument.**

1. If every part had further parts without end, no ultimate physical unit would remain.
2. Infinite regress would undermine any stable explanation of finite compounds.
3. Therefore atoms must be indivisible.

ANALYSIS: Traditional absurdity arguments compare tiny and huge objects: if division had no ultimate stop, a **mustard seed and a mountain** would become equally analysable without foundation - each would contain infinitely many parts, and their difference in magnitude would become inexplicable.

7. The combination sequence, and the counting point examiners test

FACT: Two atoms combine into an imperceptible **dyad (dvyaṇuka)**.

FACT: **Three dyads - not merely three atoms - combine into a triad (tryaṇuka / trasareṇu)**, treated in standard textbook exposition as the **minimum perceptible magnitude**.

FACT: Gross objects arise from increasingly complex combinations.

ANALYSIS: **Why three dyads.** Two dyads would remain imperceptibly minute on the school's own reckoning; the triad is the first aggregate with the magnitude required for perceptibility, and it is standardly illustrated by the mote of dust visible in a sunbeam. The step from dyad to triad is therefore the point at which the invisible becomes visible, which is why examiners test the number.

8. Initiation of motion, and the cycles

FACT: At dissolution, **atoms remain** but compounds break apart.

FACT: At creation, **first motion must begin again**.

FACT: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika invokes **unseen moral force (adr̥ṣṭa)** and **the will of God** as the initiator of this first motion.

FACT: **Cycles.** Creation (*sṛṣṭi*) and dissolution (*pralaya*) occur cyclically: God wills; atoms combine; the world appears. God wills, or cosmic conditions reverse; compounds disintegrate; dissolution occurs. **Atoms persist through dissolution.**

ANALYSIS: **The systemic point.** This is where Sessions 13 and 14 lock together. The argument from combination is not an independent theistic afterthought - it is the atomism's own unfinished business. Atoms are inert; unseen moral force is unconscious; something intelligent must start the first motion. An answer that presents atomism without this gap has removed the reason the school became theistic.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION

Claim. Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika's causal theory locates necessity in the causal relation rather than in the effect, and its definition of cause is what makes that possible. **Named evidence.** A cause is defined as an unconditional invariable antecedent that is not otherwise established, so that the potter's father, the colour of his staff, the sound of the staff, all-pervading space and the donkey are all excluded as otherwise-established; and the three kinds of cause - inherent threads, their non-inherent conjunction, and the efficient weaver - map exactly onto substance, quality and agency. **Analysis.** Because the effect is denied pre-existence, the theory would over-generate unless irrelevant antecedents could be excluded, so the pair *anyathāsiddha* and *ananyathāsiddha* is not a refinement but the load-bearing device that makes an antecedent-based definition of cause survivable. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: The decisive anti-Sāṃkhya argument from prior non-existence works only within an ontology that already admits absence as a real category, so the causation dispute is downstream of the prior dispute about negative facts, and Sāṃkhya's argument from the restriction of effects to specific causes remains unanswered on its own terms.

UPSC TRAPS - SESSION 14

- ANALYSIS: Saying *asatkāryavāda* denies causation. It denies the **pre-existent effect**, not causal production.
- ANALYSIS: Writing "three atoms make a triad". It is **three dyads**.
- ANALYSIS: Making God the material cause of the world at creation. The material cause is atoms.
- ANALYSIS: Omitting the exclusion principle from a 2020-style question. *Anyathāsiddha* is the whole answer.
- ANALYSIS: Presenting prior non-existence as a knock-down argument without conceding that it presupposes the reality of absence.
- ANALYSIS: Forgetting the whole-over-parts commitment, which is what Buddhists attack.

RAPID REVISION - SESSION 14

- Effect is new (*asatkāryavāda* / *ārambhavāda*); Sāṃkhya says pre-existent (*satkāryavāda*).
- Cause = unconditional invariable antecedent, not otherwise established. Complete cause = causal complex + absence of blocker.
- Excluded: staff-colour, potter's father, staff-sound, space, donkey - five kinds of irrelevance.
- Three causes: inherent (substance) · non-inherent (quality/conjunction) · efficient (agent).
- Atoms eternal, partless, imperceptible; 2 atoms -> dyad; **3 dyads** -> triad, first perceptible magnitude.
- Prior non-existence ends when the effect is produced - that is the anti-Sāṃkhya weapon, and it presupposes real absences.
- First motion at creation: unseen moral force plus divine will - the bridge from atomism to theism.

SESSION 15 - JUDGEMENT: NAMED OBJECTIONS, THE CROSS-SCHOOL GRID AND A GRADED VERDICT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: This session does not teach a new doctrine. It teaches how to end an answer - which criticisms are serious, which replies work, which points are genuinely undecided, and how to say all that in three or four sentences under exam conditions.

Technical definition: The **evaluative apparatus** consists of the school's **presupposition ledger** (what each doctrine assumes and what collapses if the assumption is denied), the **opponent-reply ledger** (*pūrvapakṣa-siddhānta*) with residual force stated, the **inter-school positioning grid**, and a **graded verdict** distinguishing strong points, weak points and genuinely contested points.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

A fair verdict on Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika is necessarily graded rather than global: the very devices that complete the system - inherence, ultimate particularity, universal-mediated perception and a karma-bound God - are simultaneously its most vulnerable joints, so its rigour and its exposure have exactly the same source.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **presupposition ledger** - what collapses if the assumption is denied
- **opponent and settled view (pūrvapakṣa and siddhānta)** - the classical debate form
- **residual force** - what survives the reply
- **stipulated terminus** - the honest name for inference and particularity
- **graded verdict** - strong / weak / genuinely contested
- **directive decoding** - matching the closing line to the question word

How to use them: never close an answer with "thus the system is great". Close with a graded line that names one strength and one cost. The next four boxes give ready material for exactly that.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

HOW TO END ANY NYĀYA-VAIŚEṢIKA ANSWER IN THREE MOVES

MOVE 1 NAME THE ACHIEVEMENT

"Its strength is systematic linkage: instruments of knowing secure knowledge, categories secure being, God secures order."

MOVE 2 NAME THE COST - pick the one your question touched

categories? -> inference and particularity are stipulated termini
inference? -> the induction reply depends on real universals
liberation? -> the stone-like objection survives the reply
God? -> divine independence is limited by beginningless karma

MOVE 3 STATE THE VERDICT AS A CONDITION, NOT AS A CHEER

"The system is compelling for anyone who grants realism about universals and absences; the disputes with Buddhism, Advaita and Sāṃkhya are therefore disagreements about starting-points rather than about internal consistency."

In simple words: examiners are not testing whether you admire the school. They are testing whether you can say what it buys and what it pays. Three sentences, one strength, one cost, one condition.

Remember first	Meaning
Strong	Inference theory, reply to scepticism, regulated ontology, natural theology
Weak	Inherence and particularity as termini; unconscious liberation; God limited by karma
Contested	Universal-mediated perception; one system or two; the pot-potter analogy
Verdict shape	Conditional, graded, and tied to the presupposition the question touched

One-line memory: name the achievement, name the cost, state the condition - then stop.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE PRESUPPOSITION LEDGER AS A COLLAPSE MAP

IF THIS ASSUMPTION FAILS ...	... THIS COLLAPSES
reality is classifiable into stable knowable kinds	-> the whole category scheme loses its map of substance, quality, motion, universal, particularity, inherence and absence
cognitions are of real objects, validity ascertained externally	-> validity cannot be distinguished from mere appearance in the realist way
universal concomitance can be warranted by elimination + tarka + universal-mediated perception	-> inference falls to Cārvāka scepticism and ordinary proof collapses
common predication is grounded in REAL universals	-> classification, word-meaning, universal-mediated perception and the grasping of concomitance lose their ontological base
inseparable relations need a sui generis relation	-> whole-part, quality-substance and universal-particular become unexplained
exactly similar eternalists need ultimate individuators	-> atoms and selves of the same class risk collapsing into one
production generates a genuinely new effect	-> the school cannot oppose Sāṃkhya, and prior non-existence loses its function
gross objects require eternal partless atoms	-> atomistic creation and dissolution lose their metaphysical foundation
cognition is a quality needing an enduring self-locus	-> memory, recognition, moral agency and the liberation of one subject become hard to explain
the highest goal is total cessation of suffering	-> Nyāya soteriology is absorbed into Vedāntic or Buddhist models
cosmic order, atomic initiation, karmic dispensation and Vedic authority require omniscient governance	-> later natural theology and moral cosmology lose their converging centre

ANALYSIS: Caption. The collapse map is the fastest route to an evaluative sentence: find the row your question sits in, and the "if this fails" column supplies the qualification while the "this collapses" column supplies the significance.

1. The opponent-and-reply ledger, with residual force

Objector	Objection	Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika reply	Residual force ANALYSIS:
FACT: Cārvāka on concomitance	FACT: No finite observation proves a universal, and hidden adjuncts may always remain.	FACT: Repeated observation, non-observation of deviation, elimination of the adjunct, hypothetical reasoning and universal-mediated perception together warrant inference.	ANALYSIS: The reply depends on accepting real universals and extraordinary perception.
FACT: Buddhist (Dignāga / Dharmakīrti) on universals	FACT: Universals are unperceived, causally inert and reducible to exclusion of the other.	FACT: Universals are perceived in determinate cognition, inhere by inference, and exclusion presupposes stable exclusion-classes.	ANALYSIS: Buddhist nominalism remains powerful against reified universals.
FACT: Buddhist momentariness and no-self	FACT: Only momentary cognitions exist; no enduring substance-self is needed.	FACT: Memory, recognition, agency and moral responsibility require an enduring self distinct from the cognition-series.	ANALYSIS: Nyāya must explain why a permanent self has episodic consciousness.
FACT: Buddhist critique of the whole (avayavin)	FACT: The whole over and above the parts is either identical with them or different and unintelligible.	FACT: Nyāya infers a real whole because practical cognition and the new properties of wholes cannot be reduced to loose aggregates.	ANALYSIS: The whole-part relation leans heavily on inference.
FACT: Advaita / Śrīharṣa	FACT: Nyāya definitions invite counterexamples and regress; inference and particularity are vulnerable stipulations.	FACT: Nyāya accepts primitive termini where explanation must stop, and defends definitions through refined Navya-Nyāya analysis.	ANALYSIS: The dialectical attack exposes the cost of realist precision.
FACT: Advaita on liberation	FACT: Liberation without consciousness or bliss is not worth attaining.	FACT: Release is rational because complete cessation of suffering is intrinsically desirable.	ANALYSIS: The stone-like liberation objection remains forceful.
FACT: Sāṃkhya	FACT: The pre-existence of the effect explains causation better.	FACT: Prior non-existence shows the effect is absent before production, so production is a new beginning.	ANALYSIS: Nyāya must still explain continuity between cause and effect without latent pre-existence.
FACT: Mīmāṃsā	FACT: Validity is self-known and the Veda needs no divine author.	FACT: Validity and invalidity are known through external checks; meaningful authoritative testimony points to a competent reliable authority.	ANALYSIS: If an authorless Veda is accepted, the scriptural proof of God weakens.
FACT: Jaina non-absolutism	FACT: A rigid category scheme ignores many-sidedness and conditional predication.	FACT: Debate and inference require determinate categories and non-contradictory predication.	ANALYSIS: Jaina logic highlights contextual limits in Nyāya's fixed classifications.

2. Two named inter-school debates the papers actually set

(a) Do words signify universals or particulars? (2023 routed)

- FACT: Nyāya generally leans toward words signifying objects **through universals** and qualificative structures, not bare particulars alone.
- FACT: Mīmāṃsā develops a different semantic sensitivity, often giving stronger independent weight to word-meaning relations in sentence-use.
- ANALYSIS: Answer by showing Nyāya's **realist semantics**: universals are objective and hence linguistically significant. The category name *padārtha* - "the meaning of a word" - is itself evidence for the position.

(b) The Naiyāyika response to Cārvāka objections against inference (2022)

- FACT: Cārvāka attacks inference by doubting the universal relation.

- FACT: Nyāya replies that ordinary and scientific life depend on reliable inferential regularities established through observation, elimination of the adjunct, and hypothetical reasoning.
- ANALYSIS: The Nyāya point is **not infallibilism but disciplined justificatory practice** - and the Cārvāka's own general claim about inference is itself inferential.

3. Four standing criticisms, compactly

- FACT: **Against universals.** Buddhist: universals are unperceived and causally inert; exclusion explains classification. Cārvāka: perception presents individuals, and universal-realism strengthens the very inference Cārvāka disputes. FACT: **Reply:** exclusion and resemblance presuppose stable classes; determinate perception presents an individual *as qualified by* a universal; inherence explains presence in instances. ANALYSIS: **Mīmāṃsā caution:** major Mīmāṃsā thinkers are **also realists about universals** - their disagreement is not simple nominalism but concerns word-meaning, sentence-meaning, the instruments of knowing and whether Nyāya's theistic or relational apparatus is needed.
- FACT: **Against inherence.** Objection: it multiplies entities unnecessarily. Reply: without a distinct inseparable relation, whole-part and quality-substance relations remain unexplained.
- FACT: **Against stone-like liberation.** Objection: desire for unconscious liberation is incoherent. Reply: complete removal of pain is a sufficient rational goal.
- FACT: **Against the proofs of God.** Objection: order can be explained without God. Reply: purposive order, moral dispensation and linguistic normativity are not adequately explained by blind atoms alone.

4. The inter-school positioning grid

School	Instruments of knowing	Validity	Error	Universals	Causation	God	Self and liberation
FACT: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	Four for Nyāya	Extrinsic for validity and invalidity	Misplacement	Real universals, disciplined by the six blockers	New production; eternal atoms	Efficient cause and karmic governor	Enduring self; release as cessation of suffering
FACT: Sāṃkhya-Yoga	Usually three	Not framed in the extrinsic manner	Misidentification of witness and nature	Less central than the evolution of principles	Pre-existent effect; no atomism	Sāṃkhya needs no creator; Yoga accepts a special witness	Many witnesses; isolation as the goal
FACT: Mīmāṃsā	More expansive, adding postulation and, for Bhāṭṭa, non-cognition	Intrinsic validity	Prābhākara non-apprehension of difference ; Bhāṭṭa differs	Generally realist about word-meaning	Ritual potency, not atomistic creation	No divine author needed for the Veda	Self accepted; liberation varies by sub-school
FACT: Advaita	Six in the standard later account	Works within the empirical; ultimate knowledge sublates duality	Indefinable	Empirical universals not ultimately real	Appearance rather than new production	God is empirical; Brahman is ultimately non-dual	Self-Brahman identity; liberation as knowledge
FACT: Viśiṣṭādvaita	Perception, inference, scripture	Theistic-realist	No indefinable object required	Real plurality as modes of Brahman	Real transformation, not atomism	Brahman as material and efficient cause	Selves as real modes; conscious service retained
FACT: Buddhism	Two: perception and inference	Cognition-centred, self-luminosity-friendly	Labels vary in doxography	Exclusion , not real universals	Momentariness; rejects permanent atoms and self	No creator God	No eternal self; cessation is not Nyāya's release
FACT: Jainism	Multiple, with standpoint-based analysis	Conditioned by standpoint	Partial absolutisation	Realism filtered by non-absolutism	Atomism in a different pluralist frame	No creator God in Nyāya's sense	Many souls; liberation retains perfected consciousness
FACT: Cārvāka	Perception alone	Tied to perceptibility	Error exposes unreliability beyond perception	Rejects real universals	Materialism without inference-based atomism	Rejects God	Rejects an enduring non-material self and liberation

ANALYSIS: Answer to "one system or two?" Historically two allied systems, doctrinally fused in later Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika for exam purposes, with distinguishable emphases: Nyāya supplies the instruments of knowing and dialectic, Vaiśeṣika supplies categories, atomism and the particularity-inherence ontology, and Navya-Nyāya refines both into a highly technical analytic idiom.

5. The directive decoder

Directive	What is being tested	Structural move	Closing verdict shape
Discuss	Breadth plus balanced explanation	Define, give parts, add one rival and reply	"Thus the doctrine is central because..., though it presupposes..."
Examine	Internal logic and assumptions	State thesis, unpack the inference, expose the presupposition	"The argument works if its realist presupposition is granted."
Critically examine / critically discuss	Doctrine plus a serious objection	Nyāya position, named opponent, reply, residual force	"Nyāya answers X, but Y remains the pressure point."
Analyse	Decomposition into elements and relations	Break into category / instrument / error / causal components	"The strength lies in systematic linkage, not isolated claims."
Evaluate	Normative judgement after evidence	Strengths, weaknesses, final graded judgement	"On balance it is strong as..., weaker as..."
Compare	Similarity and difference	Two-column school comparison with exact terms	"The overlap is limited because the metaphysical bases differ."
Distinguish	Precision between nearby terms	Define each, state locus, relation and example	"Therefore the two are not interchangeable because..."
Elucidate	Clear exposition with examples	Statement, mechanism, example, trap	"This clarifies why Nyāya needs the doctrine in the system."
Present an account / exposition	Organised completeness	Definition, divisions, mechanism, one contrast	"The account is complete once X, Y and Z are shown to be connected."
Justify	Defence with reasons, not description	Give the datum, the explanatory need, the economy check, the concession	"The status is justified given..., subject to..."
Do you agree?	Reasoned stance, not opinion	Qualified agreement, evidence, objection, reply	"I agree only to the extent that..., because..."

6. The graded verdict

Strong points

- FACT: **Logic and inference.** The most developed Indian account of inference, debate, reason-testing and fallacy-analysis.
- FACT: **Answer to scepticism.** The account of how concomitance is grasped is a serious realist reply to Cārvāka-style and induction-style scepticism.
- FACT: **Disciplined ontology.** Vaiśeṣika does not merely multiply entities; the six blockers show an internal economy of universals.
- FACT: **Natural theology.** Udayana gives the most rigorous Indian cumulative case for God as efficient cause, karmic governor and reliable scriptural authority.

Weak points

- ANALYSIS: **Inherence and particularity.** Both function as **stipulated termini** against regress, so critics can call them explanatory placeholders.
- ANALYSIS: **Liberation.** Release as the absence of pleasure, pain and ordinary cognition invites the stone-like objection.
- ANALYSIS: **God and karma.** Making God dispense fruits according to beginningless karma protects justice but limits divine independence.
- ANALYSIS: **Ontological proliferation.** Absence, inherence, particularity and multiple categories can look excessive to Buddhist, Advaitin and Cārvāka critics.

Genuinely contested points

- CAUTION: **Universal-mediated perception.** It is contested whether it is genuine perception or an *ad hoc* device for induction.
- CAUTION: **One system or two.** Nyāya and Vaiśeṣika are historically distinct but later fused; an answer must preserve both facts.
- CAUTION: **The pot-potter analogy.** It is contested whether an embodied artisan analogy can bear the weight of proving a bodiless cosmic maker.

Ready verdict lines

- ANALYSIS: **10 marks.** "Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika is strongest as a realist logic-ontology, but its primitive relations and particularisers remain vulnerable."
- ANALYSIS: **15 marks.** "Its achievement is systematic: the instruments secure knowledge, the categories secure being and God secures order; its weakness is that inherence, particularity and unconscious liberation are asserted as much as proved."
- ANALYSIS: **20 marks.** "A fair verdict is graded: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika gives Indian philosophy its most rigorous realism, inference-theory and natural theology, yet the very devices that make the system complete - inherence, particularity, universal-mediated perception and a karma-bound God - are also its deepest contested points."

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - CLAIM -> EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION

Claim. Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika's strengths and vulnerabilities are not independent features but two descriptions of the same commitment to explanatory completeness. **Named evidence.** The system stops the relation-regress by declaring inherence self-linking, stops the individuation-regress by declaring particularity self-differentiating, and stops the induction-regress by declaring the universal perceptible - and each of these three is a place where an opponent's regress argument is halted by fiat rather than by further proof. **Analysis.** Because a complete realism must terminate every regress somewhere, the same rigour that produces the school's unmatched inference-theory and its regulated ontology also produces exactly three well-marked stipulations, which is why Buddhist, Advaitin and Cārvāka criticism converges on those three points and not on random ones. **Qualification.** ANALYSIS: Stopping a regress is not by itself a fault, since every relational ontology must stop; the fair charge is narrower - that Nyāya deploys regress as a weapon against opponents while claiming immunity for its own termini, which makes the disagreement one about starting-points rather than about internal consistency.

UPSC TRAPS - SESSION 15

- ANALYSIS: Ending with praise rather than a graded verdict.
- ANALYSIS: Treating Mīmāṃsā as nominalist about universals. Major Mīmāṃsā thinkers are realists.
- ANALYSIS: Presenting the contested points as settled in Nyāya's favour.
- ANALYSIS: Using a Western parallel before the Indian argument is complete, or for more than one line.
- ANALYSIS: Saying the school "multiplies entities" without acknowledging the six blockers.
- ANALYSIS: Giving the same closing line regardless of the directive. Match the close to the question word.

RAPID REVISION - SESSION 15

- Three stipulated termini: inherence (self-linking) · particularity (self-differentiating) · universal-mediated perception.
- Strong: inference theory, reply to scepticism, regulated ontology, cumulative natural theology.
- Weak: termini, unconscious liberation, God bound by karma, apparent proliferation.
- Contested: universal-mediated perception, one-or-two systems, the pot-potter analogy.
- Grid essentials: extrinsic validity both ways · misplacement error · real universals · new production · efficient-cause God.
- Close with strength + cost + condition, matched to the directive.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

Answer placement: each correct option was fixed independently, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated. Options are matched for length, specificity, grammar and visible formatting so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

CORE DIAGNOSTICS - 24 ITEMS

MCQ 1. What the two allied schools actually divide between them

With reference to the classical division of labour between Nyāya and Vaiśeṣika, consider the following statements.

1. Nyāya organises itself around sixteen topics of inquiry, proof and debate.
2. Classical Vaiśeṣika accepts four independent means of valid knowledge.
3. The mature Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika synthesis normally follows the fuller Nyāya epistemology.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. 1 and 3 only

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it retains statement 2, which assigns Nyāya's fourfold scheme to classical Vaiśeṣika, whereas Vaiśeṣika classically keeps perception and inference and reduces comparison and testimony to inference.
- **B:** Incorrect: dropping statement 1 removes the very feature that identifies the Nyāya half, namely its organisation around sixteen topics running from the means of valid knowledge to the ground of defeat.
- **C:** Incorrect: statements 1 and 3 are sound, but including 2 contradicts statement 3, since the synthesis would have nothing to adopt if Vaiśeṣika already accepted four.
- **D:** Correct: Nyāya is organised by sixteen topics of inquiry, Vaiśeṣika by seven categories of being with two instruments, and the later synthesis takes over the fourfold Nyāya scheme.

Examiner trap 1: Writing "Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika accepts four means of valid knowledge" without noticing that four is the Nyāya count discards a precision mark that costs one clause to secure.

MCQ 2. What kind of list the sixteen are

Nyāya's sixteen topics include doubt, victory-directed wrangling, quibble and the ground of defeat. Their presence in the list shows most directly that the sixteen constitute

- A. a map of what a disciplined rational inquiry and dispute contain
- B. a graded inventory of the kinds of being that the school admits
- C. a sequence of meditative stages culminating in liberating knowledge
- D. a list of the defects that any opponent's position must exhibit

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: only an anatomy of disputation would place instruments of proof beside styles of arguing and modes of failure, because a complete theory of proof must also describe how proof is faked.
- **B:** Incorrect: an inventory of being could never contain quibble or the ground of defeat, since neither names a kind of thing; the inventory of being is Vaiśeṣika's separate list of seven.
- **C:** Incorrect: the sixteen are not stages of practice, and although the second topic opens into a soteriological sequence of twelve knowables, the list as a whole is dialectical rather than meditative.
- **D:** Incorrect: only four of the sixteen concern failure, and they classify how any argument can fail rather than what a particular opponent must be guilty of.

Examiner trap 2: Merging the sixteen topics of inquiry with the seven categories of being into one list of twenty-three is a category error in the strict sense, and it makes every later distinction in the script look unreliable.

MCQ 3. The twelve knowables read correctly

The twelve objects of valid knowledge run from the self through body, senses, objects, cognition, mind, activity, defects, rebirth, fruit and suffering to release. This ordering is best described as

- A. an exhaustive ontology intended to replace the Vaiśeṣika category scheme
- B. a soteriological sequence in which knowledge of the chain enables release
- C. a classification of substances arranged from the subtlest to the grossest
- D. a ranking of the means of valid knowledge by their degree of reliability

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the twelve are expressly not meant as an exhaustive ontology, and the Vaiśeṣika categories are located by Nyāya *within* the field of knowable objects rather than replaced by it.
- **B:** Correct: the sequence traces defects to activity, activity to rebirth and rebirth to suffering, so that true knowledge of the self and of that chain is what makes release intelligible as its terminus.
- **C:** Incorrect: several members of the list, such as activity, defects, fruit and suffering, are not substances at all, so no subtle-to-gross substance ordering can be extracted.
- **D:** Incorrect: the means of valid knowledge form the first topic, not the second, and Nyāya nowhere ranks its four instruments by degrees of reliability.

Examiner trap 3: Reciting the twelve without stating that they form a bondage-to-release chain converts a structured argument into a memorised list and forfeits the analysis marks.

MCQ 4. Which set contains only the nine substances

Which of the following sets contains only substances as classified by Vaiśeṣika?

- A. Earth, water, fire, air, ether, cognition, pleasure, merit, demerit
- B. Earth, water, fire, air, atoms, universals, inherence, absence, self
- C. Earth, water, fire, air, ether, number, magnitude, self, mind
- D. Earth, water, fire, air, ether, time, direction, self, mind

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: cognition, pleasure, merit and demerit belong to the twenty-four qualities that inhere in the self, and treating them as substances repeats the error Nyāya specifically guards against in its account of the self.
- **B:** Incorrect: atoms are not a tenth substance but the ultimate units of four of the nine, while universals, inherence and absence are separate categories standing alongside substance rather than inside it.
- **C:** Incorrect: number and magnitude are listed among the twenty-four qualities, and their inclusion displaces time and direction, which are genuinely substances.
- **D:** Correct: the nine are earth, water, fire, air, ether, time, direction, self and mind, with the first four possessing atoms and the next three all-pervading and eternal.

Examiner trap 4: Treating ether, time and direction as abstract frameworks rather than as substances is the most frequent way scripts reduce the list of nine to a list of six or seven.

MCQ 5. Where cognition and pleasure belong, and why it matters

In Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika, cognition, pleasure, desire, merit and demerit are classified as qualities inhering in the self. The most important consequence of this classification is that

- A. the self can exist without manifest consciousness, as in deep sleep and in release
- B. the self becomes identical with the stream of its own mental episodes
- C. moral desert has to be relocated outside the seven-category scheme
- D. consciousness must be treated as the defining essence of the self

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: because cognition is an adventitious quality requiring conjunction of self, mind, senses and objects, its absence leaves the self intact, which is exactly what deep sleep and release require.
- **B:** Incorrect: identifying the self with its episodes is the Buddhist stream-analysis that Nyāya rejects; on the Nyāya view the episodes vary while the substance that bears them endures.
- **C:** Incorrect: merit and demerit are located precisely *inside* the scheme as qualities of the self, which is how the school accommodates moral desert without adding a new category.
- **D:** Incorrect: consciousness as the very nature of the self is the Advaita position, and its contradiction of the Nyāya classification is one of the most examinable contrasts in the paper.

Examiner trap 5: Writing that consciousness is the essence of the self in Nyāya destroys the account of release in the same stroke, because a self whose essence is consciousness could not be liberated into unconsciousness.

MCQ 6. Motion, and the work it does in the system

Motion or action as a Vaiśeṣika category is causally important chiefly because it

- A. supplies the moral merit and demerit that determine the fruits of past deeds
- B. constitutes the ultimate material out of which composite substances are formed
- C. produces the conjunction and disjunction on which production and destruction depend
- D. functions as the inseparable relation binding a quality to its substance

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this confuses physical motion with moral karma; merit and demerit are two of the twenty-four qualities, and motion in the category list means only upward, downward, contraction, expansion and locomotion.
- **B:** Incorrect: the ultimate material constituents are atoms, which are substances; motion is an occurrence *in* a substance and is never itself a material out of which anything is made.
- **C:** Correct: motion generates conjunction and disjunction, and since the non-inherent cause of an effect is typically a conjunction in the material cause, the category feeds directly into the theory of causation.
- **D:** Incorrect: the inseparable relation is inherence, a category of its own, whereas conjunction - which motion produces - is separable and is classified as a quality.

Examiner trap 6: Reading *karma* in the category list as moral karma turns a mechanical category into an ethical one and silently removes the bridge from the categories to the theory of causation.

MCQ 7. The argument for the reality of universals

Consider the following statements about the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika defence of real universals.

1. Mere resemblance among individuals is treated as sufficient to ground classification.
2. A universal is present in many particulars through inherence rather than by spatial division.
3. Determinate perception presents an individual as qualified by a universal.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it keeps statement 1, but the school's argument turns on the insufficiency of resemblance, since resemblance itself has to be resemblance in some objectively common respect.
- **B:** Correct: presence by inherence answers the "how can one be wholly in many?" objection, and presentation in determinate perception is what allows Nyāya to say universals are perceived rather than merely inferred.
- **C:** Incorrect: statement 3 is sound but statement 1 is the position Nyāya argues *against*, and combining the two makes the school's own premiss into its conclusion's rival.
- **D:** Incorrect: statements 2 and 3 are correct, but statement 1 misreports the argument and would collapse Nyāya realism into the resemblance-nominalism it is designed to defeat.

Examiner trap 7: Explaining the presence of one universal in many by spatial division concedes the Buddhist objection outright, because a spatially divided universal is no longer one entity.

MCQ 8. What the six blockers of universalhood accomplish

The six impediments to universalhood are best described as

- A. six varieties of universal ranked from the widest to the narrowest extension
- B. six defects that make an opponent's inference fail as a proof of universals
- C. six grounds on which a proposed universal must be refused and downgraded
- D. six relations by which a universal can attach itself to its instances

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: ranking by extension is the separate distinction between higher and lower universals, and it classifies admitted universals rather than excluding candidates.
- **B:** Incorrect: defects in a proof are the fallacies of the reason, a different apparatus belonging to the theory of inference and testing reasons rather than candidate classes.
- **C:** Correct: single-instance, co-extensiveness, cross-cutting, regress, form-loss and lack of an available relation are refusal tests, and a blocked candidate survives only as an imposed property.
- **D:** Incorrect: a universal attaches to its instances by exactly one relation, inherence, and the sixth blocker exists precisely because no further relation is available for inherence itself.

Examiner trap 8: Answering a charge of ontological excess by asserting that Vaiśeṣika is economical, without naming two blockers by function, gives the examiner an assertion where an argument was expected.

MCQ 9. The scope of ultimate particularity

A candidate writes that ultimate particularity individuates every object, including pots and cloths. The precise correction is that particularity resides

- A. only in eternal substances such as atoms, ether, time, direction, selves and minds
- B. only in the four elemental substances that possess ultimate atomic constituents
- C. in every substance but not in qualities, motions, universals or absences
- D. in whatever is imperceptible, whether it be a substance, a quality or a relation

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: composite objects are individuated by their parts, qualities, place and causal history, so particularity is needed only where exactly similar *eternal* substances would otherwise collapse into one.
- **B:** Incorrect: this omits ether, time, direction, self and mind, all of which are eternal and all of which require ultimate individuation on the same reasoning as atoms.
- **C:** Incorrect: extending particularity to every substance makes it redundant for composites, which already have distinguishing parts and histories, and thereby wastes the posit it was introduced to justify.
- **D:** Incorrect: imperceptibility is a symptom rather than the criterion; inherence is imperceptible and inferred, yet no particularity resides in it, since the fifth blocker forbids it.

Examiner trap 9: Assigning particularity to ordinary composites removes the school's own justification for the posit, since the argument depends on there being no other individuator available.

MCQ 10. The brown table and the book on the table

The Vaiśeṣika distinguishes the brown colour of a table from a book resting on it by holding that

- A. both are conjunctions, the first being merely more durable than the second
- B. both are inferences, since neither the colour nor the book can be removed without effort
- C. the colour is a conjunction and the book is an inference, since the book is supported
- D. the colour inheres in the table, whereas the book is conjoined with it

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: durability is not the criterion at all, and treating both as conjunctions would leave the quality-substance relation unexplained, since a quality cannot be conjoined with its bearer.
- **B:** Incorrect: effort of removal is a physical consideration; the school's test is whether the relata could be established separately, and the book and the table plainly could.
- **C:** Incorrect: the assignment is exactly reversed, and the reason offered - that support implies inference - confuses a spatial relation with an ontological dependence.
- **D:** Correct: inference is the eternal inseparable relation between a quality and its substance, while conjunction is a produced and destructible quality holding between separable relata.

Examiner trap 10: Grading relations by how hard the relata are to pull apart substitutes a physical criterion for the ontological one and reverses the answer whenever the example involves a firmly attached object.

MCQ 11. Inseparability as a defining characteristic

On whether inseparability is a necessary or a sufficient condition for defining inference, the defensible position is that inseparability is

- A. sufficient but not necessary, since some inferences hold between separable relata
- B. neither necessary nor sufficient, since inference is defined solely by its eternality
- C. necessary but not by itself sufficient, unless the specific ontological dependence is shown
- D. both necessary and sufficient, since no further condition can be specified for it

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it inverts the logic, since every case of inference involves relata that cannot be established separately, which makes inseparability necessary rather than dispensable.
- **B:** Incorrect: eternality attaches to inference as a relation but cannot define it, because the relation must still be distinguished from other eternal features of the system.
- **C:** Correct: inseparability alone risks being too wide as a defining characteristic, so the definition is safe only when the categorial dependence of the dependent term on its locus is added.
- **D:** Incorrect: declaring the condition sufficient ignores the standard requirement that a defining characteristic avoid being too narrow, too wide or impossible, and it answers an easier question than the one set.

Examiner trap 11: Asserting that inseparability defines inference answers a question about a *definition* with a claim about a *necessary condition*, which is the exact distinction the question was set to test.

MCQ 12. The temporal signatures of the four absences

Match the kind of absence with its temporal signature.

1. Prior non-existence - no beginning, but an end
2. Posterior non-existence - a beginning, but no end
3. Absolute non-existence - neither beginning nor end

Which of the matches given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it omits absolute non-existence, whose signature of neither beginning nor end is exactly what distinguishes it from the two temporally bounded kinds.
- **B:** Incorrect: dropping prior non-existence removes the one absence that ends, and with it the whole anti-Sāṃkhya argument, since production is what terminates that absence.
- **C:** Incorrect: leaving out posterior non-existence loses the mirror-image case in which destruction inaugurates an absence that thereafter never ends.
- **D:** Correct: prior non-existence ends with production, posterior non-existence begins with destruction, and absolute non-existence such as a hare's horn is bounded at neither end.

Examiner trap 12: Reversing prior and posterior non-existence is easy under time pressure, and it inverts the causation answer as well, because it is the *prior* absence that production terminates.

MCQ 13. Two sentences, two absences

According to Vaiśeṣika, the sentences "Air does not have heat" and "Air is not fire"

- A. express the same absence, since both deny that air possesses a fiery character
- B. express different absences, the first absolute and the second mutual
- C. express different absences, the first mutual and the second prior
- D. express no absence at all, since both are merely linguistic negations

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: sameness of subject does not entail sameness of absence, and the two sentences deny different things - one a qualification, the other an identity.
- **B:** Correct: heat is a quality whose permanent absence in air is absolute non-existence, whereas "air is not fire" denies identity between two substances and is therefore mutual non-existence.
- **C:** Incorrect: the assignment is reversed and prior non-existence is irrelevant here, since neither sentence concerns an effect awaiting production.
- **D:** Incorrect: treating negation as merely linguistic abandons the realist semantics on which the seventh category rests, and it contradicts the school's insistence that every negation has a counterpositive.

Examiner trap 13: Answering "yes, the same" because both sentences share the same grammatical subject overlooks that the classification is fixed by the counterpositive, not by the locus.

MCQ 14. How Nyāya knows an absence

Consider the following statements about the cognition "there is no jar on the table".

1. The table functions as the locus and the jar as the counterpositive.
2. Nyāya requires an independent means of valid knowledge called non-cognition.
3. The absence can be presented perceptually through the qualifier-qualified relation.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the structure of locus and counterpositive is what gives the negative cognition determinate content, and the sixth sense-object contact allows the absence to qualify the perceived locus.
- **B:** Incorrect: it retains statement 2, but the independent instrument of non-cognition is the Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā position, and Nyāya expressly reduces the work to perception or inference.
- **C:** Incorrect: statement 3 is sound, yet coupling it with statement 2 is incoherent, since an absence presented through an existing contact needs no new instrument.
- **D:** Incorrect: statements 1 and 3 are correct, but statement 2 imports a rival school's instrument and breaches Nyāya's own economy of four.

Examiner trap 14: Attributing non-cognition to Nyāya loses two marks at once, because it both misstates Nyāya's count of instruments and misattributes the Bhāṭṭa position.

MCQ 15. What each clause of Gautama's definition excludes

In Gautama's definition of perception, the clauses "non-verbal", "non-errant" and "determinate" respectively exclude

- A. inference, memory and comparison, all of which fail to arise from sense-object contact
- B. testimony, illusion and doubt, each of which would otherwise be admitted as perceptual
- C. universals, absences and extraordinary contacts, none of which is reached by ordinary contact
- D. yogic perception, indeterminate perception and the whole-part relation

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: inference, memory and comparison are excluded by the first requirement of production from sense-object contact, not by the three later clauses under consideration.
- **B:** Correct: "non-verbal" separates perception from verbally constituted knowledge, "non-errant" rules out shell-silver illusion, and "determinate" rules out doubt such as "post or man?".
- **C:** Incorrect: universals, absences and the extraordinary contacts are precisely what the six graded contacts are designed to make perceptible, so they are included rather than excluded.
- **D:** Incorrect: yogic perception is an admitted kind of extraordinary perception, and the indeterminate stage is retained by later Naiyāyikas rather than excluded by the definition.

Examiner trap 15: Translating the clauses instead of naming what each one excludes produces a paraphrase where the examiner is testing whether the candidate can identify the rival being ruled out.

MCQ 16. Which contact makes which object perceptible

The sixth sense-object contact, the qualifier-qualified relation, exists in the list chiefly in order to explain the perception of

- A. a substance such as a pot standing before the eye
- B. a universal inhering in a quality that inheres in a conjoined substance
- C. an absence, such as jar-absence qualifying the surface of a table
- D. sound, taken as inhering in the all-pervading substance ether

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: a substance directly before the eye is reached by the first contact, simple conjunction, which is the most straightforward case in the list.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is the third contact, inherence in what inheres in what is conjoined, and it explains how colour-ness rather than an absence becomes perceptible.
- **C:** Correct: the absence qualifies the locus and is presented along with it, which is how Nyāya perceives negative facts without admitting a new instrument for them.
- **D:** Incorrect: sound is handled by the fourth contact, plain inherence, because sound is taken to inhere in ether and is grasped by the auditory organ.

Examiner trap 16: Listing the six contacts without saying which object each one reaches turns a functional analysis into a transliteration exercise and misses the link to the account of absence.

MCQ 17. The three kinds of extraordinary perception

Consider the following pairings of extraordinary perception with the doctrinal work it performs.

1. Universal-mediated perception - supports the account of how invariable concomitance is grasped
2. Cognition-mediated perception - supports the account of illusion as misplacement
3. Yogic perception - supports the account of how absences qualify their loci

Which of the pairings given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it keeps pairing 3, but absences are handled by the sixth ordinary sense-object contact, whereas yogic perception concerns subtle, distant, past or future objects.
- **B:** Correct: universal-mediated perception delivers the kind rather than the sample and so answers the induction problem, and cognition-mediated perception supplies the presentational force that illusion requires.
- **C:** Incorrect: pairing 2 is sound but pairing 3 misassigns yogic perception, and dropping pairing 1 discards the specifically Nyāya solution to inductive scepticism.
- **D:** Incorrect: pairings 1 and 2 are correct, but pairing 3 attaches yogic perception to a task already performed by an ordinary contact.

Examiner trap 17: Treating the three extraordinary perceptions as a decorative appendix conceals that two of them are load-bearing, one for induction and one for the theory of error.

MCQ 18. The member with no Western counterpart

Among the five members of the Nyāya demonstration, the one that most sharply distinguishes it from a purely formal syllogism is

- A. the thesis, because it announces the claim before any reason has been supplied
- B. the application, because it brings the subject explicitly under the general rule
- C. the conclusion, because it restates the thesis after the proof has been given
- D. the example, because it states the general rule together with an agreed instance

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: announcing a claim before proving it is common to any structured argument, and a formal syllogism can equally begin by stating what is to be shown.
- **B:** Incorrect: bringing a subject under a rule is exactly what a syllogism's minor premiss does, so this member has a direct formal counterpart.
- **C:** Incorrect: restating the conclusion is likewise ordinary, and the interesting point about it - that it is now established rather than asserted - is a consequence of the other members.
- **D:** Correct: the demonstration must exhibit an actually observed instance the audience already grants, because Nyāya is producing warranted assent about the world rather than testing the form of a sentence.

Examiner trap 18: Describing the five-membered demonstration as the Indian version of the Aristotelian syllogism erases the empirical example and with it the school's whole conception of proof to another.

MCQ 19. Three grids, three bases of division

The division of inference into inference from perceived cause to unperceived effect, from perceived effect to unperceived cause, and from non-causal uniformity is a division by

- A. the direction or basis of the uniformity that licenses the inferential move
- B. the purpose for which the inference is drawn, whether for oneself or for another
- C. the form of concomitance, whether positive-only, negative-only or both
- D. the number of members required to communicate the proof to a hearer

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: dark clouds to coming rain, a swollen muddy river to past rain, and changed celestial position to unperceived motion are the standard illustrations of the three directions.
- **B:** Incorrect: the purpose-based division yields only two kinds, inference for oneself and inference for another, and it says nothing about the direction of the uniformity.
- **C:** Incorrect: the concomitance-based division yields positive-only, negative-only and positive-and-negative, which is a different threefold division resting on agreement in presence and absence.
- **D:** Incorrect: the number of members is a feature of communicated proof and does not generate a classification of inferences at all.

Examiner trap 19: Mixing the two textbook readings of the effect-to-cause type - one causal and one by residual elimination - without stating which is being used makes an otherwise sound answer read as confused.

MCQ 20. Marks and fallacies as one test read twice

The fallacy in which the reason occurs in both similar and dissimilar instances is a violation of which mark of a valid reason?

- A. Presence of the reason in the subject under consideration
- B. Absence of the reason from dissimilar negative instances
- C. Non-contradiction of the property by a stronger instrument
- D. Absence of an equally strong counter-reason opposing it

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: failure of presence in the subject produces the unproved reason, whose subtypes concern an unreal locus, an absent reason or an unproved pervasion.
- **B:** Correct: a reason found in dissimilar instances is irregular, since its occurrence where the property is known to be absent destroys precisely the invariability the inference needs.
- **C:** Incorrect: contradiction by a stronger instrument produces the stultified reason, illustrated by attempting to infer that fire is cold when perception defeats the conclusion.
- **D:** Incorrect: an equally strong opposing reason produces the counterbalanced fallacy, in which the dispute is deadlocked rather than the concomitance being broken.

Examiner trap 20: Listing the five fallacies without mapping them onto the five marks answers a recall question when the paper's twenty-marker demands the correspondence itself.

MCQ 21. Identifying the conditioning adjunct

In the defective inference "the hill has smoke, because it has fire", wet fuel is identified as a conditioning adjunct because it

- A. pervades smoke, the property to be proved, while failing to pervade fire, the reason
- B. pervades fire, the reason, while failing to pervade smoke, the property to be proved
- C. is present in the subject and absent from every similar and dissimilar instance alike
- D. is a co-effect of the same causal complex and therefore accompanies both terms

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the formula requires an adjunct to pervade the property to be proved without pervading the reason, and wherever there is smoke there is wet fuel although fire may burn without it.
- **B:** Incorrect: the formula is exactly reversed here, and on this reading the adjunct would establish rather than defeat the concomitance between fire and smoke.
- **C:** Incorrect: this describes the too-restricted variety of the irregular fallacy, in which the reason is confined to the subject and no contrast class remains.
- **D:** Incorrect: a co-effect is an accidental antecedent excluded by the definition of cause, and it belongs to the theory of causation rather than to the test for an adjunct.

Examiner trap 21: Stating the adjunct formula backwards is the single commonest technical slip in inference answers, and it converts the school's quality-control device into a validation of the bad inference.

MCQ 22. What the chain that secures concomitance actually claims

Consider the following statements about how Nyāya claims to grasp invariable concomitance.

1. Repeated observation is by itself sufficient to establish an unrestricted universal.
2. Hypothetical reasoning is classed as an aid to the instruments, not as an instrument.
3. Universal-mediated perception allows the kind to be presented without an exhaustive survey.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 1 and 3 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it retains statement 1, but Nyāya itself concedes that repeated observation leaves a finite sample and cannot by itself yield an unrestricted universal.
- **B:** Incorrect: statement 3 is sound, yet statement 1 misreports the school's own admission and would make the later steps of elimination and doubt-removal pointless.
- **C:** Correct: keeping hypothetical reasoning out of the list of instruments is what saves the reply from circularity, and universal-mediated perception supplies the kind rather than the sample.
- **D:** Incorrect: statements 2 and 3 are correct, but including statement 1 attributes to Nyāya the naïve enumerative position it expressly rejects.

Examiner trap 22: Promoting hypothetical reasoning to a fifth means of valid knowledge concedes the circularity charge, because the defence of inference would then rest on an instrument of the same kind.

MCQ 23. What makes a speaker's word an instrument of knowledge

According to Nyāya, verbal testimony yields valid knowledge only when the speaker is reliable and the sentence is intelligible. Intelligibility requires

- A. that the sentence be Vedic rather than secular, and concern an imperceptible matter
- B. that the words be arranged so that no inference is required to grasp their sense
- C. that the speaker occupy a recognised position of authority within a tradition
- D. mutual expectancy, semantic fitness, proximity in utterance and intended meaning

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: testimony is expressly divided into secular and Vedic and into perceptible and imperceptible matters, so none of these features is a condition of intelligibility.
- **B:** Incorrect: the absence of inference is not among the conditions, and in any case understanding a sentence characteristically involves settling an intended meaning where ambiguity exists.
- **C:** Incorrect: reliability is defined by correct knowledge, truthful intention and competence of expression, and the school explicitly denies that status or confidence creates epistemic authority.
- **D:** Correct: the four sentence conditions locate the risk in the utterance, as when "cow horse man" fails expectancy, "sprinkle with fire" fails fitness, and an ambiguous term needs a settled intention.

Examiner trap 23: Answering a testimony question with the reliability conditions alone supplies half the machinery, because the other half of the failure risk lies in the sentence rather than in the speaker.

MCQ 24. What comparison actually delivers

A forester says that an animal called a *gavaya* resembles a cow; later, seeing such an animal, one knows that this is what the word denotes. According to Nyāya this final cognition is produced by

- A. testimony, because the forester's sentence supplied all the content that was needed
- B. perception, because the animal was directly present to the sense of sight
- C. comparison, because what is established is the relation between a word and its object
- D. inference, because the described features were found in the animal encountered

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the forester's sentence supplied a description but not a referent, and the new cognition attaches a word to an object that the speaker never presented.
- **B:** Incorrect: perception delivered an animal but no name, so the cognition of the word-object relation is not something the eye could have produced by itself.
- **C:** Correct: instruments are individuated by the kind of cognition they produce, and here what is newly known is a semantic relation acquired through resemblance plus prior description.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is the classical Vaiśeṣika reduction of comparison to inference, which Nyāya resists on the ground that the result is a word-object relation rather than a property of the animal.

Examiner trap 24: Treating comparison as reasoning by analogy imports a Western sense of the term and makes it impossible to explain why Nyāya counts it as a separate instrument at all.

REMEDIAL DRILLS - 8 ITEMS TARGETING PREDICTABLE ERRORS

MCQ 25. The half-remembered position on validity

A candidate writes that Nyāya holds validity to be intrinsic and invalidity to be extrinsic. The correct statement of the Nyāya position is that

- A. both validity and invalidity are intrinsic, arising with the cognition itself
- B. both validity and invalidity are extrinsic, known through external conditions
- C. validity is extrinsic while invalidity is intrinsic and immediately felt
- D. neither validity nor invalidity can be ascertained, so the question lapses

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: intrinsic validity is the general Mīmāṃsā position, and extending it to invalidity would make error unrecognisable even by the Mīmāṃsaka's own account.
- **B:** Correct: a cognition's truth depends on whether its generating conditions were free of defect, and the knower has no access to that from inside the cognition, so successful activity, coherence or corroboration is required.
- **C:** Incorrect: this reverses the pair, and an intrinsically felt invalidity would make illusion self-announcing, which is exactly what the shell-silver case shows it is not.
- **D:** Incorrect: Nyāya nowhere abandons ascertainment; it holds that doubt ceases practically through confirmation rather than through a foundational guarantee.

Examiner trap 25: The half-correct formulation "Nyāya is extrinsic for invalidity" is so widespread that examiners set the point deliberately; only "extrinsic for both" earns the mark.

MCQ 26. Three theories of error that scripts routinely merge

Match each account of error with the school that holds it.

1. A real object known elsewhere is apprehended as being here
2. Two valid cognitions are not discriminated, so no false cognition occurs
3. The presented object is neither real nor unreal

A. 1 - Advaita Vedānta; 2 - Nyāya; 3 - Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā

B. 1 - Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā; 2 - Advaita Vedānta; 3 - Nyāya

C. 1 - Nyāya; 2 - Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā; 3 - Advaita Vedānta

D. 1 - Nyāya; 2 - Advaita Vedānta; 3 - Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it assigns the misplacement account to Advaita, whose whole point is that the presented silver cannot be located among ordinary reals at all.
- **B:** Incorrect: it makes Nyāya the school of the indefinable object, which contradicts the realism that the misplacement account exists to protect.
- **C:** Correct: misplacement is Nyāya, non-apprehension of difference is Prābhākara, and the indefinable status is Advaita's response to an object that is both sublated and motivating.
- **D:** Incorrect: the first pairing is right but the second and third are exchanged, and Advaita does not deny that a false cognition occurs.

Examiner trap 26: Confusing misplacement with the indefinable account is among the most heavily penalised errors in the paper, because the two are opposite responses to the same illusion.

MCQ 27. Counting the reasons for the self

When a question asks for the six reasons offered by the Naiyāyikas to prove the existence of the self, the correct set is

A. desire, aversion, effort, memory, recognition and the coordination of the senses

B. desire, aversion, pleasure, pain, memory and the instrument-user relation

C. cognition, pleasure, pain, memory, recognition and moral responsibility

D. desire, aversion, effort, pleasure, pain and cognition

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: memory, recognition and sensory coordination are valuable supplementary arguments, but substituting them for effort's companions breaks the canonical formula.
- **B:** Incorrect: it drops effort and cognition, the first of which supplies the agent of striving and the second of which carries the decisive quality-requires-substance move.
- **C:** Incorrect: three of the six are replaced by supplementary considerations, and moral responsibility is a consequence drawn from the self rather than one of the marks of it.
- **D:** Correct: these are the six marks in Gautama's sequence, and the sixth is structurally distinct because cognition is a quality and therefore requires a substance to inhere in.

Examiner trap 27: Producing eight undifferentiated arguments when six were asked for fails the instruction even when every individual argument in the list is sound.

MCQ 28. What release is, and what the standing objection targets

The Nyāya account of release and the stone-like liberation objection are best stated as follows.

- A. Release is the attainment of unbroken bliss, and the objection is that bliss cannot be permanent
- B. Release is union with God, and the objection is that a plural ontology forbids such union
- C. Release is absolute cessation of pain, and the objection is that a state without consciousness cannot be worth seeking
- D. Release is the perfection of cognition, and the objection is that perfect cognition would still be relational

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: bliss is precisely what the standard Nyāya formulation does not promise, and the school argues that bliss would be relational and capable of generating attachment.
- **B:** Incorrect: union with God is not the Nyāya goal; God is an efficient cause and moral governor, and the liberated self remains a distinct substance.
- **C:** Correct: release is defined as absolute cessation of pain, and since consciousness requires conjunction with mind, senses and objects, the liberated self is left without it, which is what critics call stone-like.
- **D:** Incorrect: cognition ceases in release rather than being perfected, so the account described here belongs to a different soteriology altogether.

Examiner trap 28: Presenting the reply to the stone-like objection as decisive overlooks the motivational cost that survives it: a goal no one can desire as a state remains hard to recommend as an end of practice.

MCQ 29. What Nyāya's God does and does not do

Consider the following statements about God in Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika.

1. God is the efficient but not the material cause of the world.
2. Kaṇāda's foundational text unambiguously foregrounds a creator God.
3. Classical Yoga establishes God through the same cumulative natural theology.

Which of the statements given above is or are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: atoms remain the material cause, and the developed theistic apparatus belongs to Praśastapāda, Śrīdhara and Udayana rather than unambiguously to the foundational text.
- **B:** Incorrect: it adds statement 2, which projects later theism backwards and discards the historical control that a careful answer is expected to supply.
- **C:** Incorrect: both statements are wrong; Yoga's God is a special conscious witness and an object of devotion rather than the conclusion of a creator inference.
- **D:** Incorrect: only the first statement holds, and combining all three would attribute to one stratum of the tradition what belongs to several different ones.

Examiner trap 29: Answering the 2018 comparison with "yes, both prove God similarly" misses that the question is disjunctive and that the required answer is a reasoned negative.

MCQ 30. The doctrine of causation stated without its usual distortion

Which statement most accurately expresses the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika theory of causation?

- A. Causation is denied, since the effect is neither present in the cause nor produced from it
- B. The effect does not pre-exist in its cause and is a genuinely new production from it
- C. The effect pre-exists latently in the cause and production is only its manifestation
- D. The effect and the cause are numerically identical under two different descriptions

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the school denies pre-existence, not production; its whole apparatus of inherent, non-inherent and efficient causes exists to explain how effects are produced.
- **B:** Correct: cloth is a new whole produced from threads rather than a redescription of them, and the effect's prior non-existence is what production terminates.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is the Sāṃkhya position of the pre-existent effect, which Nyāya attacks precisely by appealing to the reality of prior non-existence.
- **D:** Incorrect: identity under two descriptions would make production trivial, and it would leave the new properties of wholes, such as being wearable, unexplained.

Examiner trap 30: Rendering the doctrine as "causation is denied" mistakes the denial of a pre-existent effect for a denial of causal production, and it makes the school's three kinds of cause unintelligible.

MCQ 31. Counting the steps from atom to visible object

In the Vaiśeṣika account of atomic combination, the minimum perceptible magnitude is reached when

- A. three dyads combine to form a triad
- B. three atoms combine to form a triad
- C. two dyads combine to form a tetrad
- D. two atoms combine to form a dyad

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the triad is the first aggregate with the magnitude required for perceptibility, standardly illustrated by the mote of dust visible in a sunbeam.
- **B:** Incorrect: the triad is composed of three dyads rather than of three atoms, and the difference is exactly the point examiners set the question to test.
- **C:** Incorrect: no tetrad stage figures in the standard sequence, which runs from atoms to dyads to triads and thereafter to increasingly complex aggregates.
- **D:** Incorrect: the dyad is expressly imperceptible, which is why a further stage of combination is required before anything becomes visible.

Examiner trap 31: Writing "three atoms make a triad" is a single-word slip that removes the dyad stage and makes the school's account of the transition from invisible to visible incoherent.

MCQ 32. Instrument and fruit, and why the schools differ

The Naiyāyika-Buddhist debate over the means of valid knowledge and its fruit turns fundamentally on

- A. whether inference should be counted as a means of valid knowledge at all
- B. whether scripture can be admitted alongside perception and inference
- C. whether the number of means of valid knowledge is two or four
- D. whether a realist ontology requires the instrument to be distinct from its result

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: both traditions accept inference as an instrument, and their extended disputes concern how concomitance is secured rather than whether inference counts.
- **B:** Incorrect: the status of scripture divides Nyāya from the Buddhists on other grounds, but it is not what the instrument-and-fruit distinction is about.
- **C:** Incorrect: the difference in count is a symptom of the deeper disagreement and does not by itself explain why one school separates instrument from result and the other does not.
- **D:** Correct: Nyāya separates knower, instrument, object and resulting cognition because an independent object requires a distinct means of reaching it, while a cognition-centred ontology has no room for a second entity nobody perceives.

Examiner trap 32: Reporting the debate as a terminological preference rather than as a consequence of opposed metaphysics loses the analysis mark, since the whole point is that each position follows from its school's ontology.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

Verified wording. Every previous-year question below is reproduced exactly as printed in the held UPSC Civil Services (Main) Philosophy Paper I question papers, 2018-2025, with the year, question number and marks as printed. **No official key exists in the repository for these descriptive questions.** The model answers are independent learner practice written to the stated word band and directive. They are never presented as official UPSC keys, and no objective answer letter is asserted for any descriptive question. **Ownership.** All twenty-two solved previous-year questions are primary-owned by Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika, which is the largest single owner in the Indian Philosophy section of the local corpus at twenty-two of one hundred and twelve parts. **Word bands used.** 10 marks: 150-200 words. 15 marks: 250-300 words. 20 marks: 340-400 words.

VERIFIED PREVIOUS-YEAR QUESTIONS - TWENTY-TWO COMPLETE SOLUTIONS

PYQ 1 · 2018 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question, as printed: How do the Vaiśeṣika philosophers explain the difference of the relationships in the two cases-(i) the brown colour of the table and (ii) the book on the table? Discuss.

Demand decoded. The hinge word is "difference of the relationships". The examiner wants the ontological criterion that separates two relations, not a description of a table.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

Vaiśeṣika holds that the two cases exhibit two categorially distinct relations. The brown colour belongs to the table by **inherence (samavāya)**; the book stands on the table by **conjunction (saṃyoga)**.

The criterion is **inseparability (ayutasiddhatva)**, not physical grip or spatial closeness. Relata are inseparable when neither can be established apart from the other in the relevant ontological mode. A table of that kind cannot be established without some colour, so colour and table are inseparable; the book and the table plainly can be established apart, so they are separable.

Their ontological ranks differ accordingly. Inherence is a **category (padārtha)** in its own right: one, eternal as a relation, imperceptible and inferred, holding across five standard pairs - whole and parts, quality and substance, motion and substance, universal and particular, and ultimate particularity and its eternal substance. Conjunction is not a category at all but one of the twenty-four **qualities (guṇa)**, produced by motion and destroyed by motion.

The decisive analytical point is that conjunction, being a quality, must itself inhere in its substances. Conjunction therefore presupposes inherence and cannot replace it, which is precisely why Vaiśeṣika refuses to reduce all relation to contact.

Why this earns marks. It names the criterion before the example, fixes the difference of ontological rank rather than of strength, and closes with the argument that conjunction presupposes inherence - the point that converts a description into a demonstration.

PYQ 2 · 2018 · Q5(d) · 10 marks

Question, as printed: How do the Buddhists and the Nyāya philosophers explain our knowledge of 'the absence of the jar on the table'? Answer in detail.

Demand decoded. Two schools, one cognition. The mark lies in showing that the disagreement is ontological before it is epistemological, and in not smuggling a fifth instrument into Nyāya.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

For Nyāya, "there is no jar on the table" has determinate structure: the table is the **locus (anuyogin)** and the jar is the **counterpositive (pratiyogin)** whose absence qualifies that locus. **Absence (abhāva)** is a real seventh category, so the cognition reports a fact rather than a mere failure to find.

Nyāya does **not** admit an independent instrument of non-cognition. The same perceptual situation that presents the empty locus presents jar-absence through the sixth sense-object contact, the **qualifier-qualified relation (viśeṣaṇa-viśeṣya-bhāva)**. Four conditions must hold: the jar would have been perceptible if present, the locus is available, the senses are competent, and nothing obstructs. Where the missing item is itself inferential, its absence is established inferentially.

The Buddhist denies any separately existing negative entity. On that view one perceives only the positive locus, and the negative judgement is explained by non-apprehension, conceptual exclusion or inference.

The disagreement is therefore first about whether absences are real, and only then about how they are known. **Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā** marks the third position, admitting **non-cognition (anupalabdhi)** as an independent instrument.

Why this earns marks. It gives the locus-counterpositive structure, names the exact contact and its four conditions, states the Buddhist alternative in its own terms, and fixes the cross-school boundary that keeps the answer controlled.

Question, as printed: How do the Naiyāyikas prove the existence of God? Do the Yoga philosophers prove God in the same way? If yes, how? And if no, why? Give reasons for your answer.

Demand decoded. The question is explicitly disjunctive: prove, then compare, then answer yes or no with reasons. A script that spends twenty marks on the Nyāya proofs alone has answered half the question.

Model answer (20 marks, 340-400 words).

The Nyāya proofs. Later Nyāya affirms **God (Īśvara)** as an eternal, omniscient, bodiless special self who is the **efficient cause (nimitta-kāraṇa)** of the world but never its material cause; atoms remain the material cause. Udayana's *Nyāyakusumāñjali* presents converging inferences. **From effect (kāryāt):** the world is composite and ordered, hence an effect, hence requires an intelligent maker, as a pot requires a potter. **From combination (āyojanāt):** at the start of a cycle, unconscious atoms and unconscious **unseen moral force (adr̥ṣṭa)** cannot initiate ordered first motion, so an intelligent impeller is required. **From sustenance (dhr̥tyādeḥ):** the cosmos is maintained, regulated and dissolved, which indicates governing intelligence. **From scripture (śruteḥ):** Vedic authority of superhuman scope implies an omniscient source. A moral strand is added: unconscious *adr̥ṣṭa* cannot allot fruits with precision, so an intelligent administrator is required.

Whether Yoga proves God in the same way - no. Classical Yoga's God is a **special conscious witness (puruṣa-viśeṣa)** untouched by afflictions, actions, fruits and latent deposits. He is *admitted* within an already complete soteriology of bondage and release, not *inferred* as the explanation of cosmic order. His role is practical: **devotion to God (Īśvara-praṇidhāna)** aids concentration and meditative absorption, and he functions as the beginningless teacher. The *Yoga-sūtra* does not construct Udayana's atomic creator inference, and Sāṃkhya, Yoga's metaphysical partner, dispenses with a creator altogether.

The reason for the difference. The two theisms answer different questions. Nyāya needs God because its atomism leaves a gap - inert atoms plus an unconscious moral ledger cannot start themselves - and because its realism about moral order requires an intelligent allocator. Yoga needs God because its practice requires an object of devotion and a guarantor of the possibility of perfect isolation. Argumentative role, not description, is the discriminating factor.

ANALYSIS: Qualified verdict. Both systems accept God, but sameness of name does not prove sameness of demonstration or function. Later Yoga commentators may strengthen theistic cosmology; the safe conclusion is that classical Yoga's God is a soteriological posit and an object of practice, whereas Nyāya's is the conclusion of a cumulative natural theology whose every strand rests on the contested premiss that order and meaning require intelligence.

Why this earns marks. It answers both halves in proportion, casts the proofs as inferences rather than as a list, gives an explicit reasoned negative to the comparison, explains the difference structurally, and closes with the shared presupposition on which every objection lands.

PYQ 4 · 2019 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question, as printed: Justify the status of Abhāva as a category in Vaiśeṣika philosophy.

Demand decoded. "Justify" asks for a defence with reasons, not a description of the four kinds. Give the datum, the explanatory need, the economy check and the honest concession.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

Four considerations justify admitting **absence (abhāva)** as a category.

Cognitive datum. Negative judgements - "no jar here", "a pot is not a cloth" - are determinately true or false, so they possess structured content: every absence has a **counterpositive (pratiyogin)** and a **locus (anuyogin)**.

Realist semantics. In this school a determinate cognition is a cognition of something real. A merely linguistic account of negation would break the correspondence on which the whole system, from **category (padārtha)** to **means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)**, depends.

Explanatory necessity. The four kinds do work elsewhere. **Prior non-existence (prāgabhāva)** is the weapon against the pre-existent effect; **posterior non-existence (pradhvaṃsābhāva)** accounts for destruction; **absolute non-existence (atyantābhāva)** and **mutual non-existence (anyonyābhāva)** account for permanent lack and for difference.

Economy. Absence is admitted as one category with four kinds, and it is known by perception or inference rather than by a new instrument, so the school's parsimony is not breached.

CAUTION: The concession is historical: Kaṇāda's older enumeration is commonly taken as six, absence being added later.

Why this earns marks. It argues rather than describes, shows the category earning its keep in the theory of causation, protects the school's economy explicitly, and concedes the disputed enumeration instead of concealing it.

PYQ 5 · 2019 · Q6(b) · 15 marks

Question, as printed: What is the role of Jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa in explaining Anyathākhyāti?

Demand decoded. "Role in explaining" asks for a mechanism. The answer must show precisely which explanatory gap this extraordinary perception fills.

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

Misplacement theory of error (anyathākhyāti) holds that in the shell-silver illusion both terms are real: the presented "this" is a real shell and silver is a real substance existing elsewhere. Falsity lies in the relation asserted - silver is taken as being *here*.

That thesis creates a problem. If the silver is not present, how can it be *given* with the immediacy of seeing rather than merely recalled? Illusions do not feel like memories; they feel like perceptions. Realism forbids saying that an unreal object was perceived, and memory alone cannot supply presentational force.

Cognition-mediated perception (jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa) fills exactly this gap. It is one of the three extraordinary (*alaukika*) perceptions, in which a prior cognition itself serves as the connecting relation between sense and object. Through it, the silver becomes present to awareness in a derivative perceptual mode without being physically present at the locus.

The mechanism runs: the eye contacts the glittering shell; the resemblance revives a past impression of silver; that prior cognition mediates a derivative perceptual presentation of silver; **non-discrimination** prevents the mind from noticing that the presented "this" and the presented silver are two; and the synthesis "this is silver" results.

The role is therefore threefold. It supplies **presentational immediacy**, it preserves **realism** by admitting no unreal object, and it explains why the corrective cognition takes the form "this is *not* silver" - a denial of location rather than of existence.

ANALYSIS: Critics reply that a perception mediated by a prior cognition strains the definition of perception, which requires production from present sense-object contact. Nyāya accepts the extension as the price of explaining illusion without ontological cost.

Why this earns marks. It states the explanatory gap before the device, gives the mechanism in ordered steps, names the three functions the device performs, and concedes the definitional strain that critics press.

PYQ 6 · 2019 · Q7(a) · 20 marks

Question, as printed: How does Udayana prove the existence of God through Kāryāt, Āyojanāt, Dhṛtyādeḥ and Śruteḥ? Discuss.

Demand decoded. Four named proofs, so four separate treatments are obligatory. "Discuss" then requires evaluation, which is best supplied by presenting the four as a cumulative case and naming the shared presupposition.

Model answer (20 marks, 340-400 words).

Udayana's *Nyāyakusumāñjali* argues for **God (Īśvara)** as an eternal, omniscient, bodiless **efficient cause (nimitta-kāraṇa)**. It proceeds by removing successive obstacles to theism rather than by one demonstration, and each named proof is a formal inference.

From effect (kāryāt). Subject: the world. Reason: it is composite, ordered and therefore an effect. Property to be proved: it has an intelligent maker. Example: pot and potter. The move from compositeness to effect-hood is Nyāya's cosmological-teleological bridge.

From combination (āyojanāt). Subject: the primordial conjunction of atoms at the start of a creative cycle. Reason: unconscious atoms and unconscious **unseen moral force (adṛṣṭa)** cannot purposively initiate ordered first motion. Property: an intelligent impeller is required. This proof is not a variant of the first; it addresses a gap left by Vaiśeṣika atomism itself, since atoms are inert and the moral ledger is unconscious.

From sustenance (dhṛtyādeḥ). Subject: the ordered cosmos. Reason: it is maintained, regulated and finally dissolved. Property: governing intelligence. This extends the case from origination to continuing governance.

From scripture (śruteḥ). Subject: Vedic and meaningful sentences. Reason: sentences require competent authorship, and Vedic scope exceeds ordinary knowledge. Property: an omniscient source. God is the **reliable authority (āpta)** who authors or transmits the Veda.

Why the four converge. Each addresses a different explanandum - compositeness, initiation, regulation, authority - so refuting one leaves the others standing. Udayana's own procedure confirms this reading: the *Nyāyakusumāñjali* removes obstacles successively, denying in turn that there is no unseen cause, that an unseen cause needs no controller, that Vedic authority can stand without an author, and that karma or atoms can operate without governance. Additional strands are commonly enumerated, including arguments from words, from cognition, from sentences and from determinate numerical modes of atomic combination, together with the moral argument that unconscious *adṛṣṭa* cannot allot fruits with precision.

ANALYSIS: Evaluation. The cumulative form is a genuine strength: no single refutation defeats it. But a cumulative case is only as strong as the premiss shared by all its strands, and here that premiss is that order, meaning and purposiveness require intelligence rather than being brute or emergent. Mīmāṃsā denies it for scripture, Sāṃkhya for cosmic teleology, the Buddhist presses the **disanalogy (vaiṣamya)** that every observed maker is embodied, and the Cārvāka refuses the inference machinery altogether. CAUTION: The exact naming and count of the proofs also vary across presentations, so the safe formula is "commonly enumerated as".

Why this earns marks. It treats all four proofs separately, gives each as an inference with its terms, explains what makes the case cumulative rather than repetitive, and evaluates by locating the single premiss on which every objection converges.

Question, as printed: Explain the concepts of 'Anyathāsiddha' and 'Ananyathāsiddha' in the context of Asatkāryavāda.

Demand decoded. The phrase "in the context of" is doing real work: the pair must be shown to be *required* by the doctrine of the newly produced effect, not merely defined alongside it.

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

Non-pre-existence of the effect (asatkāryavāda) holds that the effect does not lie latent in its cause but is a genuinely new production. This creates an immediate difficulty. Since the effect is not located in the cause, causal necessity must be located instead in the *antecedent relation* - and a bare antecedent relation over-generates, because innumerable things precede any effect.

Nyāya's definition therefore builds in a filter. A cause is an **unconditional and invariable antecedent**: prior (*pūrvavṛtti*), invariably prior (*niyata-pūrvavṛtti*) and **not otherwise established (ananyathāsiddha)**. The complete cause is the **causal complex (kāraṇa-sāmagrī)**, including the **absence of a blocking condition (pratibandhakābhāva)**.

Ananyathāsiddha marks indispensable causal relevance: the item's connection to the effect is not accounted for by anything else. **Anyathāsiddha** marks an antecedent that is otherwise established and is therefore excluded, however reliably it precedes.

Five classical exclusions, each a different kind of irrelevance: the **colour of the potter's staff** is a quality of an instrument, not a producer; the **potter's father** is a remote cause of the potter, not of the pot; the **sound of the staff** is a co-effect of the same operation; **all-pervading space** is an ever-present background, not a distinctive antecedent; the **potter's donkey** is an accidental companion.

The pair is thus not a refinement but a load-bearing device: without it, an antecedent-based definition of cause could not survive, and the doctrine of new production would collapse into the claim that everything preceding a pot causes it.

ANALYSIS: Sāṃkhya presses the residual question of restriction - why only *these* causes yield *this* effect. Nyāya answers by invariability rather than by latency, which is coherent but leaves the restriction unexplained at a deeper level.

Why this earns marks. It derives the need for the pair from the doctrine, defines both terms exactly, classifies the five exclusions by *kind* of irrelevance, and closes with the Sāṃkhya pressure point that a "critically" framed follow-up would demand.

Question, as printed: Critically evaluate the logical and metaphysical status of Viśeṣa in the context of Vaiśeṣika Philosophy.

Demand decoded. "Logical and metaphysical status" is a two-part instruction. Logical status = what work the posit does in an argument. Metaphysical status = what kind of entity it is and whether the posit is legitimate.

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

Metaphysical status. Ultimate particularity (viśeṣa) is the seventh-category individuator residing only in **eternal** substances: the atoms of earth, water, fire and air, and the eternal instances of ether, time, direction, self and mind. Composite objects need no particularity, since parts, qualities, place and causal history already distinguish them. Particularity is imperceptible and is known inferentially. It gives the *Vaiśeṣika* school its name, so the system's identity is bound to it.

Logical status. The posit answers a specific argument. Two atoms of earth may share every universal and every ordinary quality. If nothing further distinguished them, then by the identity of indiscernibles they would be one, and the school's pluralism would fail at its foundation. Particularity is introduced as the differentiator, and Nyāya frames the introduction inferentially - plurality of exactly similar eternal is otherwise inexplicable - which is consistent, since Nyāya reduces **postulation (arthāpatti)** to inference rather than admitting it as a separate instrument.

Two objections. First, the **regress of differentiators**: if particularity differentiates atoms, what differentiates particularities? The reply is that they are **self-differentiating (svato-vyāvartaka)**, distinguishing both their loci and themselves. Second, the charge of an **imperceptible ontological IOU**: an unperceived entity posited solely to perform one job.

ANALYSIS: Evaluation. The replies are coherent but terminal rather than demonstrative. "Self-differentiating" names the stopping point instead of proving it, and every relational or individuating ontology must stop somewhere. The fair verdict is that particularity is **logically indispensable within Vaiśeṣika pluralism and metaphysically stipulative**, which is why Jaina, Buddhist and Advaita critics - Śrīharṣa systematically - treat it, with inherence, as the school's weakest joint.

Why this earns marks. It separates the two halves the directive names, supplies the identity-of-indiscernibles argument that gives the posit its logical force, presses both standard objections, and delivers a graded verdict rather than a defence.

PYQ 9 · 2021 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question, as printed: Does the seed contain the tree? Discuss with reference to Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika Philosophy.

Demand decoded. A yes/no question with a school named. Answer "no" in the pre-existence sense, then pre-empt the obvious rejoinder about why only mango seeds yield mango trees.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

No - not in the sense the question invites. Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika defends **non-pre-existence of the effect (asatkāryavāda)**, also called **new beginning (ārambhavāda)**: the effect does not pre-exist in its cause.

The tree is a genuinely new effect produced from the seed under appropriate conditions of soil, moisture, warmth and time. The seed is **causal ground, not a concealed miniature tree in metaphysical latency**. Before the tree arises it has **prior non-existence (prāgabhāva)** - a real absence whose counterpositive is the tree - and that absence ends precisely when the tree is produced. A real absence cannot coexist with a latent presence.

The expected rejoinder is that only a mango seed yields a mango tree, so something mango-like must already be present. Nyāya agrees with the datum and rejects the inference. Specificity is secured by the *definition of cause* - the mango seed is the unconditional, invariable antecedent of the mango tree and of nothing else - not by pre-existence.

ANALYSIS: Contrast. Sāṃkhya's **pre-existent effect (satkāryavāda)** treats production as manifestation of what was latent. The dispute is about what causation is *for*: novelty or manifestation.

Why this earns marks. It answers the question directly, supplies the prior-absence argument, anticipates and defeats the restriction rejoinder, and names the rival doctrine with the exact point of disagreement.

PYQ 10 · 2021 · Q5(b) · 10 marks

Question, as printed: Explain with reference to Nyāya Philosophy, the nature of śabda as the advice of āpta (a reliable person).

Demand decoded. "Nature of śabda as the advice of āpta" requires three linked things: what makes a speaker reliable, what makes an utterance intelligible, and what cognition results.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

Testimony (śabda) is valid verbal knowledge arising from the instruction of a reliable person (*āptopadeśa / āptavākya*). It is an independent **means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)** because much of what any knower knows cannot be perceived personally, and human life depends on reliable communication.

The speaker. An *āpta* satisfies three conditions: correct knowledge of the matter, truthful intention to communicate it, and competence to express it. Mere social status, confidence or eminence creates no epistemic authority.

The utterance. An intelligible sentence requires four conditions: **mutual expectancy (ākāṅkṣā)** among its words, **semantic fitness (yogyatā)** without contradiction, **proximity (sannidhi / āsatti)** in utterance, and **intended meaning (tātparya)** where ambiguity exists - "bring the *saindhava*" means salt at dinner and a horse before a journey.

The result. The hearer acquires cognition of the word-object relation and hence of the object. Testimony is classified as concerning perceptible or imperceptible matters and as secular or Vedic; Nyāya accepts Vedic testimony, later linking its authority to God as omniscient author.

ANALYSIS: Risk located precisely: failure is either an unreliable speaker or an unintelligible sentence.

Why this earns marks. It gives all three limbs the question names, supplies a worked example of intended meaning, and closes by showing that the two sets of conditions between them exhaust the ways testimony can fail.

PYQ 11 · 2021 · Q5(c) · 10 marks

Question, as printed: Is 'inseparability' (ayuta-siddhatva) a necessary condition or a sufficient condition for defining characteristics (lakṣaṇa) of samavāya (inherence)? Explain with reference to Vaiśeṣika Philosophy.

Demand decoded. A necessary/sufficient question is a question about *defining characteristics*, and the technical vocabulary of definitional faults is what the examiner is looking for.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

Inseparability is **necessary but not by itself sufficient**.

Necessary. Inherence (samavāya) is defined as the eternal inseparable relation (*ayutasiddha-sambandha*) holding across five pairs: whole and parts, quality and substance, motion and substance, universal and particular, and ultimate particularity and its eternal substance. In every case the relata cannot be established separately, so no case of inherence lacks inseparability.

Not sufficient. A **defining characteristic (lakṣaṇa)** must avoid three faults: being too narrow (*avyāpti*), too wide (*ativyāpti*) and impossible (*asambhava*). Inseparability alone risks being **too wide**, since it can be satisfied wherever two items happen to be inseparably found without exhibiting the specific categorial dependence of a dependent term on its locus. Physical inseparability is emphatically not the criterion; **conjunction (saṃyoga)** between a book and a table is separable, but tightness of attachment never converts a conjunction into inherence.

The defensible formulation is therefore: inseparability **plus** the specific ontological dependence of the dependent term on its locus.

ANALYSIS: The question is testing the difference between a necessary condition and a definition; conflating them answers an easier question than the one asked.

Why this earns marks. It gives a direct verdict, uses the technical vocabulary of definitional faults, shows *why* the condition is too wide, and names the discrimination the examiner is actually testing.

PYQ 12 · 2022 · Q5(b) · 10 marks

Question, as printed: What is the ontological status of Sāmānya, according to Vaiśeṣika Philosophy? Critically examine.

Demand decoded. "Ontological status ... critically examine" means: what kind of entity, on what argument, and with what surviving objection.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

Universal (sāmānya) is a real, eternal, one-in-many entity, present in many particulars by **inherence (samavāya)** rather than by spatial division, and ordered as higher (*para*) and lower (*apara*) by extension.

The argument. We classify dissimilar individuals under one concept - a black cow and a white calf are both cows. Resemblance cannot ground this, since resemblance must itself be resemblance in some objectively common respect. Therefore a real common entity is required. The presupposition is realist semantics: common predication reflects objective common structure.

The economy. Realism here is regulated. The six **blockers of universalhood (jāti-bādhaka)** refuse a candidate that would have a single instance, duplicate a co-extensive universal, cross-cut another, generate regress, destroy its bearer's function, or lack an available relation. A blocked candidate survives only as an **imposed property (upādhi)**.

ANALYSIS: Critical examination. Buddhist **exclusion theory (apoha)** replies that universals are unperceived, causally inert and not wholly present in many places. Nyāya answers that universals *are* presented in determinate perception and that exclusion presupposes stable exclusion-classes. **ANALYSIS:** The reply holds only for one who already grants realist semantics, so the dispute is about starting-points.

Why this earns marks. It states the ontology precisely, gives the argument with its presupposition, defends economy by naming the blockers, and ends with an objection whose residual force is stated rather than dismissed.

Question, as printed: How do Naiyāyikas respond to Cārvāka's objections against inference (anumāna) and establish inference as an independent means of knowledge? Critically discuss.

Demand decoded. Two verbs: "respond" and "establish". State the Cārvāka case at full strength first; a weak statement of the objection makes the reply look easy and loses analysis marks.

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

The Cārvāka case, at full strength. Inference presupposes **invariable concomitance (vyāpti)**. But no finite observation licenses an unrestricted universal; a **conditioning adjunct (upādhi)** may always lurk undetected; **hypothetical reasoning (tarka)** appears to presuppose inference and so to be circular; and **universal-mediated perception (sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa)** looks like a posit invented for the occasion. Hence only perception is a means of valid knowledge.

The Nyāya response. Concomitance is grasped by a disciplined chain, each step calibrated to the previous step's gap. **Repeated observation (bhūyodarśana)** collects co-presence and co-absence; Nyāya concedes at once that a finite sample cannot yield a universal. **Non-observation of deviation (vyabhicāra-adarśana)** shifts from collecting to attempted refutation. **Elimination of the adjunct (upādhi-nirāsa)** applies the formula that an adjunct pervades the property to be proved without pervading the reason - wet fuel defeats the fire-to-smoke inference but no comparable adjunct is found for smoke-to-fire. **Hypothetical reasoning** then removes residual doubt by exposing the unacceptable consequence of the contrary supposition, and is expressly classed as an **aid to the instruments (pramāṇa-anugrahaka)**, never as one of them - which is exactly why the reply is not circular.

Establishing independence. Because universals are real, perceiving an instance of smokiness relates the cognizer to smoke *as such*, so the kind rather than the sample is grasped. Inference thus yields cognition that perception cannot: what lies beyond present sense-contact.

The counter-attack. A universal denial of inference is itself a universal claim about inference, inviting **self-contradiction in one's own speech (svavacana-virodha)**; and the Cārvāka's own argument from possible hidden adjuncts is itself inferential.

ANALYSIS: Residual force. The reply presupposes realism about universals. Deny real kinds, and the induction solution becomes contested rather than secured.

Why this earns marks. It states the objection strongly, gives the four-step chain with the adjunct formula worked out, protects the reply from circularity explicitly, adds the self-refutation charge, and concedes the presupposition on which the whole defence rests.

PYQ 14 · 2023 · Q5(d) · 10 marks

Question, as printed: Present an account of Vaiśeṣika's view of negation in the light of their statement - "Negation always has a counterpositive and absolute negation is an impossibility."

Demand decoded. A quoted statement must be decoded before it is answered. Clause one asserts structure; clause two denies contentless negation - and it must not be confused with denying absolute absence.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

The quoted statement has two clauses, and each carries a distinct doctrine.

"Negation always has a counterpositive." Every **absence (abhāva)** is the absence of something; that absent positive term is the **counterpositive (pratiyogin)**, and it qualifies a **locus (anuyogin)**. Absence is therefore not sheer blankness but structured, intentional content - which is what allows it to be a real seventh category rather than a mere linguistic operation.

"Absolute negation is an impossibility." A negation of *nothing in particular*, lacking any counterpositive and any locus, would have no content and could not be a cognition at all. The impossible item is **contentless negation**.

ANALYSIS: The discrimination that decides the mark. This does **not** deny **absolute non-existence (atyantābhāva)**, which is a fully admitted kind with a determinate counterpositive - the hare's horn is absent in every locus at all times, but it is the horn that is absent.

The four kinds follow: **prior (prāgabhāva)** has no beginning but ends at production; **posterior (pradhvaṃsābhāva)** begins at destruction and never ends; **absolute** is bounded at neither end; **mutual (anyonyābhāva)** is difference - a pot is not a cloth.

Why this earns marks. It decodes both clauses before answering, blocks the standard conflation between absolute *absence* and absolute *negation*, and supplies the fourfold classification with exact temporal signatures.

PYQ 15 · 2023 · Q6(c) · 15 marks

Question, as printed: Elucidate Naiyāyikas view of ordinary and extraordinary perception. Are they justified in accepting that universals are perceived? Discuss.

Demand decoded. Two demands: expound ordinary and extraordinary perception, then deliver a judgement on the perceptibility of universals. The judgement must be conditional, not a cheer.

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

Ordinary perception (laukika). Gautama defines perception as cognition produced from **sense-object contact (indriyārtha-sannikarṣa)**, non-verbal, non-errant and determinate. It runs from an **indeterminate (nirvikalpaka)** pre-predicative phase to a **determinate (savikalpaka)** phase such as "this is a blue pot". Six graded contacts explain what can be reached: conjunction for a substance; inherence in what is conjoined for its quality; inherence in what inheres in what is conjoined for the universal in that quality; inherence for sound; inherence in what inheres for sound-ness; and the **qualifier-qualified relation** for absences.

Extraordinary perception (alaukika). Three kinds, distinguished by what supplies the connecting relation.

Universal-mediated (sāmānyalakṣaṇa): apprehending an instance of smokeness relates the cognizer to smoke as such, so the kind rather than the sample is given. **Cognition-mediated (jñānalakṣaṇa):** a prior cognition mediates a present perceptual presentation, as when sandalwood is "seen" as fragrant. **Yogic (yogaja):** perception of subtle, distant, past or future objects by the perfected practitioner.

Are they justified about universals? For: determinate perception already presents an individual *as qualified by* a universal, so the universal is given in the cognition rather than added to it; the third and fifth contacts are constructed precisely to reach universals; and without perceptible kinds, classification and the grasping of concomitance lose their base.

ANALYSIS: Against: CAUTION: critics hold that universal-mediated perception is *ad hoc*, built to solve induction; Buddhist **exclusion theory (apoha)** explains classification without a perceived one-in-many; and admitting a perception whose object is not in present contact strains the school's own definition.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict.** Justified *within* Nyāya's realist ontology, where universals are genuine categories and the third and fifth contacts are constructed to reach them; not justified for an opponent who has already refused that ontology. The dispute is metaphysical before it is perceptual.

Why this earns marks. It covers both kinds with the six contacts named functionally, gives three arguments on each side of the evaluative question, and closes with a conditional verdict that locates the real disagreement.

PYQ 16 · 2023 · Q7(a) · 20 marks

Question, as printed: Elucidate Naiyāyikas account of fallacies of the middle term in relation to five characteristics of valid middle term.

Demand decoded. "In relation to" is the whole instruction. The fallacies must be presented as the negative image of the five marks, one by one, not as two separate lists.

Model answer (20 marks, 340-400 words).

Nyāya tests the middle term twice - positively, through five marks of a valid **reason (hetu)**, and negatively, through five **fallacies of the reason (hetvābhāsa)**. They are one test read in two directions.

The five marks. (1) **Presence in the subject (pakṣadharmatā)**: the reason occurs in the subject under consideration. (2) **Presence in similar instances (sapakṣa-sattva)**: it occurs where the property is known to hold. (3) **Absence from dissimilar instances (vipakṣa-asattva)**: it never occurs where the property is known to be absent. (4) **Not contradicted (abādhitā)**: the property is not defeated by a stronger instrument. (5) **Not counterbalanced (asatpratipakṣa)**: no equally strong counter-reason exists.

The five fallacies, mapped.

Irregular (savyabhicāra / anaikāntika) violates mark 3. The reason strays into dissimilar instances. Subtypes: **too common (sādhāraṇa)**, occurring in both similar and dissimilar instances; **too restricted (asādhāraṇa)**, confined to the subject so that no contrast class remains; **inconclusive by over-width (anupasaṃhārin)**, so wide that no contrast is available.

Unproved (asiddha / sādhyasama) violates mark 1. Subtypes: **locus-unproved (āśrayāsiddha)**, where the subject is unreal; **form-unproved (svarūpāsiddha)**, where the reason is absent from the subject; **pervasion-unproved (vyāpyatvāsiddha)**, where concomitance is unestablished, typically because a **conditioning adjunct (upādhi)** is present - as wet fuel is in the inference from fire to smoke.

Stultified (bādhitā / kālātīta) violates mark 4. The conclusion is defeated by a stronger instrument: fire cannot be inferred to be cold, because perception overrules it.

Counterbalanced (satpratipakṣa / prakaraṇasama) violates mark 5. An equally strong opposing reason establishes the contrary property, and the dispute deadlocks with neither side defeated on its own terms.

Contradictory (viruddha) is the exception. It does not merely negate one mark; it **inverts the concomitance** that all five marks presuppose, so that the reason proves the opposite of the intended property - a reason offered for permanence establishing impermanence instead.

ANALYSIS: **Evaluation.** The correspondence is systematic rather than accidental: because a valid reason is defined by five conditions, exactly five modes of failure are possible, with one of them operating at the level of the relation itself rather than at the level of a condition. ANALYSIS: The scheme's power nevertheless depends on the prior availability of similar and dissimilar instances, which is exactly what positive-only (*kevalānvayī*) and negative-only (*kevalavyatireki*) inferences lack - so the fallacy theory is at its strongest where both classes exist and requires careful handling elsewhere.

Why this earns marks. It presents one test in two directions, maps four fallacies one-to-one and identifies the fifth as structurally different, supplies the named subtypes and examples, and evaluates the completeness of the scheme rather than merely reciting it.

Question, as printed: Write a note on Nyāya notion of Prāgabdhāva (prior non-existence). How does this notion help Naiyāyikas in defending their position on causation against the Sāṃkhya view of causation? Critically discuss.

Demand decoded. A note plus a use plus a critical evaluation. The evaluation must concede that the argument presupposes the reality of absences, which Sāṃkhya need not grant.

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

The notion. Prior non-existence (prāgabdhāva) is the first of the four kinds of **absence (abhāva)**: the non-existence of an effect before its production. Its temporal signature is distinctive - it has **no beginning** but **ends** at the moment the effect is produced. Its counterpositive is the effect itself; its locus is the material cause. Unlike posterior non-existence, which begins at destruction and never ends, prior non-existence is terminated by production, so its termination and the effect's origination are one event described twice.

The use against Sāṃkhya. Sāṃkhya's **pre-existent effect (satkāryavāda)** holds that the effect lies latent in its cause and that production is manifestation. Nyāya's counter runs: prior non-existence is a real absence with the effect as counterpositive; a real absence cannot coexist with a latent presence of the same thing in the same locus; therefore, before production, the effect is genuinely absent; therefore production is a new beginning, and **non-pre-existence of the effect (asatkāryavāda / ārambhavāda)** stands. The argument is sharp because it converts an ontological category the school already needs into a weapon it did not have to invent for the occasion.

ANALYSIS: Critical evaluation. Two limits. First, the argument is **internally decisive and externally question-begging**: prior non-existence is a Vaiśeṣika posit, and Sāṃkhya is not obliged to admit absences as real entities, so the causation dispute reduces to the prior dispute about negative facts. Second, Sāṃkhya's own motivation survives untouched - the restriction of specific effects to specific causes. Nyāya answers restriction by invariability built into the definition of cause rather than by latency, which is coherent but explains the regularity at the level of the causal relation rather than of the effect.

Why this earns marks. It fixes the temporal signature precisely, sets out the anti-Sāṃkhya argument as a numbered inference, and delivers two distinct criticisms rather than a generic reservation.

Question, as printed: Explain the six reasons offered by the Naiyāyikas to prove the existence of the self.

Demand decoded. "Six reasons" is a count instruction. Give Gautama's canonical six and label anything else as supplementary.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

Gautama's canonical formula is that **desire, aversion, effort, pleasure, pain and cognition are the marks of the self (icchā-dveṣa-prayatna-sukha-duḥkha-jñānāny ātmano liṅgam)**.

1. **Desire (icchā)** requires a subject who desires.
2. **Aversion (dveṣa)** requires a subject who rejects or avoids.
3. **Effort (prayatna)** requires an agent of striving.
4. **Pleasure (sukha)** requires an experiencer.
5. **Pain (duḥkha)** requires an experiencer.
6. **Cognition (jñāna)** is a **quality (guṇa)** and therefore requires a substance in which it inheres.

The argument is **cumulative**, not six independent proofs. These qualities are episodic and variable, yet each is appropriated as "I desire", "I suffer", "I know". Variable qualities appropriated by one owner point to a single enduring **substance (dravya)** - the **self (ātman)** - distinct from body, senses and mind, in which consciousness inheres as an **adventitious quality** rather than constituting its essence.

ANALYSIS: Supplementary, not canonical. Memory and recognition support persistence across time, and the coordinated body-sense-mind complex supports an instrument-user inference. These enrich a longer answer but must never be substituted for one of the six.

Why this earns marks. It gives exactly six in Gautama's own sequence, marks the structural difference of the sixth, states the cumulative character explicitly, and separates the supplementary arguments instead of silently padding the count.

PYQ 19 · 2024 · Q5(c) · 10 marks

Question, as printed: Do these two sentences "Air does not have heat" and "Air is not fire" refer to the same type of absence or abhāva, according to the Vaiśeṣikas? Discuss.

Demand decoded. A yes/no discrimination. The mark lies in the structural test that separates a denial of qualification from a denial of identity.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

No - the two sentences report different kinds of **absence (abhāva)**.

"Air does not have heat." The locus is air, a substance; the counterpositive is heat, a **quality (guṇa)**. The claim is that a quality does not, and will not, reside in this locus. In the Vaiśeṣika scheme hot touch is the characteristic touch of fire, so its absence in air is not a contingent shortage but a permanent categorial one. This is **absolute non-existence (atyantābhāva)** of heat with respect to air.

"Air is not fire." Here the counterpositive is fire, another **substance (dravya)**. The claim denies **identity** between two entities, not the residence of a quality in a locus. This is **mutual non-existence (anyonyābhāva)**, which is reciprocal difference - as in "a pot is not a cloth".

The deciding test. Ask what the counterpositive is. If the missing item is a quality that could have qualified the locus, the absence is absolute. If it is another entity with which the locus might be identified, the absence is mutual.

ANALYSIS: Sameness of grammatical subject does not entail sameness of absence; the classification is fixed by the counterpositive, not by the locus.

Why this earns marks. It answers directly, analyses each sentence into locus and counterpositive, supplies a portable structural test, and names the surface feature that misleads most scripts.

PYQ 20 · 2025 · Q5(b) · 10 marks

Question, as printed: Present an exposition of the debate between Naiyāyikas and Buddhists with reference to the notion of Pramāṇa and Pramāṇaphala.

Demand decoded. "Exposition of the debate" means both positions plus the reason each holds its position. A bare contrast of definitions will not do.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

The Nyāya position. A cognitive episode has four analytically distinct factors: the **knower (pramātr)**, the **means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)**, the **object (prameya)** and the **resulting true cognition (pramā / pramiti)**, which is the **fruit (pramāṇaphala)**. The instrument is the operative causal complex; the fruit is the true cognition it produces. Instrument and fruit are therefore different.

The reason. The separation follows from realism. If the object is independently real, the means of reaching it must be distinct from the reaching, exactly as an axe is distinct from the splitting it produces.

The Buddhist position. Buddhist epistemologists such as **Dignāga** are commonly read as tightening the relation, so that cognition itself is both the revelatory act and its result within a self-luminous framework.

The reason. With only momentary cognition-events available and no enduring knower, an instrument distinct from its result would be a further entity that nothing presents.

ANALYSIS: Verdict. The debate is not terminological. **Nyāya is instrumentally realist; Buddhist epistemology is cognition-centred**, and each account of the instrument-fruit relation follows directly from its school's ontology.

Why this earns marks. It gives both positions with their supporting reasons, uses the axe-and-splitting analogy to make the realist point concrete, and closes by deriving the disagreement from the underlying metaphysics.

Question, as printed: Present an exposition of Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika's theory of causation.

Demand decoded. A general exposition at ten marks. Cover the thesis, the definition of cause, the threefold classification and one contrast - nothing more, or the answer runs long and shallow.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika holds **non-pre-existence of the effect (asatkāryavāda)**, also called **new beginning (ārambhavāda)**: the effect does not pre-exist in its cause but is genuinely produced. Cloth is a new whole with properties its threads lack, not a redescription of them.

Definition of cause. A cause is an **unconditional and invariable antecedent** - prior, invariably prior, and **not otherwise established (ananyathāsiddha)**. The complete cause is the **causal complex (kāraṇa-sāmagrī)** including the absence of a blocker. Merely **otherwise-established (anyathāsiddha)** antecedents are excluded: the colour of the potter's staff, the potter's father, the sound of the staff, all-pervading space and the potter's donkey.

Three kinds of cause. Inherent (samavāyi) - the threads in which the cloth inheres; **non-inherent (asamavāyi)** - the conjunction of those threads, a quality produced by motion; **efficient (nimitta)** - the weaver with his loom. The classification mirrors the categories: substance, quality, agency.

ANALYSIS: Contrast. Sāṃkhya's **pre-existent effect (satkāryavāda)** makes production manifestation. Nyāya's decisive counter is **prior non-existence (prāgabhāva)**: a real absence of the effect, ending exactly at production.

Why this earns marks. It covers thesis, definition, exclusions, threefold classification and the rival contrast within the band, and shows the classification of causes arising from the category scheme rather than floating free.

Question, as printed: Present a detailed account of Gautama's definition of Perception.

Demand decoded. "Detailed account" of a *definition* means clause-by-clause treatment. Each clause must be paired with the rival it excludes, and the internal tension in the last clause must be reported.

Model answer (20 marks, 340-400 words).

Gautama defines perception as *indriyārtha-sannikarṣa-utpannam jñānam avyapadeśyam avyabhicāri vyavasāyātmakam pratyakṣam* - cognition produced from sense-object contact, non-verbal, non-errant and determinate. The definition works by **exclusion**: each clause rules out a specific rival candidate.

Produced from sense-object contact (indriyārtha-sannikarṣa-utpanna). Perception begins in a relation between sense organ and object, and the cognition must be *generated* by that relation, not merely accompanied by it. This excludes inference, memory and testimony at a stroke, and marks perception as the foundational instrument, since the other three all presuppose that something was at some point perceived.

Non-verbal (avyapadeśya). Perception is not constituted by words *as words*. This separates it from **testimony (śabda)**. It does not mean perception is inexpressible: determinate perception is expressible and remains perception.

Non-errant (avyabhicāri). Genuine perception is unerring, so shell-silver illusion is excluded from valid perception. Note the consequence: since illusion is excluded rather than explained, the system incurs an obligation to supply a separate theory of error, discharged by **misplacement (anyathākhyāti)**.

Determinate (vyavasāyātmaka). The cognition is definite, not doubtful; "is that a post or a man?" is excluded.

The internal tension. Later Naiyāyikas also admit an **indeterminate (nirvikalpaka)** pre-predicative phase preceding the **determinate (savikalpaka)** phase such as "this is a blue pot". If perception must be determinate, how can the indeterminate phase be perception? The standard resolution is that the clause excludes *doubt*, not the pre-predicative stage: that stage is generated by contact and is not doubtful, merely unarticulated. CAUTION: Critics answer that this makes one word do two jobs.

What the definition sets up. Because simple contact cannot reach every kind of object, six graded **contacts (sannikarṣa)** are elaborated - conjunction for substances, inherence in what is conjoined for qualities, inherence in what inheres in what is conjoined for universals in qualities, inherence for sound, inherence in what inheres for

sound-ness, and the qualifier-qualified relation for absences. And because ordinary contact cannot present a kind as such, three **extraordinary (alaukika)** perceptions are admitted: universal-mediated, cognition-mediated and yogic.

ANALYSIS: Verdict. The definition is economical and generative: four clauses exclude four rivals and simultaneously set the agenda for the school's theory of error, its taxonomy of contacts and its account of induction. Its one unresolved strain is the determinacy clause, which the tradition itself had to reinterpret.

Why this earns marks. It reads the definition as a filter, pairs every clause with the rival it excludes, reports the internal tension with its resolution and its criticism, and shows how the definition generates the rest of the epistemology.

ORIGINAL SOLVED MAINS PRACTICE - SIX QUESTIONS

These six questions are **original practice items** written in the style and at the difficulty of the paper. They are not previous-year questions and are not official keys. Two are set at 10 marks, two at 15 and two at 20, using the same word bands as above.

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question. Explain why Nyāya refuses to count memory (*smṛti*) among the means of valid knowledge, and compare its ground with the Prābhākara ground for the same exclusion.

Demand decoded. "Compare its ground" is the operative phrase: the verdict is shared, so the marks lie entirely in distinguishing the two reasons.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

A **means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)** must produce **fresh, true cognition** of what is not already known in that mode. **Memory (smṛti)** merely reproduces a cognition already had; it originates no new content. Nyāya's ground of exclusion is therefore the **novelty condition**: however accurate a recollection may be, it adds nothing to the knower's stock and so is not an instrument, though it remains psychologically indispensable and is presupposed by comparison and by the theory of error.

The **Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā** ground is related but distinct. Their objection is that memory is not **presentative**: it depends on a residual impression (*saṃskāra*) rather than on a present object, so its content is borrowed rather than given. Where Nyāya asks what a cognition *adds*, Prābhākara asks what a cognition is *of*.

ANALYSIS: The two grounds converge on one verdict but diverge in their tests, and a question that names both schools is testing exactly this divergence rather than the shared conclusion.

Why this earns marks. It supplies the definition that does the excluding, states two distinct grounds in one sentence each, and identifies the precise axis of difference - what a cognition adds versus what it is of.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question. "The atomism of Vaiśeṣika is incomplete without a theistic supplement." Examine this claim.

Demand decoded. "Examine" tests internal logic. The claim should be granted in a specific sense and qualified historically.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

The claim is largely defensible. **Atoms (paramāṇu)** are eternal, partless and **inert**; **unseen moral force (adr̥ṣṭa)** is real but **unconscious**. At the beginning of a creative cycle, compounds have dissolved and first motion must begin again. Neither an inert atom nor an unconscious moral residue can purposively initiate an ordered combination, and combination must be ordered, since two atoms form a dyad (*dvyaṇuka*) and three dyads a triad (*tryaṇuka*), the first perceptible magnitude.

The gap is therefore internal to the physics, not imported from religion. This is exactly why Udayana's **argument from combination (āyojanāt)** is not a variant of the argument from effect: it addresses the atomism's own unfinished business.

ANALYSIS: Two qualifications. First, historically the supplement is late: Kaṇāda's foundational text does not unambiguously foreground a creator, and the theistic synthesis belongs to Praśastapāda, Śrīdhara and Udayana. Second, an opponent may accept the physics and deny that ordered initiation requires *intelligence* rather than being brute - which is where Sāṃkhya and the Buddhists resist.

Why this earns marks. It grants the claim on a stated internal ground, connects it to the specific proof it generates, and qualifies both historically and dialectically.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question. Nyāya stops the regress of relations by declaring inherence self-linking and the regress of individuator by declaring ultimate particularity self-differentiating. Critically discuss whether these two moves are legitimate.

Demand decoded. "Critically discuss whether legitimate" invites neither endorsement nor dismissal. The answer must find the precise form of the charge that survives.

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

The two moves. If **inherence (samavāya)** relates a quality to its substance, a further relation appears necessary to relate inherence to each relatum, generating **infinite regress (anavasthā)**. Nyāya replies that inherence is a **self-linking relation (svarūpa-sambandha)**, relating by its own nature. Similarly, if **ultimate particularity (viśeṣa)** differentiates one atom from another, a further differentiator seems required; Nyāya replies that particularities are **self-differentiating (svato-vyāvartaka)**.

The case for legitimacy. Every relational and individuating ontology must terminate somewhere, on pain of an actual infinite regress that would explain nothing. Declaring a terminus is not by itself a fault; it is a structural necessity, and the school selects its termini at exactly the two points where regress threatens. Moreover, the moves are not unmotivated: inherence is admitted because whole-part and quality-substance relations would otherwise be unexplained, and particularity because exactly similar eternals would otherwise collapse by the identity of indiscernibles.

ANALYSIS: The charge that survives. It is not that Nyāya stops, but that it stops **selectively**. The school deploys regress as a weapon elsewhere - the fourth **blocker of universalhood (jāti-bādhaka)** refuses universal-ness precisely because it would generate regress - while claiming immunity for its own two termini. The asymmetry needs an independent criterion distinguishing a legitimate primitive from an illegitimate one, and Nyāya supplies explanatory indispensability rather than a formal test. **ANALYSIS: Critics - Buddhists, and Śrīharṣa systematically in the Khaṇḍanakhaṇḍakhādyā** - press exactly this.

ANALYSIS: Verdict. The moves are legitimate as primitives and vulnerable as arguments: they name where explanation stops rather than showing that it must stop there, which is why inherence and particularity remain the school's most contested joints.

Why this earns marks. It states both regresses precisely, defends termination on structural grounds, isolates selectivity as the surviving charge, and closes with a graded verdict rather than a verdict for one side.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question. Compare the Nyāya and Advaita accounts of the self and of liberation, and assess which account better explains the desirability of the goal it proposes.

Demand decoded. "Assess which better explains desirability" narrows the comparison to a single evaluative axis. Do not write a general contrast.

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

Nyāya. The **self (ātman)** is an eternal, all-pervading **substance (dravya)**, and selves are many. Consciousness is an **adventitious quality** arising only under the conjunction of self, mind, senses and objects. **Release (apavarga)** is accordingly the **absolute cessation of pain (duḥkha-atyanta-nivṛtti)**, reached by true knowledge removing false notion, defects, activity, birth and finally suffering. In release, cognition, pleasure and pain all cease.

Advaita. The self is not a substance bearing consciousness but consciousness itself, and it is one, not many. Liberation is not the cessation of a quality but the removal of ignorance regarding what one always was; it is characterised as being, consciousness and bliss.

The evaluative axis. Advaita explains desirability more easily: a goal described as bliss is intelligibly wanted, and no further motivational account is required. This is the force of the **stone-like liberation** objection pressed against Nyāya - why seek a state without consciousness or satisfaction, and how can anyone form the desire for it?

ANALYSIS: Nyāya's reply is principled. The aim is **freedom from suffering, not the acquisition of bliss**; and bliss, being relational, could itself generate attachment, so a state of bliss would not be secure. Its account also explains permanence straightforwardly: nothing remains that could be lost.

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** Advaita wins on motivational intelligibility, because a goal named as bliss is intelligibly wanted and needs no further defence. Nyāya wins on internal consistency, because its goal follows rigorously from the prior classification of consciousness as an adventitious quality rather than as the self's nature, and it also explains permanence straightforwardly: nothing remains in release that could later be lost. The disagreement is therefore not about the value of liberation but about what a self is, and each soteriology is exactly as attractive as its underlying account of consciousness allows.

Why this earns marks. It restricts itself to the named axis, states both positions with their technical vocabulary, awards each side the point it genuinely wins, and traces the disagreement back to the prior question about consciousness.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question. "Vaiśeṣika multiplies categories only where explanatory need demands them." Critically examine this claim with reference to universal, ultimate particularity, inherence and absence.

Demand decoded. A quotation plus four named categories. Each must be tested against the claim separately, and the verdict must be graded, not uniform.

Model answer (20 marks, 340-400 words).

The claim asserts a disciplined ontology rather than a generous one. It should be tested category by category.

Universal (sāmānya). The need is real: dissimilar individuals are classified together, and resemblance cannot ground this, since resemblance is always resemblance in some objectively common respect. Crucially, the school also polices the posit. The six **blockers of universalhood (jāti-bādhaka)** refuse a candidate that would have a single instance, duplicate a co-extensive universal, cross-cut another, generate regress, destroy its bearer's function, or lack an available relation; refused candidates survive only as **imposed properties (upādhi)**. Here the claim is strongly vindicated.

Absence (abhāva). The need is again real: negative judgements have determinate content, structured as **counterpositive (pratiyogin)** and **locus (anuyogin)**, and **prior non-existence (prāgabhāva)** does indispensable work against the pre-existent effect. Economy is preserved: one category with four kinds, known by existing instruments rather than by a new one. CAUTION: The historical qualification is that Kaṇāda's older enumeration is commonly taken as six, so the seventh was itself a considered addition.

Inherence (samavāya). The need is structural: **conjunction (saṃyoga)** is itself a quality and must inhere, so conjunction presupposes inherence and cannot replace it. But the posit is defended against regress by declaring it **self-linking (svarūpa-sambandha)**, and parsimony at the top - inherence is one, not many - is purchased by an explanatory debt lower down, since a single relation must borrow all its specificity from its relata.

Ultimate particularity (viśeṣa). The need is narrow but genuine: exactly similar eternal substances would collapse by the identity of indiscernibles. Yet the entity is imperceptible, posited for exactly one task, and rescued from regress by being declared **self-differentiating (svato-vyāvartaka)**. This is where the claim is weakest.

ANALYSIS: **Graded verdict.** The claim holds strongly for universal and absence, where explanatory need is independent and internal discipline is visible. It holds moderately for inherence, where the need is structural but the terminus is stipulated. It holds weakly for particularity, which is close to an entity introduced to save a doctrine.

ANALYSIS: The fair conclusion is that Vaiśeṣika is economical in *procedure* - it publishes refusal rules and reduces where it can - while remaining vulnerable at the two points where it declares a primitive rather than deriving one, which is precisely where Buddhist, Advaitin and Jaina critics concentrate.

Why this earns marks. It tests the quotation against each named category separately, supplies the internal discipline that supports the claim, identifies the two weakest joints, and grades the verdict instead of endorsing or rejecting the

claim wholesale.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question. Analyse how Nyāya's theory of the means of valid knowledge, its theory of error and its theory of validity depend upon one another, and evaluate whether that interdependence is a strength or a vulnerability.

Demand decoded. "Analyse how they depend upon one another" requires demonstrated linkage; "evaluate whether" requires a two-sided judgement.

Model answer (20 marks, 340-400 words).

The three doctrines. Gautama defines **perception (pratyakṣa)** as cognition produced from sense-object contact, non-verbal, **non-errant** and determinate. **Misplacement (anyathākhyāti)** explains illusion as a real object known elsewhere apprehended as here. **Extrinsic validity (parataḥ-prāmāṇya)** holds that both validity and invalidity are known through external conditions or later checks.

First dependence: definition creates a debt. By excluding illusion through the non-errancy clause, the definition of perception refuses to explain error; it merely rules it out. Some account must therefore be supplied elsewhere, and misplacement discharges that debt without admitting an unreal object: both the presented "this" and the silver are real, and only the asserted relation is false.

Second dependence: error demands extrinsic validity. If a false cognition can be phenomenally indistinguishable from a true one - as shell-silver plainly is - then truth cannot announce itself from within. Intrinsic validity would make illusion self-detecting, which experience refutes. Hence validity, and equally invalidity, must be ascertained externally, through successful activity, coherence or corroboration.

Third dependence: extrinsic validity requires the mechanism of error. Extrinsic validity is intelligible only if there is an account of how a defective cognition arises from real materials. **Cognition-mediated perception (jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa)** supplies it, giving the absent silver presentational force through a prior cognition; and the corrective cognition's form - "this is *not* silver" - confirms the analysis by denying a location rather than an existence.

Evaluation - strength. The three doctrines form a closed explanatory circuit in which each is required by the others, so the system is unusually economical: it needs no unreal object, no third ontological status and no self-certifying cognition. It also generates a testable prediction about the *form* of correction, which the phenomenology matches.

ANALYSIS: Evaluation - vulnerability. Interdependence is also concentrated exposure. If cognition-mediated perception is rejected as straining the definition of perception, illusion loses its presentational force; if intrinsic validity is granted with Mīmāṃsā, the motive for the extrinsic account weakens; and if absences and universals are denied, the six contacts that make the epistemology work lose their objects. **ANALYSIS:** Each of these is a live rival position, so the circuit stands or falls largely together.

ANALYSIS: Verdict. The interdependence is a strength within the system and a vulnerability across systems: it makes Nyāya internally coherent and externally all-or-nothing, which is exactly why its debates with Prābhākara, Advaita and the Buddhists are conducted at the level of starting-points rather than of details.

Why this earns marks. It demonstrates three specific dependences rather than asserting a general connection, uses the form of the corrective cognition as evidence, and evaluates the same feature as both strength and exposure with named rivals attached.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Read this only after the Basic block and the practice sections. Nothing below is needed for a full-marks core answer on the categories, the means of valid knowledge, perception, inference, error, the self, release, God, causation, atomism or any routed previous-year question. Each module is an *evaluative* enrichment: use at most one, in the critical paragraph of a fifteen- or twenty-marker, after the core exposition is already complete. Two is the ceiling.

1. Navya-Nyāya technical language - scholastic excess or analytic gain?

ANALYSIS: **The issue.** Does the later formalism associated with Gaṅgeśa merely complicate Nyāya, or does it supply the finest available tools for analysing cognition, absence and relation?

CAUTION: **The two readings.** A classical-expository reading holds that old Nyāya is sufficient for the doctrine an examiner can test, and that the later idiom adds precision without adding content. A Navya reading holds that the later precision clarifies exactly *what* is being cognised and *how* - for example by resolving the qualifier-qualified structure of a cognition into determinate relational components, and by making the counterpositive of an absence a specifiable term rather than a loose reference.

FACT: **Strongest extra objection.** Navya terminology is scholastic excess: it multiplies vocabulary without settling a single substantive dispute with Buddhism or Advaita. FACT: **Counter-reply.** True as a matter of exam volume, but it shows why Nyāya remained philosophically alive and analytically exact for centuries after its rivals had ceased to develop, and Śrīharṣa's dialectic is precisely what forced the school to sharpen its definitions.

ANALYSIS: **Source trail.** Gaṅgeśa, *Tattvacintāmaṇi*; B. K. Matilal, *Perception*; Karl Potter, *Encyclopedia of Indian Philosophies*.

ANALYSIS: **Answer use.** One sentence only, in evaluation: "The definitional pressure applied by Śrīharṣa is what drove Navya-Nyāya's refinement, so the later technicality is a response to criticism rather than an ornament."

2. Inherence as a relation-theory stress test

ANALYSIS: **The issue.** Does **inherence (samavāya)** explain inseparable relatedness, or merely name the problem of relation?

CAUTION: **The two readings.** Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika realism treats inherence as a unique, irreducible relation that is required wherever whole and parts, quality and substance, or universal and particular stand together. Buddhist and Advaita pressure holds that positing a special relation either invites regress or duplicates the very relatedness it was introduced to explain.

FACT: **Strongest extra objection.** If a relation must itself be related to its relata, regress follows without end. FACT: **Counter-reply.** Vaiśeṣika treats inherence as *sui generis* and non-relationally mediated - a **self-linking relation (svarūpa-sambandha)**. Critics find this primitive, but primitiveness is not obviously incoherence, since any relational ontology must terminate.

ANALYSIS: **Source trail.** Kaṇāda, *Vaiśeṣika-sūtra*; the Praśastapāda tradition; Chatterjee and Datta.

ANALYSIS: **Answer use.** Use only where a question presses the regress. The Basic block already supplies the core reply; the advanced addition is the observation that Nyāya's *selective* use of regress - as a weapon in the blockers of universalhood, as inadmissible against itself - is the sharper form of the charge.

3. Ultimate particularity as primitive "thisness"

ANALYSIS: **The issue.** Is **ultimate particularity (viśeṣa)** a necessary ontological differentiator of eternal reals, or an *ad hoc* entity added to save plurality?

CAUTION: **The two readings.** The realist reading holds that eternal atoms and selves need ultimate differentiators, since they share every universal and quality. Rival pressure from Buddhists and Advaitins holds that plurality may be conceptual or derivative rather than ontologically basic, so that no such entity is required.

FACT: **Strongest extra objection.** Particularity triggers a regress of differentiators. FACT: **Counter-reply.** The school stops the regress by treating particularity as **self-differentiating (svato-vyāvartaka)**: primitive particularity distinguishes both its locus and itself.

ANALYSIS: **Source trail.** Kaṇāda, *Vaiśeṣika-sūtra*; Udayana; S. Radhakrishnan, *Indian Philosophy*.

ANALYSIS: **Answer use.** Best deployed as a comparison line in an evaluative paragraph: the posit functions as a bare "thisness", and the school's willingness to name a primitive rather than derive one is what makes it simultaneously complete and contestable.

4. Udayana as a cumulative rational theist

ANALYSIS: **The issue.** Are the Nyāya proofs strongest **singly** or **cumulatively**, as a web of causal, teleological, moral and scriptural considerations?

CAUTION: **The two readings.** A narrow exam reading lists the proofs and evaluates each in isolation. A broader reading treats the *Nyāyakusumāñjali* as building mutually reinforcing realism and theism, so that the proofs are stages in the removal of successive objections rather than four independent demonstrations.

FACT: **Strongest extra objection.** Accumulation hides the weakness of each proof: four weak arguments do not make one strong argument. FACT: **Counter-reply.** Nyāya can answer that metaphysical explanation often proceeds cumulatively rather than through one demonstrative inference, and that the strands address *different* explananda - compositeness, initiation of first motion, continuing regulation and scriptural authority - so they are complementary rather than redundant.

ANALYSIS: **Source trail.** Udayana, *Nyāyakusumāñjali*; Gautama, *Nyāya-sūtra*; Chatterjee and Datta.

ANALYSIS: **Answer use.** One line in the evaluative paragraph of a twenty-marker on God: "Udayana's case is cumulative by design, so it is not defeated by refuting one strand - but a cumulative case is only as strong as the premiss all its strands share."

5. Controlled Western comparisons - one line at most, after the Indian argument is complete

Point of contact	Similarity	Disanalogy
ANALYSIS: Concomitance and Hume's problem of induction	ANALYSIS: Both notice that observed regularity does not by itself entail universal necessity.	FACT: Hume treats the belief as a habit of imagination; Nyāya claims warranted universal cognition through adjunct-elimination, hypothetical reasoning and universal-mediated perception, because universals are real.
ANALYSIS: Inherence and Bradley's regress	ANALYSIS: Both see that relations may require further relations and threaten regress.	FACT: Bradley moves toward the unreality of relations in an Absolute; Nyāya stops the regress by treating inherence as a self-linking relation.
ANALYSIS: The five-membered demonstration and the Aristotelian syllogism	ANALYSIS: Both offer patterns of valid reasoning.	FACT: Nyāya includes the example (udāharaṇa) as an essential empirical member and is primarily a schema of proof to another, not a purely formal validity calculus.
ANALYSIS: Nyāya universals and Platonic Forms	ANALYSIS: Both treat universals as real and shareable.	FACT: Nyāya universals inhere in particulars by inherence and have no separate transcendent realm; there is no Platonic <i>chorismos</i> .
ANALYSIS: Udayana and design or cosmological arguments	ANALYSIS: Both infer an intelligent first cause or ordering intelligence from effects and order.	FACT: Nyāya's God is efficient cause only, not creator of matter; atoms and selves are eternal, and God works with karma rather than creating from nothing.
ANALYSIS: Release and Epicurean freedom from disturbance	ANALYSIS: Both can define the goal as the absence of disturbance or suffering.	FACT: Nyāya's release may involve the absence of ordinary consciousness itself, which Western eudaimonism generally does not accept as the highest human good.

ANALYSIS: **Rubric.** Western parallels are illustrative only, never a substitute for the Indian argument. Use at most one or two lines, and only after the Nyāya case is complete.

6. What not to over-study

ANALYSIS: Full Navya symbolising habits; endless lists of later sub-fallacies; every later theistic proof variant; exhaustive subtypes of **quibble (chala)** or **ground of defeat (nigrahasthāna)**. Once the routed previous-year questions are answerable, additional taxonomy adds volume rather than marks.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Purpose. Twelve compressed retrieval parts covering every subtopic taught above. This is not a second introduction; it is what is revised the night before, and it preserves the Basic versus Optional-Advanced distinction throughout.

A. System identity and answer-worthiness

- **Nyāya** = science of valid knowing, inference, debate, fallacy, error-theory, natural theology; organised by **sixteen topics of inquiry**. Text: Gautama's *Nyāya-sūtra*.
- **Vaiśeṣika** = ontology of **seven categories** plus atomism; named after **ultimate particularity (viśeṣa)**. Text: Kaṇāda's *Vaiśeṣika-sūtra*.
- Textbook label: **similar systems (samānatāntara)**. CAUTION: Allied early, fused later - not identical from the start.
- Counts: **Nyāya 4** means of valid knowledge; **classical Vaiśeṣika 2**, reducing comparison and testimony to inference; the synthesis follows Nyāya.
- **Navya-Nyāya** (Gaṅgeśa) refines vocabulary; **Praśastapāda, Śrīdhara, Udayana** develop the theism. ANALYSIS: Kaṇāda's own text does not unambiguously foreground a creator.
- Purpose ladder: true knowledge → false notion removed → **defects (doṣa: attachment, aversion, delusion)** cease → activity ceases → birth ceases → suffering ceases → **release (apavarga)**.
- **Marks-essential:** both category systems, four instruments, perception and inference taxonomies, comparison and testimony, theory of error, self and release, God and proofs, causation, atomism, all 22 routed questions.

B. The two category systems

- **Sixteen topics (ṣoḍaśa-padārtha)** in four functional blocks: apparatus (means of valid knowledge, objects of valid knowledge); running an inquiry (doubt, purpose, accepted example, established doctrine, members, hypothetical reasoning, ascertainment); styles of dispute (truth-directed debate, victory-directed wrangling, destructive cavil); modes of failure (fallacious reason, quibble, futile rejoinder, ground of defeat).
- ANALYSIS: **Homonym trap:** *jāti* = futile rejoinder here; *jāti* = universal in Vaiśeṣika.
- **Twelve knowables (prameya):** self, body, senses, sense-objects, cognition, sensory mind, activity, defects, rebirth, fruit, suffering, release. A **soteriological sequence**, not an ontology.
- **Seven categories (padārtha):** substance, quality, motion, universal, ultimate particularity, inherence, absence. CAUTION: Kaṇāda's older list commonly taken as six, absence added later.
- ANALYSIS: **Never merge the sixteen and the seven.** Different questions, different ownership.
- **Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)** is topic 8 and an **aid to the instruments (pramāṇa-anugrahaka)**, never an instrument. Unacceptable-consequence forms: self-dependence, mutual dependence, circularity, infinite regress, contradiction of perception or inference.

C. Substance, quality and motion

- **Nine substances:** earth, water, fire, air (atomic); ether, time, direction (all-pervading, eternal, non-atomic); self; mind. ANALYSIS: Ether, time and direction *are* substances.
- **Twenty-four qualities** include colour, taste, smell, touch, number, magnitude, distinctness, conjunction, disjunction, priority, posteriority, cognition, pleasure, pain, desire, aversion, effort, heaviness, fluidity, viscosity, dispositional tendency, merit, demerit, sound.
- ANALYSIS: Cognition, pleasure, desire, **merit and demerit** are **qualities**, not the essence of the self and not a separate category.

- **Five motions:** upward, downward, contraction, expansion, locomotion. *Karma* here = physical motion, **not** moral karma.
- Motion -> **conjunction and disjunction** (themselves qualities) -> causation. **Mind is atomic** => one cognition at a time; deep sleep = withdrawal of conjunction.

D. Universal, its six blockers, and ultimate particularity

- **Universal (sāmānya / jāti):** real, eternal, one-in-many, present by **inherence**, not by spatial division; ordered as higher (*para*) and lower (*apara*).
- Argument: real classification of dissimilar individuals needs an objective ground; resemblance is always resemblance *in some respect*.
- **Six blockers (jāti-bādhaka):** no single instance (ether-ness) · co-extensiveness (pot-ness vs jar-ness) · cross-cutting (elemental-ness vs corporeal-ness) · infinite regress (universal-ness) · form-loss (a universal in particularities) · no available relation (inherence-ness). Blocked candidates become **imposed properties (upādhi)**.
- Buddhist rival: **exclusion (apoha)** - "cow" = "not non-cow". Nyāya reply: universals are perceived in determinate cognition; exclusion presupposes stable exclusion-classes.
- **Ultimate particularity (viśeṣa):** individuates **eternal** substances only - the atoms of the four elements, ether, time, direction, self, mind. Composites need none.
- Function: without it, exactly similar eternals collapse by the identity of indiscernibles. Reply to regress: **self-differentiating (svato-vyāvantaka)**. ANALYSIS: A stipulated terminus.

E. Inherence versus conjunction

- **Inherence (samavāya):** a **category**; eternal as a relation; **one**, not locally multiplied; imperceptible and inferred; holds where relata are **inseparable (ayutasiddha)**.
- **Five pairs:** whole-parts · quality-substance · motion-substance · universal-particular · particularity-eternal substance.
- **Conjunction (saṃyoga):** a **quality**; produced and destructible; separable relata. Book on table; two pots touching.
- ANALYSIS: Criterion = ontological inseparability, **not** closeness or physical grip.
- **2021 verdict:** inseparability is **necessary but not by itself sufficient**; alone it is **too wide (ativyāpti)** as a defining characteristic. Definitional faults to name: too narrow, too wide, impossible.
- Regress reply: **self-linking relation (svarūpa-sambandha)**. ANALYSIS: Critics: Nyāya uses regress against opponents while claiming immunity.
- Strongest pro-inherence argument: conjunction is a quality and must itself inhere, so conjunction **presupposes** inherence.

F. Absence and how it is known

- **Four kinds:** **prior (prāgabhāva)** - no beginning, ends at production; **posterior (pradhvaṃsābhāva)** - begins at destruction, no end; **absolute (atyantābhāva)** - neither, e.g. hare's horn; **mutual (anyonyābhāva)** - difference, "a pot is not a cloth".
- Structure: **locus (anuyogin) + counterpositive (pratiyogin)**. No counterpositive => no negation.
- **2023:** "absolute negation is an impossibility" denies **contentless** negation, **not** absolute absence.
- **2024:** heat-in-air = **absolute** (a quality denied of a locus); air/fire = **mutual** (an identity denied). Test: is the counterpositive a *quality* or another *entity*?
- **2018:** Nyāya perceives absence by the **qualifier-qualified relation**, the sixth contact. Four conditions: would-be-perceptible, locus available, senses competent, no obstruction. Buddhists explain the judgement away; **Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā** admits **non-cognition (anupalabdhi)** as an independent instrument.
- **2019 justification:** determinate negative cognition + realist semantics + explanatory work + parsimony, with CAUTION: the six/seven enumeration conceded.

G. Means of valid knowledge and perception

- **Four:** perception, inference, comparison, testimony. Nyāya reduces **postulation (arthāpatti)** to inference and **non-cognition** to perception or inference.
- **Gautama's definition:** produced from **sense-object contact** · **non-verbal** · **non-errant** · **determinate**.
- Exclusions in order: the other three instruments · testimony · illusion · doubt.
- **Indeterminate (nirvikalpaka)** -> **determinate (savikalpaka)**. CAUTION: Tension: the determinacy clause is read as excluding *doubt*, not the pre-predicative phase; critics say one word does two jobs.
- **Six contacts:** conjunction (substance) · inherence-in-conjoined (quality) · inherence-in-inherent-in-conjoined (universal in a quality) · inherence (sound) · inherence-in-inherent (sound-ness) · **qualifier-qualified (absence)**.
- **Three extraordinary (alaukika):** **universal-mediated** (induction) · **cognition-mediated** (error) · **yogic**.

H. Inference and the fallacies

- Terms: **subject (pakṣa)** · **property to be proved (sādhya)** · **reason (hetu / liṅga)** · **similar instance (sapakṣa)** · **dissimilar instance (vipakṣa)**.
- **Five members:** thesis · reason · **example** · application · conclusion. The example has no Aristotelian counterpart.
- **Immediate cause (kāraṇa)** of the conclusion = **subsumptive reflection (parāmarśa)**.
- **Three grids:** purpose (for oneself / for another) · direction (cause->effect, effect->cause, non-causal uniformity; ANALYSIS: *śeṣavat* has two readings) · concomitance (positive-only, negative-only, both).
- **Five marks:** in the subject · in similar instances · absent from dissimilar instances · uncontradicted · uncounterbalanced.
- **Five fallacies mapped:** irregular <-> dissimilar-instance absence (subtypes: too common, too restricted, over-wide) · unproved <-> presence in subject (subtypes: locus-unproved, form-unproved, pervasion-unproved) · stultified <-> uncontradicted · counterbalanced <-> uncounterbalanced · **contradictory** reverses concomitance itself.
- **Concomitance (vyāpti)** = **fixed (niyata)** and **unconditioned (anaupādhika)**; equal vs unequal extension.
- **Acquisition chain:** repeated observation -> non-observation of deviation -> **adjunct-elimination** -> hypothetical reasoning -> universal-mediated perception.
- **Adjunct formula:** *sādhya-vyāpakatve sati sādhana-avyāpakaḥ* - pervades the property, not the reason. Example: **wet fuel** defeats fire->smoke.
- Sceptic's self-refutation: a universal denial of inference is itself a universal claim.

I. Comparison, testimony, memory and validity

- **Comparison (upamāna):** description + resemblance -> **word-object relation**. Classical Vaiśeṣika reduces it to inference; Nyāya resists because the cognition is semantic.
- **Reliable person (āpta):** correct knowledge · truthful intention · competent expression. **Not** status or confidence.
- **Four sentence conditions:** mutual expectancy · semantic fitness · proximity · intended meaning (*saindhava* = salt or horse).
- Classifications: perceptible / imperceptible matter; secular / Vedic. Later Nyāya links Vedic authority to God as author. ANALYSIS: Keep the scriptural proof as a converging strand, not the foundation, to avoid circularity.
- **Memory** excluded for lack of **novelty**; **Prābhākara** excludes it for lack of **presentative** character. Same verdict, different ground.
- **Validity: extrinsic for BOTH** validity and invalidity. Mīmāṃsā: intrinsic validity, extrinsic invalidity. Confirmation via successful activity, coherence, corroboration.
- **Instrument (pramāṇa) ≠ fruit (pramāṇaphala)** for Nyāya, because realism separates the reaching from what reaches; **Dignāga** tightens them within a self-luminous framework.

J. Error, self and release

- **Misplacement (anyathākhyāti)**: both terms real; falsity lies in the **relation**. Mechanism: present base -> revived impression -> **cognition-mediated perception** -> non-discrimination -> "this is silver" -> **sublation** "this is *not* silver".
- **Five theories**: Nyāya misplacement · Yogācāra self-apprehension · Mādhyamika apprehension of the non-existent (standard doxography) · Prābhākara non-apprehension of difference · Advaita the indefinable.
- **2021 reply to Advaita**: a third ontological status is obscure and uneconomical; ANALYSIS: Advaita answers from sublation plus motivation.
- **Self (ātman)**: eternal, all-pervading, **many**; consciousness is an **adventitious quality**; **mind (manas)** is atomic.
- **Six marks (2024)**: desire · aversion · effort · pleasure · pain · cognition. ANALYSIS: Memory, recognition and the instrument-user argument are **supplementary**.
- **Release (apavarga)** = **absolute cessation of pain**, not bliss. Liberated self has no pleasure, pain, desire, aversion or ordinary cognition.
- **Stone-like objection** answered by "freedom from suffering, not acquisition of bliss"; bliss would be relational and attachment-generating. ANALYSIS: Motivational cost survives.

K. God, causation and atomism

- **God (Īśvara)**: eternal, omniscient, bodiless special self; **efficient cause only**; never bound by karma; orders atoms, dispenses fruits, sources the Veda.
- **Four proofs**: from effect · from combination · from sustenance · from scripture. Also from words, cognition, sentences, numerical modes; plus the moral-administration strand.
- **Cumulative structure**: successive obstacle-removal in the *Nyāyakusumāñjali*. CAUTION: Names and counts vary - write "commonly enumerated as".
- **Objections**: Mīmāṃsā authorless Veda · Sāṃkhya no motive · Buddhist **disanalogy (vaiṣamya)** of the pot-potter · Cārvāka anti-inference · Advaita two levels · problem of evil answered by beginningless karma at the cost of divine independence.
- **2018**: Yoga's God is a **special conscious witness (puruṣa-viśeṣa)** and object of **devotion (Īśvara-praṇidhāna)**, admitted rather than inferred. Reasoned **no**.
- **Causation**: effect newly produced (**asatkāryavāda / ārambhavāda**). Cause = **unconditional invariable antecedent, not otherwise established**. Complete cause = **causal complex** + absence of blocker.
- **Excluded antecedents**: staff-colour · potter's father · staff-sound · space · donkey - five kinds of irrelevance.
- **Three causes**: inherent (substance) · non-inherent (quality/conjunction) · efficient (agent).
- **2021 seed/tree**: no; specificity comes from invariability, not latency. **2023 prior absence** ends at production - the anti-Sāṃkhya weapon, which presupposes real absences.
- **Atomism**: atoms eternal, partless, imperceptible, minute (*parimāṇḍalya*); **2 atoms -> dyad**; **3 dyads -> triad**, first perceptible magnitude; first motion needs **unseen moral force (adr̥ṣṭa)** + divine will; atoms persist through dissolution.

L. Final answer discipline

- **Three stipulated termini**: inherence (self-linking) · particularity (self-differentiating) · universal-mediated perception. All criticism converges here.
- **Strong**: inference theory; the reply to inductive scepticism; a *regulated* ontology; cumulative natural theology.
- **Weak**: the termini; unconscious release; God limited by beginningless karma; apparent proliferation.
- **Contested CAUTION::** universal-mediated perception as genuine perception; one system or two; the pot-potter analogy.
- **Cross-school anchors**: extrinsic validity both ways · misplacement error · real universals against exclusion · new production against pre-existence · efficient-cause God against Mīmāṃsā and Sāṃkhya · enduring self against no-self · release as cessation against blissful liberation.

- ## COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/15: System identity, division of labour and the liberation ladder

NYAYA (Gautama, Nyaya-sutra) science of valid knowing 16 TOPICS OF INQUIRY owns: means of valid knowledge inference, debate, fallacy, theory of error, theology 4 instruments	VAISESIKA (Kanada, Vaisesika-sutra) ontology of what there is 7 CATEGORIES OF BEING owns: substance, quality, motion, universal, particularity, inherence, absence, atomism 2 instruments (comparison + testimony reduced to inference)
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THE LADDER THAT MAKES IT ONE SYSTEM
true knowledge of reality (tattva-jnana)
-> false notion removed (mithya-jnana)
-> defects cease (dosa: raga, dvesa, moha)
-> activity ceases (pravritti) -> birth ceases (janma)
-> suffering ceases (duhkha) -> RELEASE (apavarga)

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ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/15: Sixteen topics of inquiry and twelve knowables

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/15: Sixteen topics of inquiry and twelve knowables

NYAYA 16 = ANATOMY OF A DISPUTE, NOT AN INVENTORY OF BEING

BLOCK I APPARATUS

1 means of valid knowledge (pramana) 2 objects of valid knowledge (prameya)

BLOCK II RUNNING AN INQUIRY FROM DOUBT TO VERDICT

3 doubt (samsaya) 4 purpose (prayojana) 5 accepted example (drstanta)

6 established doctrine (siddhanta) 7 members of demonstration (avayava)

8 hypothetical reasoning (tarka) 9 ascertainment (nirnaya)

BLOCK III THREE STYLES OF DISPUTE

10 truth-directed debate (vada) | 11 victory-directed wrangling (jalpa)

12 destructive cavil (vitanda)

BLOCK IV FOUR MODES OF FAILURE

13 fallacious reason (hetvabhasa) 14 quibble (chala)

15 futile rejoinder (jati) 16 ground of defeat (nigrahasthana)

! HOMONYM TRAP: jati = futile rejoinder HERE; jati = universal in Vaisesika.

|

v

TOPIC 2 OPENS INTO 12 KNOWABLES – A SOTERIOLOGICAL SEQUENCE, NOT AN ONTOLOGY

self -> body -> senses -> sense-objects -> cognition -> sensory mind (manas)

-> activity -> defects -> rebirth -> fruit -> suffering -> release

Vaisesika's categories fall WITHIN this field of knowables but keep their own ownership and structure.

! NEVER MERGE 16 + 7 INTO ONE LIST OF 23.

tarka = AID to the instruments (pramana-anugrahaka), never an instrument.

its unacceptable-consequence forms: self-dependence (atmasraya), mutual

dependence (anyonyasraya), circularity (cakraka), infinite regress

(anavastha), contradiction of perception or inference.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/15: Seven categories - substance, quality, motion

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CATEGORY (padartha) = "the meaning of a word" = whatever is nameable and knowable

1 SUBSTANCE (dravya) 2 QUALITY (guna) 3 MOTION (karma)

4 UNIVERSAL (samanya) 5 ULTIMATE PARTICULARITY (visesa)

6 INHERENCE (samavaya) 7 ABSENCE (abhava)

? Kanada's older list is commonly taken as SIX, absence added later as seventh.

NINE SUBSTANCES, SORTED BY THE TESTS EXAMINERS USE

ATOMIC + build the gross world : earth (prthivi) | water (ap) | fire (tejas)

| air (vayu)

ALL-PERVADING, ETERNAL, ONE : ether (akasa, substrate of sound)

| time (kala) | direction (dik)

KNOWER AND ITS INSTRUMENT : self (atman) eternal, all-pervading, MANY

| mind (manas) eternal, ATOMIC, one per self

! TRAP: ether, time and direction ARE substances, not abstract frameworks.

! mind atomic => ONE cognition at a time; deep sleep = conjunction withdrawn.

TWENTY-FOUR QUALITIES (guna) – dependent, inhere in substance

colour | taste | smell | touch | number | magnitude | distinctness

conjunction | disjunction | priority | posteriority | cognition | pleasure

pain | desire | aversion | effort | heaviness | fluidity | viscosity

dispositional tendency (samskara) | merit (dharma) | demerit (adharma) | sound

! cognition, pleasure, desire, merit, demerit are QUALITIES OF THE SELF,

not its essence and not a separate category.

FIVE MOTIONS (karma) = PHYSICAL, not moral karma

upward | downward | contraction | expansion | locomotion

motion -> CONJUNCTION and DISJUNCTION (themselves qualities) -> CAUSATION

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/15: Universal, six blockers, ultimate particularity

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/15: Universal, six blockers, ultimate particularity
TWO OPPOSITE PUZZLES, ONE ONTOLOGY

SAMENESS: black cow + white calf are both "cow" -> UNIVERSAL (samanya/jati)
DIFFERENCE: two atoms alike in every respect are TWO -> PARTICULARITY (visesa)
UNIVERSAL: real, eternal, ONE-IN-MANY, present by INHERENCE (not spatial split)
ordered higher (para) / lower (apara) by extension
ARGUMENT: real classification needs an objective ground; resemblance is always
resemblance IN SOME RESPECT -> presupposes realist semantics
RIVAL: Buddhist EXCLUSION (apoha) – "cow" = "not non-cow" (Dignaga/Dharmakirti)
REPLY: universals ARE presented in determinate (savikalpaka) perception;
exclusion presupposes stable exclusion-classes
SIX BLOCKERS OF UNIVERSALHOOD (jati-badhaka) = SIX REFUSAL TESTS
1 no single instance (vyakter abhedah) ether-ness blocked
2 co-extensiveness (tulyatvam) pot-ness vs jar-ness
3 cross-cutting (sankarah) elemental-ness vs corporeal-ness
4 infinite regress (anavastha) universal-ness blocked
5 form-loss (rupahanih) a universal in particularities
6 no available relation (asambandhah) inherence-ness blocked
BLOCKED CANDIDATE -> survives only as IMPOSED PROPERTY (upadhi), not a category
=> the realism is REGULATED; this answers the charge of ontological excess
ULTIMATE PARTICULARITY (visesa): individuates ETERNAL substances only
atoms of the four elements + ether, time, direction, self, mind
composites need none (parts, qualities, place, causal history individuate them)
WITHOUT IT: exactly similar eternal collapse by identity of indiscernibles
OBJ regress of differentiators -> REPLY self-differentiating (svato-vyavartaka)
OBJ imperceptible IOU -> REPLY posited INFERENTIALLY (Nyaya reduces postulation
(arthapatti) to inference, so no smuggled fifth instrument)
! RESIDUE: "self-differentiating" NAMES the terminus, does not prove it.
Srihasa's Khandanakhandakhadya attacks Nyaya definitions systematically.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/15: Inherence versus conjunction - the table test

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/15: Inherence versus conjunction – the table test
2018 Q5(a): (i) the BROWN COLOUR of the table (ii) the BOOK on the table
(i) remove the colour -> no table of that kind => INSEPARABLE (ayutasiddha)
(ii) remove the book -> table survives => SEPARABLE (yutasiddha)
CRITERION = ONTOLOGICAL INSEPARABILITY, NOT closeness or physical grip

FEATURE	INHERENCE (samavaya)	CONJUNCTION (samyoga)
ontological rank	a CATEGORY in its own right	a QUALITY (one of 24)
relata	inseparable	separable
production	eternal as a relation	produced + destructible
number	ONE, not locally multiplied	many, one per contact
access	imperceptible, inferred	effects evident
example	colour in cloth; whole in parts	book on table; two pots in contact

FIVE INHERENCE PAIRS

whole <- parts | quality <- substance | motion <- substance
universal <- particular | particularity <- eternal substance
2021 Q5(c) VERDICT: inseparability (ayuta-siddhatva) is NECESSARY but NOT BY
ITSELF SUFFICIENT as a defining characteristic (laksana).
definitional faults to name: too narrow (avyapti) | too wide (ativyapti)
| impossible (asambhava). Inseparability alone risks being TOO WIDE.
safe formula = inseparability + the specific ontological dependence of the
dependent term on its locus.

OBJ relation-regress (anavastha) -> REPLY self-linking relation
(svarupa-sambandha); relates by its own nature, needs no further relator
! RESIDUE: a stipulated terminus; critics note Nyaya uses regress as a weapon
(blocker 4) while claiming immunity here.

ONE OR MANY? one and eternal, for parsimony. Difficulty: why does one relation
tie THIS quality to THIS substance? Reply: the relata determine its operation.
STRONGEST PRO-INHERENCE ARGUMENT: conjunction is itself a QUALITY and must
inhere, so conjunction PRESUPPOSES inherence and cannot replace it.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/15: Absence - four kinds, structure, cognition

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/15: Absence – four kinds, structure, cognition
STRUCTURE OF EVERY ABSENCE: LOCUS (anuyogin) qualified by the absence OF a
COUNTERPOSITIVE (pratiyogin). No counterpositive => no negation.
FOUR KINDS AND THEIR EXACT TEMPORAL SIGNATURES
PRIOR (pragabhava) NO BEGINNING, HAS AN END (ends at production)
POSTERIOR (pradhvamsa-) .. HAS A BEGINNING, NO END (begins at destruction)
ABSOLUTE (atyantabhava) .. NEITHER BEGINNING NOR END – hare's horn
MUTUAL (anyonyabhava) DIFFERENCE, not temporal – "a pot is not a cloth"
2023 Q5(d) DECODE THE PRINTED STATEMENT IN TWO CLAUSES
"negation always has a counterpositive" -> negation has determinate content
"absolute negation is an impossibility" -> CONTENTLESS negation is impossible
! THIS DOES NOT DENY ABSOLUTE ABSENCE (atyantabhava), an admitted kind.
2024 Q5(c) THE DISCRIMINATION, DRAWN
"AIR DOES NOT HAVE HEAT" locus air | counterpositive HEAT = a QUALITY
-> denies a QUALIFICATION -> ABSOLUTE ABSENCE
"AIR IS NOT FIRE" locus air | counterpositive FIRE = a SUBSTANCE
-> denies an IDENTITY -> MUTUAL ABSENCE
TEST: is the missing item a QUALITY that could qualify the locus (absolute)
or ANOTHER ENTITY the locus might be identified with (mutual)?
2018 Q5(d) HOW ABSENCE IS KNOWN – THREE POSITIONS
NYAYA : perceived through the QUALIFIER-QUALIFIED relation
(visesana-visesya-bhava), the SIXTH sense-object contact.
4 conditions: object would be perceptible if present | locus
available | senses competent | no obstruction.
If the missing item is inferential, its absence is inferred.
NO independent instrument of non-cognition is admitted.
BUDDHIST : no separate negative entity; positive locus + non-apprehension,
conceptual exclusion or inference
BHATTA MIMAMSA : NON-COGNITION (anupalabdhi) as an INDEPENDENT instrument
=> the disagreement is ONTOLOGICAL before it is EPISTEMOLOGICAL
2019 Q5(a) JUSTIFICATION IN FOUR STEPS
determinate negative cognition -> realist semantics -> explanatory work
(prior absence defeats the pre-existent effect) -> economy (one category,
four kinds, no new instrument). ? concede the six/seven enumeration.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/15: Four instruments and Gautama's definition

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/15: Four instruments and Gautama's definition
FOUR MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramana) – each covers the previous one's limit
PERCEPTION (pratyaksa) ... gives the object itself, directly
INFERENCE (anumana) reaches what is out of sensory range
COMPARISON (upamana) fixes the word-object link
TESTIMONY (sabda) reaches what no individual could verify
COUNT CAUTION: 4 = NYAYA. classical Vaisesika = 2. synthesis follows Nyaya.
NYAYA REDUCES: postulation (arthapatti) -> inference;
non-cognition (anupalabdhi) -> perception or inference.
NOT instruments: MEMORY (reproductive) | TARKA (aid only)
GAUTAMA'S DEFINITION (2025 Q6(a)) AS FOUR EXCLUSION GATES
indriyārtha-sannikarsa-utpannam jñanam avyapadesyam avyabhicari
vyavasayatmakam pratyaksam
GATE 1 produced from SENSE-OBJECT CONTACT -> EXCLUDES inference, memory,
testimony; marks perception as the foundational instrument
GATE 2 NON-VERBAL (avyapadesya) EXCLUDES testimony
! does NOT mean inexpressible; determinate perception is expressible
GATE 3 NON-ERRANT (avyabhicari) EXCLUDES illusion (shell-silver)
=> creates the DEBT that the theory of error must discharge
GATE 4 DETERMINATE (vyavasayatmaka) EXCLUDES doubt ("post or man?")
? tension with the admitted INDETERMINATE (nirvikalpaka) phase.
standard reading: the clause excludes DOUBT, not the pre-predicative
stage. critics: one word doing two jobs.
INDETERMINATE (nirvikalpaka) -> DETERMINATE (savikalpaka) "this is a blue pot"
the determinate stage is where the UNIVERSAL appears as qualifier => this is
the epistemology behind realism about universals.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/15: Six contacts and three extraordinary perceptions

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SIX SENSE-OBJECT CONTACTS (sannikarsa) – EACH REACHES A DIFFERENT OBJECT

- 1 conjunction (samyoga) a SUBSTANCE: the pot
 - 2 inherence-in-conjoined its QUALITY or MOTION: its colour (samyukta-samavaya)
 - 3 inherence-in-inherent-in-conjoined the UNIVERSAL in that quality: (samyukta-samaveta-samavaya) colour-ness
 - 4 inherence (samavaya) SOUND, inhering in ether
 - 5 inherence-in-inherent (samaveta-samavaya) SOUND-NESS
 - 6 qualifier-qualified (visesana-visesya) ABSENCE: jar-absence on the table
- => 3 and 5 carry "universals are perceived"; 6 carries absence-cognition

THREE EXTRAORDINARY PERCEPTIONS (alaukika) – TWO ARE LOAD-BEARING

UNIVERSAL-MEDIATED (samanyalaksana-pratyaksa)

perceiving an instance of smokiness relates the knower to SMOKE AS SUCH

-> the specifically Nyaya solution to INDUCTION (see Panel 10)

COGNITION-MEDIATED (jñanalaksana-pratyaksa)

a prior cognition mediates present perception; sandalwood "seen" as fragrant

-> the mechanism of the THEORY OF ERROR (see Panel 11)

YOGIC (yogaja-pratyaksa)

subtle, distant, past or future objects, for the perfected practitioner

2023 Q6(c) ARE UNIVERSALS PERCEIVED? – THREE MOVES

FOR : determinate perception presents the object AS QUALIFIED by a universal; contacts 3 and 5 exist to reach universals; without perceptible kinds, classification and concomitance lose their base

AGAINST: ? universal-mediated perception may be ad hoc; exclusion (apoha) explains classification without a perceived one-in-many; an object not in present contact strains the definition of perception

VERDICT: justified WITHIN Nyaya's realist ontology; not justified for an opponent who has refused it => metaphysical before perceptual

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/15: Inference engine - members, grids, five marks

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TERMS: subject (paksa) = this hill | property to be proved (sadhya) = fire

reason (hetu/linga) = smoke | similar instance (sapaksa) = kitchen

dissimilar instance (vipaksa) = lake

FIVE MEMBERS (pancavayava) – THE PUBLIC FORM OF ONE REFLECTION

- 1 THESIS (pratijna) "the hill has fire" states the claim
- 2 REASON (hetu) "because it has smoke" names the sign
- 3 EXAMPLE (udaharana) "wherever smoke, fire – states the RULE + an as in a kitchen" AGREED INSTANCE <<<<
- 4 APPLICATION (upanaya) .. "this hill has such smoke" brings subject under it
- 5 CONCLUSION (nigamana) .. "therefore the hill has fire" now ESTABLISHED

<<<< member 3 has NO Aristotelian counterpart: Nyaya proves to a PERSON, it does not test the form of a sentence.

members 3+4 = public form of SUBSUMPTIVE REFLECTION (paramarsa):

"this hill possesses smoke which is pervaded by fire" = IMMEDIATE CAUSE

(karana) of the inferential cognition.

! redundancy objection: fewer members suffice for a trained hearer.

reply: the demonstration is a PUBLIC EPISTEMIC ACT, not a minimal derivation.

THREE CLASSIFICATION GRIDS – SAY WHICH ONE YOU ARE USING

by PURPOSE : for oneself (svarthanumana) | for another (pararthanumana)

by DIRECTION : cause->effect (purvavat, clouds to rain)
effect->cause (sesavat, swollen river to past rain)
non-causal uniformity (samanyatodrsta, celestial position)
! sesavat also read as RESIDUAL inference (parisesa)

by CONCOMITANCE : positive-only (kevalanvayi) | negative-only (kevalavyatireki)
| positive-and-negative (anvayavyatireki)

FIVE MARKS OF A VALID REASON

- 1 presence in the subject (paksadharmata)
- 2 presence in similar instances (sapaksa-sattva)
- 3 absence from dissimilar instances (vipaksa-asattva)
- 4 not contradicted (abadhita) 5 not counterbalanced (asatpratipaksa)

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/15: Securing concomitance and the five fallacies

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CONCOMITANCE (vyapti) = FIXED (niyata) + UNCONDITIONED (anaupadhika)

= invariable non-deviation (avinabhava-niyama). NOT mere frequency.

equal extension (samavyapti) = convertible

unequal extension (visamavyapti) = all smoke pervaded by fire, not conversely

ACQUISITION CHAIN – EACH STEP FIXES THE PREVIOUS STEP'S GAP (2022 Q7(c))

1 REPEATED OBSERVATION (bhuyodarsana): co-presence (anvaya) + co-absence (vyatireka) GAP: a finite sample stays finite

2 NON-OBSERVATION OF DEVIATION (vyabhicara-adarsana): search and fail to find a counter-case GAP: a hidden condition may still act

3 ADJUNCT-ELIMINATION (upadhi-nirasa)

FORMULA: sadhya-vyapakatve sati sadhana-avyapakah

= PERVADES the property to be proved, does NOT pervade the reason

WORKED CASE: bad inference "hill has smoke BECAUSE fire".

WET FUEL (ardra-indhana): wherever SMOKE, wet fuel -> pervades sadhya

not wherever FIRE, wet fuel -> not the hetu

=> fire does not unconditionally pervade smoke; the inference fails

plus removal of the SUSPICION of an adjunct (upadhi-sanka-nivrtti)

GAP: a residual "but what if?"

4 HYPOTHETICAL REASONING (tarka): contrary supposition -> unacceptable

consequence. STATUS: AID ONLY => the reply is NOT circular

5 UNIVERSAL-MEDIATED PERCEPTION: the KIND is grasped, not the sample

! RESIDUE: the whole reply presupposes REALISM ABOUT UNIVERSALS.

! COUNTER-ATTACK: a universal denial of inference is itself a universal claim

(svavacana-virodha); the Carvaka's own hidden-adjunct argument is inferential

FIVE FALLACIES (hetvabhasa) MAPPED ONTO THE FIVE MARKS (2023 Q7(a))

IRREGULAR (savyabhicara/anaikantika) -> violates MARK 3

sadharana (in both classes) | asadharana (confined to the subject)

| anupasamharin (too wide for contrast)

UNPROVED (asiddha/sadhyasama) -----> violates MARK 1

asrayasiddha (unreal locus) | svarupasiddha (reason absent in subject)

| vyapyatvasiddha (pervasion unproved, typically an adjunct)

STULTIFIED (badhita/kalatita) -----> violates MARK 4 (fire inferred as cold)

COUNTERBALANCED (satpratipaksa/prakaranasama) -> violates MARK 5

CONTRADICTIONARY (viruddha) -----> REVERSES CONCOMITANCE ITSELF

proves the opposite of the intended property (permanence -> impermanence)

! exactly five conditions => exactly five modes of failure, one of which

operates on the relation rather than on a condition.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/15: Comparison, testimony, memory, validity, fruit

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/15: Comparison, testimony, memory, validity, fruit
COMPARISON (upamana) IN FOUR BEATS – 2021-style semantic acquisition

- 1 forester says "a gavaya is like a cow" -> TESTIMONY gives a DESCRIPTION
- 2 you see such an animal -> PERCEPTION gives an OBJECT
- 3 you recall the description -> MEMORY reproduces
- 4 "THIS is what the word 'gavaya' denotes" -> COMPARISON: the WORD-OBJECT
RELATION, a new cognition

! not analogical argument. classical Vaisesika folds it into inference;

Nyaya resists because instruments are individuated by the KIND of cognition.

TESTIMONY (sabda) – 2021 Q5(b): THREE LIMBS ARE REQUIRED

SPEAKER: a reliable person (apta) = correct knowledge + truthful intention
+ competent expression. NOT status, NOT confidence.

SENTENCE: mutual expectancy (akanksa) | semantic fitness (yogyata)
| proximity (sannidhi/asatti) | intended meaning (tatparya)

example: "bring the saindhava" = salt at dinner, horse before a ride

RESULT: cognition of the word-object relation, hence of the object

CLASSES: perceptible (drstārtha) / imperceptible (adrstārtha);
secular (laukika) / Vedic (vaidika)

! Vedic authority linked in later Nyaya to GOD as omniscient author.

keep the scriptural proof a CONVERGING strand, not the foundation

-> otherwise circular (Veda proves God, God certifies Veda).

MEMORY (smṛti) EXCLUDED – TWO DIFFERENT GROUNDS, ONE VERDICT (2024 comparative)

NYAYA : lacks NOVELTY – reproduces, generates nothing new

PRABHAKARA : lacks PRESENTATIVE character – depends on a residual impression

VALIDITY (2025 comparative)

+-----+-----+-----+-----+			
SCHOOL	VALIDITY	INVALIDITY	
NYAYA	EXTRINSIC (paratah)	EXTRINSIC (paratah)	
MIMAMSA	INTRINSIC (svatah)	extrinsic	
+-----+-----+-----+-----+			

! TRAP: "Nyaya is extrinsic for invalidity" is only HALF the position.

reason: truth depends on defect-free generating conditions, to which the
knower has no internal access -> successful activity, coherence, corroboration

INSTRUMENT vs FRUIT (2025 Q5(b))

NYAYA : knower (pramātr) | instrument (pramāna) | object (prameya)
| fruit (pramāṇaphala/pramīti) – FOUR DISTINCT FACTORS.

realism separates the reaching from what reaches (axe vs splitting)

BUDDHIST : Dignāga tightens them; cognition is both act and result in a
self-luminous framework; a distinct instrument would be an
unperceived second entity

=> the difference FOLLOWS FROM the opposed ontologies; it is not terminological

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/15: Error, self, mind and release

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/15: Error, self, mind and release
MISPLACEMENT THEORY OF ERROR (anyathakhyati) – SHELL-SILVER, STEP BY STEP
real shell present + real silver existing ELSEWHERE
-> glitter revives a past impression of silver
-> COGNITION-MEDIATED PERCEPTION (jnanalaksana-pratyaksa) makes the silver
PRESENT TO AWARENESS without physical presence <- 2019 Q6(b) answer
-> NON-DISCRIMINATION fails to notice they are two
-> FALSE COGNITION "this is silver"
-> SUBLATION (badha): "this is NOT silver" – DENIES THE RELATION, not an
entity => realism survives; NOTHING UNREAL WAS EVER PERCEIVED
FIVE THEORIES OF ERROR, ORDERED BY ONTOLOGICAL COST
akhyati (Prabhakara Mimamsa) ... two valid cognitions undiscriminated; there
is NO false cognition at all [cheapest]
anyathakhyati (NYAYA) two reals, one bad relation
atmakhyati (Yogacara) internal cognition projected outward
anirvacaniya-khyati (Advaita) .. object NEITHER real NOR unreal
asatkhyati (Madhyamika, standard doxography) apprehension of the non-existent
2021 ROUTED REPLY: a third ontological status is obscure and uneconomical.
! Advaita counters: the silver is sublated (so not real) yet motivating
(so not unreal). Nyaya answers both facts with location, not status.
! Nyaya vs Prabhakara: "this is NOT silver" denies something ASSERTED, so a
theory with no false cognition cannot explain the corrective form.
SELF (atman): eternal, ALL-PERVADING, MANY substances
consciousness is an ADVENTITIOUS QUALITY, not the self's essence (vs ADVAITA)
SIX MARKS (2024 Q5(b)) – iccha-dvesa-prayatna-sukha-duhkha-jnanani atmano
lingam: 1 desire 2 aversion 3 effort 4 pleasure 5 pain 6 cognition
6 is structurally different: cognition is a QUALITY, so it needs a SUBSTANCE
! SUPPLEMENTARY ONLY: memory/recognition; the instrument-user argument.
NEVER substitute them when "six reasons" is asked.
form: a NEGATIVE-ONLY (kevalavyatireki) inference – no independent
similar instance of a self is available
MIND (manas): eternal, ATOMIC, one per self => one cognition at a time;
deep sleep = mind withdrawn from conjunction, self persists uncognising
RELEASE (apavarga) = ABSOLUTE CESSATION OF PAIN (duhkha-atyanta-nivrtti)
NOT bliss. liberated self has no pleasure, pain, desire, aversion, cognition
STONE-LIKE OBJECTION -> REPLY: the aim is freedom FROM suffering, not the
acquisition of bliss; bliss is relational and can generate attachment
! RESIDUE: a motivational cost survives – a goal no one can desire AS a state

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 13/15: God and Udayana's cumulative case

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/15: God and Udayana's cumulative case
GOD (Isvara): eternal, omniscient, BODILESS special self, never bound by karma
EFFICIENT CAUSE (nimitta-karana) ONLY – atoms remain the MATERIAL cause
THREE JOBS: cosmic (conjoins atoms, working WITH the unseen moral force adrsta) | moral (allots karmic fruit) | scriptural (source of the Veda)
UDAYANA'S PROOFS AS INFERENCES (2019 Q7(a)) – SUBJECT | REASON | PROPERTY
FROM EFFECT (karyat) the world | composite and ordered, hence an effect | has an intelligent maker | pot & potter
FROM COMBINATION (ayojanat) primordial atomic conjunction | inert atoms and unconscious adrsta cannot start ordered FIRST motion | needs an intelligent impeller
FROM SUSTENANCE (dhrtyadeh) the ordered cosmos | sustained, regulated, dissolved | needs governing intelligence
FROM SCRIPTURE (sruteh) ... Vedic sentences | require competent authorship, scope exceeds ordinary knowledge | omniscient source
ALSO: padat (words) | pratyayatah (cognition) | vakyat (sentences) | sankhyavisesat (numerical modes) | moral-administration strand
STRUCTURE: successive OBSTACLE-REMOVAL in the Nyayakusumanjali => a CUMULATIVE case. ? names and counts vary: write "commonly enumerated as".
OBJECTIONS -> REPLIES -> RESIDUE
Mimamsa: authorless Veda + apurva -> omniscient apta explains better | residue: grant authorlessness and the scriptural proof weakens
Samkhya: prakrti suffices, a perfect God has no motive -> unconscious prakrti cannot allot karma | residue: the motive problem survives
Buddhist: DISANALOGY (vaisamya) – a potter has a body, hands, materials -> embodiment is not essential to agency | residue: analogy strained
Carvaka: God unperceived, inference unreliable -> secure inference first
Advaita: God is only empirical (vyavaharika) -> reject the two-level downgrade
EVIL: fruits follow BEGINNINGLESS KARMA | residue: divine independence limited
! ALL objections land on ONE shared premiss: order and meaning require intelligence rather than being brute or emergent.
2018 Q6(a) NYAYA vs YOGA – REASONED "NO"
NYAYA: God INFERRED as the explanation of cosmic and moral order
YOGA : a SPECIAL CONSCIOUS WITNESS (purusa-visesa) untouched by afflictions, actions, fruits, deposits; ADMITTED within an existing soteriology; role is practical – devotion (Isvara-pranidhana) aids absorption
=> sameness of NAME is not sameness of DEMONSTRATION or FUNCTION

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 14/15: Causation and atomism

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 14/15: Causation and atomism
CAUSATION: asatkaryavada / arambhavada – the effect is NEWLY PRODUCED
CAUSE = UNCONDITIONAL INVARIABLE ANTECEDENT: prior (purvavrtti), invariably prior (niyata-purvavrtti), NOT OTHERWISE ESTABLISHED (ananyathasiddha)
complete cause = causal complex (karana-samagri) + absence of a blocker
EXCLUDED (anyathasiddha) – 2020 Q6(c), five KINDS of irrelevance:
| staff-colour (quality of an instrument) | potter's father (remote)
| staff-sound (co-effect) | space (omnipresent background)
| donkey (accidental companion)
THREE CAUSES: inherent (samavayi) threads | non-inherent (asamavayi) their conjunction, a quality | efficient (nimitta) the weaver
2021 SEED/TREE: NO. specificity comes from INVARIABILITY, not latency.
2023 PRIOR ABSENCE: a real absence cannot coexist with a latent presence
! residue: presupposes real absences, which Samkhya need not grant
ATOMISM: atom (paramanu) eternal, partless, indivisible, imperceptible, minute (parimandalya). 2 atoms -> DYAD (dvyanuka, imperceptible)
3 DYADS -> TRIAD (tryanuka/trasarenu) = FIRST PERCEPTIBLE MAGNITUDE
! NOT three atoms. mote in a sunbeam is the standard illustration.
first motion at creation needs adrsta + divine will; cycles of creation (srsti) and dissolution (pralaya); ATOMS PERSIST THROUGH DISSOLUTION
=> atomism's own gap is what makes the school theistic

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 15/15: Verdict grid, cross-school anchors, answer rail

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THREE STIPULATED TERMINI – ALL CRITICISM CONVERGES HERE

inherence = self-linking (svarupa-sambandha)

particularity = self-differentiating (svato-vyavartaka)

universal-mediated perception = the kind is perceptually given

GRADED VERDICT

STRONG : the most developed Indian theory of inference, debate and fallacy
| a serious realist reply to inductive scepticism
| a REGULATED ontology (six blockers, reduction of instruments)
| the most rigorous Indian cumulative natural theology

WEAK : the three termini are asserted where explanation stops
| release without consciousness invites the stone-like objection
| God's independence limited by beginningless karma
| absence + inherence + particularity look like proliferation

CONTESTED? : universal-mediated perception as genuine perception
| one system or two
| whether an embodied-artisan analogy can prove a bodiless maker

CROSS-SCHOOL ANCHORS – ONE ROW PER RIVAL

vs CARVAKA : inference defended by adjunct-elimination + tarka + real kinds

vs BUDDHISM : real universals vs exclusion (apoha) | enduring self vs no-self
| real wholes vs aggregate reduction | instrument ≠ fruit

vs JAINISM : determinate categories vs non-absolutism and standpoints

vs SAMKHYA : new production vs pre-existent effect | God vs no creator

vs MIMAMSA : extrinsic validity vs intrinsic | authored vs authorless Veda
| Nyaya reduces postulation and non-cognition; Mimamsa does not

vs ADVAITA : misplacement vs the indefinable | consciousness as quality vs
as nature | many selves vs one | release as cessation vs bliss

vs YOGA : God inferred as cosmic cause vs admitted as meditative support

ANSWER RAIL – WHAT TO WRITE, IN ORDER

1 name the half of the system the question sits in (Nyaya / Vaishesika / joint)

2 define technically, with the English concept first and IAST immediately after

3 give the classification or the argument, with named evidence

4 add ONE named opponent and the reply

5 close: STRENGTH + COST + CONDITION, matched to the directive

CLOSING LINES BY MARK

10 : "strongest as a realist logic-ontology, but its primitive relations and
particularisers remain vulnerable."

15 : "the instruments secure knowledge, the categories secure being and God
secures order; inherence, particularity and unconscious release are
asserted as much as proved."

20 : "the very devices that make the system complete – inherence,
particularity, universal-mediated perception and a karma-bound God –
are also its deepest contested points."